

## Chapter 1 – Vocabulary

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### 1. Vocabulary Building Through Root Words

Etymological analysis (understanding root words) is the most efficient way to build a high-scoring vocabulary for APPSC, SSC, and RRB examinations. By mastering a single Greek or Latin root, you can decipher the meanings of dozens of related words.

#### A. Root: *ac, acr* (Meaning: Sharp, Bitter, Sour)

- **Acrimonious:** Bitter, caustic, or biting in temper, manner, or language.
- **Acerbity:** Sourness or bitterness of taste, speech, or temper.
- **Acidulate:** To make somewhat sour or acid.

#### B. Root: *aev, ev* (Meaning: Age, Era)

- **Primeval:** Belonging to the first or earliest ages of the world.
- **Coeval:** Existing at the same epoch, period, or age.
- **Medieval / Mediaeval:** Of, relating to, or characteristic of the Middle Ages.

#### C. Root: *belli* (Meaning: War, Fight)

- **Bellicose:** Inclined to fight; naturally hostile or argumentative.
- **Belligerent:** Waging war; actively hostile or combative.
- **Rebellious:** Defying or resisting established authority or government.

#### D. Root: *ben, bon* (Meaning: Good, Well)

- **Benefactor:** A person who confers a benefit; one who does good deeds or gives financial help.
- **Benevolence:** An inclination to do good; active goodwill or charity.
- **Bonus:** A premium or extra payment given beyond what is strictly due.

#### E. Root: *biblio* (Meaning: Book)

- **Bibliography:** A descriptive list of books on a specific subject or by a specific author.
- **Bibliophile:** A person who loves, collects, and treasures books.
- **Bible:** The sacred book of Christianity; metaphorically, "The Book" representing authoritative guidance.

#### F. Root: *cad, cas* (Meaning: To Fall)

- **Decadent:** Characterized by moral or cultural decline; falling into decay.
- **Cadence:** The rhythmic flow or musical fall of a sequence of sounds or words.
- **Cascade:** A steep waterfall descending over rocky stages.

#### G. Root: *carn* (Meaning: Flesh)

- **Carnivorous:** Flesh-eating.
- **Carnage:** The slaughter of a great number of people; a bloody massacre.
- **Carnal:** Associated with physical, fleshly appetites; sensual or wordly rather than spiritual.

#### H. Root: *ced, cess* (Meaning: To Yield, Go, Withdraw)

- **Recede:** To move or go back; to withdraw.
- **Antecedent:** A preceding event, circumstance, or word that goes before another.
- **Process:** A systematic series of actions directed to some end; going forward.

#### I. Root: *chron* (Meaning: Time)

- **Chronology:** The sequential arrangement of events in order of their occurrence in time.
- **Anachronism:** Something placed in a chronological period where it does not belong (an error in time placement).
- **Chronicle:** A historical register or continuous account of events in order of time.

#### J. Root: *cracy* (Meaning: Rule, Government)

- **Theocracy:** A form of government in which a deity is recognized as the supreme ruler, administered by religious officials.
- **Gerontocracy:** A governing body consisting of old men or elders.
- **Plutocracy:** A state or society governed by the wealthy class.
- **Bureaucracy:** Administration by a system of departments run by non-elected officials.
- **Gynaecocracy:** A government ruled entirely by women.
- **Ochlocracy:** Government run by a mob or crowd; mob rule.
- **Kakistocracy:** Government ruled by the worst, least qualified, or most unprincipled citizens.
- **Timocracy:** A form of government in which love of honor or property qualification is the ruling principle.

#### K. Root: *cred, credit* (Meaning: To Believe, Trust)

- **Incredulous:** Skeptical; showing disbelief; unwilling to believe.
- **Credility / Credulity:** Gullibility; a disposition to believe too readily on weak evidence.
- **Credence:** Belief as to the truth of a statement or claim.

#### L. Root: *culpa* (Meaning: Fault, Blame, Guilt)

- **Exculpate:** To clear from a charge of guilt or blame; declare innocent.
- **Culpable:** Deserving blame or censure; guilty.
- **Culprit:** A person who is responsible for a crime or misdeed.

#### M. Root: *dem* (Meaning: People)

- **Democracy:** A system of government by the whole population, typically through elected representatives.
- **Demagogue:** A political leader who seeks support by appealing to popular desires and prejudices rather than rational argument.
- **Epidemic:** A widespread outbreak of an infectious disease within a community at a particular time.

**N. Root: *ego* (Meaning: Self, I)**

- **Egoist:** A self-centered person who prioritizes their own interests.
- **Egotist:** A conceited, boastful talker who constantly talks about themselves.
- **Egocentric:** Individualistic; regarding oneself as the center of all things.

**O. Root: *err* (Meaning: To Wander, Mistake)**

- **Error:** A deviation from accuracy or correctness; a mistake.
- **Erratic:** Wandering; eccentric; not conforming to a standard, regular, or predictable path.
- **Knight-errant:** A medieval knight who wandered in search of adventures to prove his chivalry.

**P. Root: *eu* (Meaning: Good, Well, Beautiful)**

- **Eupeptic:** Having good digestion; metaphorically cheerful and optimistic.
- **Eulogize:** To praise highly in speech or writing (especially in a funeral oration).
- **Euphemism:** The substitution of a mild, indirect, or vague expression for one thought to be offensive or harsh.

**Q. Root: *gen* (Meaning: To Give Birth To, Produce, Kind)**

- **Gene:** A basic unit of heredity transferred from parent to offspring.
- **Congenital:** Existing at or dating from birth.
- **Genealogy:** The study of family history and ancestral lines.
- **Psychogenic:** Originating in the mind or in mental/emotional processes.

**R. Root: *grad, gress* (Meaning: Go, Step, Walk)**

- **Digress:** To wander away from the main topic or argument.
- **Regress:** To step backward; move back to a previous, less developed state.
- **Gradual:** Occurring or developing by small steps or degrees.

**S. Root: *loqu, locut* (Meaning: To Talk, Speak)**

- **Soliloquy:** An act of speaking one's thoughts aloud when alone, especially in a drama.
- **Loquacious:** Extremely talkative; chattering.
- **Elocution:** The art of public speaking, emphasizing clear pronunciation and delivery.

**T. Root: *luc* (Meaning: Light)**

- **Elucidate:** To shed light on; clarify; explain thoroughly.

- **Lucid:** Clear; transparent; easily understood.
- **Translucent:** Permitting light to pass through but diffusing it so objects cannot be clearly distinguished.

#### U. Root: *magn* (Meaning: Great, Large)

- **Magnify:** To make an object appear larger; to increase.
- **Magnanimity:** Generosity of spirit; nobility of soul; rising above pettiness.

#### V. Root: *mal* (Meaning: Bad, Evil, Ill)

- **Malevolent:** Wishing evil or harm to others; showing ill will.
- **Malediction:** A curse; slanderous or evil speaking.
- **Malefactor:** An evil-doer; a criminal.
- **Malignant:** Virulent; highly harmful; disposed to cause suffering.

#### W. Root: *mob, mot, mov* (Meaning: Move)

- **Mobilize:** To assemble or marshal forces into active motion or service.
- **Motility:** Power or capability of movement.
- **Immovable:** Firm; incapable of being shifted or moved.

#### X. Root: *pater, patr* (Meaning: Father)

- **Patriotism:** Devoted love, support, and defense of one's fatherland (country).
- **Patriarch:** The male head of a family, tribe, or community.
- **Paternity:** The state of being a father; fatherhood.

#### Y. Root: *path* (Meaning: Disease, Feeling, Suffering)

- **Pathology:** The scientific study of diseases and their structural and functional effects.
- **Apathetic:** Showing or feeling a total lack of interest, emotion, or concern.
- **Antipathy:** A natural, deep-seated feeling of intense aversion or dislike.

#### Z. Root: *phil* (Meaning: To Love)

- **Philanthropist:** A lover of humanity; a person who promotes the welfare of others through generous charitable donations.
- **Anglophile:** An admirer of England, its people, customs, and culture.
- **Philanderer:** A man who carries on casual, passing love affairs with women without serious intentions.
- **Philosopher:** A lover of wisdom; a scholar who studies the fundamental nature of knowledge and existence.
- **Philatelist:** A collector and lover of postage stamps.

#### AA. Root: *poten* (Meaning: Able, Powerful)

- **Omnipotent:** All-powerful; having infinite power.
- **Potentate:** A person who possesses great power; a monarch or ruler.
- **Impotent:** Lacking power, strength, or physical ability.

**AB. Root: *psych* (Meaning: Mind)**

- **Psychology:** The science of mind, mental states, and behavior.
- **Psychosis:** A severe mental disorder characterized by a loss of contact with reality.
- **Psychopath:** A person suffering from a chronic mental disorder characterized by abnormal, anti-social behavior and a lack of empathy.

**AC. Root: *sacr* (Meaning: Holy, Sacred)**

- **Sacrilegious:** Guilty of violating, desecrating, or treating with disrespect something holy.
- **Sacrament:** A formal, holy rite or ceremony in religious practices.

**AD. Root: *somn* (Meaning: Sleep)**

- **Insomnia:** The chronic inability to obtain sufficient sleep.
- **Somnolent:** Sleepy; drowsy; tending to cause sleep.
- **Somnamulist:** A person who walks in their sleep (sleepwalker).

**AE. Root: *therm* (Meaning: Heat)**

- **Thermostat:** An automatic device for regulating temperature.
- **Diathermy:** A medical technique using high-frequency electromagnetic currents to generate deep heat in tissues.

**AF. Root: *tract* (Meaning: Drag, Pull, Draw)**

- **Distract:** To draw away or divert one's attention from a focus.
- **Intractable:** Stubborn; unmanageable; difficult to drag, direct, or shape.

**AG. Root: *vac* (Meaning: Empty)**

- **Vacuous:** Empty-headed; containing no ideas; lacking contents or intelligence.
- **Evacuate:** To clear or empty an area of its residents or contents.

**AH. Root: *verb* (Meaning: Word)**

- **Verbose:** Wordy; using more words than necessary.
- **Verbiage:** An excess of words; wordiness without substantive meaning.
- **Verbatim:** Word-for-word replication of written or spoken speech.

**AI. Root: *voc, vocat* (Meaning: To Call)**

- **Avocation:** A calling away from one's main occupation; a hobby or minor pursuit.
- **Provocation:** Incitement; an action or speech that calls up anger or incites reaction.
- **Invocation:** Calling upon a deity or higher power in prayer or for protection.

**AJ. Root: *vol* (Meaning: Wish, Will)**

- **Malevolent:** Wishing ill, injury, or evil to another.

- **Voluntary:** Done, made, or undertaken of one's own free will or choice.

**AK. Root: *volv, volut* (Meaning: To Roll, Turn)**

- **Convolution:** A rolled-up, coiled, or twisted shape; a complex fold.

## 2. One-Word Substitutions Mapped by Themes

**Category I: Systematic Forms of Phobia (Fear) [derived from *phoebe/phobia*]**

- **Astraphobia:** Fear of celestial space, lightning, or stars.
- **Ballistophobia:** Fear of missiles or bullets.
- **Claustrophobia:** Fear of closed or confined spaces.
- **Ergophobia:** Fear of work.
- **Nyctophobia:** Fear of darkness or night.
- **Ochlophobia:** Fear of mobs or crowds.
- **Panophobia:** A generalized, persistent, groundless fear of everything (all-encompassing fear).
- **Photophobia:** Fear of or high sensitivity to light.
- **Sitophobia:** Fear of food or eating.
- **Xenophobia:** Fear of strangers, foreigners, or anything foreign.
- **Trichophobia:** Fear of hair.

## 3. Synonyms & Antonyms Master Lists

These highly high-yield vocabulary matches are derived directly from standard competitive exams.

| Word               | Part of Speech | Synonyms                        | Antonyms                        |
|--------------------|----------------|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>Abstract</b>    | Noun / Adj     | Summary, outline, general       | Detailed, specific, concrete    |
| <b>Complacent</b>  | Adjective      | Satisfied, smug, content        | Disappointed, ambitious, uneasy |
| <b>Exterminate</b> | Verb           | Annihilate, destroy, eradicate  | Save, preserve, create          |
| <b>Chagrin</b>     | Noun           | Annoyance, irritation, vexation | Delight, pleasure, satisfaction |
| <b>Dunk</b>        | Verb           | Douse, dip, submerge            | Dry, dehydrate, elevate         |
| <b>Distraught</b>  | Adjective      | Agitated, anxious, worried      | Calm, tranquil, serene          |
| <b>Lissome</b>     | Adjective      | Lithe, supple, graceful         | Stiff, rigid, clumsy            |
| <b>Palliate</b>    | Verb           | Alleviate, mitigate, ease       | Aggravate, worsen, intensify    |
| <b>Resilient</b>   | Adjective      | Spirited, elastic, buoyant      | Rigid, fragile, delicate        |
| <b>Impetuous</b>   | Adjective      | Rash, impulsive, reckless       | Cautious, careful, deliberate   |
| <b>Arraign</b>     | Verb           | Accuse, indict, charge          | Exonerate, acquit, pardon       |

|                      |           |                                    |                                      |
|----------------------|-----------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>Apocryphal</b>    | Adjective | Dubious, questionable, spurious    | Authentic, true, genuine             |
| <b>Abduct</b>        | Verb      | Kidnap, seize, snatch              | Release, rescue, surrender           |
| <b>Abode</b>         | Noun      | Dwelling, residence, sanctuary     | Exile, wilderness, outdoors          |
| <b>Epitomize</b>     | Verb      | Embody, typify, summarize          | Expand, enlarge, misrepresent        |
| <b>Immaculate</b>    | Adjective | Spotless, pure, perfect            | Unclean, filthy, defiled             |
| <b>Ignominious</b>   | Adjective | Humiliating, shameful, disgraceful | Laudable, honorable, proud           |
| <b>Mellowed</b>      | Adjective | Softened, matured, ripe            | Harsh, immature, raw                 |
| <b>Grouchy</b>       | Adjective | Cantankerous, irritable, grumpy    | Cheerful, pleasant, contented        |
| <b>Impudent</b>      | Adjective | Rude, insolent, disrespectful      | Courteous, polite, respectful        |
| <b>Mitigate</b>      | Verb      | Abate, soothe, alleviate           | Aggravate, intensify, worsen         |
| <b>Expostulation</b> | Noun      | Protest, remonstrance, objection   | Approbations, agreement, approval    |
| <b>Disparage</b>     | Verb      | Belittle, deprecate, denigrate     | Appreciate, praise, laud             |
| <b>Ossification</b>  | Noun      | Hardening, petrification           | Liquefaction, softening, flexibility |
| <b>Pedestrian</b>    | Adjective | Dull, ordinary, commonplace        | Exciting, imaginative, extraordinary |
| <b>Demented</b>      | Adjective | Mad, insane, crazed                | Sane, rational, clear-minded         |
| <b>Brusque</b>       | Adjective | Abrupt, curt, blunt                | Polite, courteous, tactful           |
| <b>Bucolic</b>       | Adjective | Pastoral, rustic, rural            | Urban, metropolitan, city-like       |
| <b>Contrite</b>      | Adjective | Apologetic, penitent, remorseful   | Defiant, unrepentant, stubborn       |
| <b>Controvert</b>    | Verb      | Refute, deny, oppose               | Accept, agree, endorse               |
| <b>Cower</b>         | Verb      | Cringe, shrink, recoil             | Stand out, confront, face            |
| <b>Crestfallen</b>   | Adjective | Abashed, dejected, discouraged     | Cheerful, confident, ecstatic        |
| <b>Jeopardy</b>      | Noun      | Danger, hazard, peril              | Security, safety, protection         |
| <b>Musty</b>         | Adjective | Moldy, stale, damp                 | Fragrant, fresh, clean               |

#### 4. Homonyms & Diction (Words Often Confused)

Mastering correct semantic usage prevents mistakes in "Sentence Correction" and "Fill in the Blanks".

##### Group I: The Singular vs. Plural Meaning Shift

A singular noun can take a completely different meaning when written in its plural form. **You must understand the sentence's contextual meaning to choose the correct noun form:**

1. **Content** (Noun: satisfaction/peace of mind) vs. **Contents** (Noun: things contained inside something, e.g., a letter or book).
  - *Example:* Her mouth was fixed in a smile of pure **content**.
  - *Example:* I opened the letter and read its **contents**.
2. **Good** (Noun: moral virtue/benefit) vs. **Goods** (Noun: merchandise/commercial products).
  - *Example:* The conflict between **good** and evil is ages old.
  - *Example:* We must produce **goods** at competitive prices.
3. **Air** (Noun: atmosphere/gas we breathe) vs. **Airs** (Noun: affected, proud, arrogant behavior).
  - *Example:* Delhites breathe the most polluted **air** in the world.
  - *Example:* She was just putting on **airs** when she came to visit us.
4. **Force** (Noun: physical strength/power) vs. **Forces** (Noun: military or troop units).
  - *Example:* We should renounce the use of **force** to settle our dispute.
  - *Example:* Families of people who died as a result of services in the **forces** should not be ignored.
5. **Return** (Noun: coming back to a place) vs. **Returns** (Noun: quantitative reports/profit declarations/ballot counts).
  - *Example:* I was very excited on my **return** to my home village.
  - *Example:* Early **returns** in the ballot indicate a majority for the opposition.

## Group II: Word Pair Confusions

1. **Advice** (Noun: a proposal or recommendation) vs. **Advise** (Verb: the action of offering counsel).
  - *Rule:* *Advice* ends with a /s/ sound; *advise* ends with a /z/ sound and takes an object when used as a transitive verb.
  - *Example:* The teacher gave much **advice** (noun) to the students.
  - *Example:* The doctor **advised** (verb) me not to smoke.
2. **Adapt** (Verb: to adjust or make suitable) vs. **Adopt** (Verb: to legally take as one's own or accept a method).
  - *Example:* Novels are **adapted** for the stage.
  - *Example:* He **adopted** a son.
3. **Allusion** (Noun: an indirect or passing reference) vs. **Illusion** (Noun: a deceptive appearance or false belief).
  - *Example:* The **allusion** that I am stingy is a mistake.
  - *Example:* I do not have **illusions** about his ability.
4. **Amiable** (Adjective: warm, pleasant, and friendly—used for *persons*) vs. **Amicable** (Adjective: peaceable; characterized by goodwill—used for *relations, agreements, settlements*).
  - *Example:* Radha is quite an **amiable** person.
  - *Example:* The dispute is serious and therefore cannot be settled **amicably**.
5. **Beside** (Preposition: by the side of; close to) vs. **Besides** (Preposition/Adverb: in addition to; moreover).
  - *Example:* His mother sat **beside** him.
  - *Example:* Is anyone else coming **besides** you?
6. **Childish** (Adjective: silly, immature, or weak—*negative connotation*) vs. **Childlike** (Adjective: innocent, trusting, and pure—*positive connotation*).
  - *Example:* I don't like his **childish** behavior.
  - *Example:* Gandhiji always put on a **childlike** smile on his lips.



7. **Confidant** (Noun: a close friend with whom secrets are shared) vs. **Confident** (Adjective: having firm belief or self-assurance).  
○ *Example:* Nehru was a **confidant** of Gandhiji in political matters.  
○ *Example:* I am **confident** of success in the examination.
8. **Continual** (Adjective: occurring frequently with short, repetitive interruptions) vs. **Continuous** (Adjective: ongoing without any break or interruption in time or space).  
○ *Example:* He had **continual** arguments with his wife.  
○ *Example:* There was **continuous** rain yesterday.
9. **Deny** (Verb: to declare a statement untrue) vs. **Refuse** (Verb: to decline to accept, give, or do something).  
○ *Example:* The minister **denied** the allegation that he had taken a bribe.  
○ *Example:* He **refused** the money given as a bribe.
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## Top 25 Expected MCQs: Previous APPSC/SSC/RRB-Style Questions

**Directions (Q1–Q5): Identify the correct option that represents the exact etymological meaning of the underlined word based on its root.**

**Q1. The old man lived in a state of complete *apathy*, ignoring everything happening in his neighborhood.** (A) Intense feeling of hatred

(B) State of having no feeling or concern

(C) Severe mental illness

(D) Great physical strength

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Etymological Rule:* The word **apathy** comes from the Greek prefix **a-** (without) and the root **path** (feeling, suffering, disease). Thus, etymologically, *apathy* means "without feeling."

**Q2. The archaeological team discovered a series of *medieval* documents inside the vault.**

(A) Belonging to the earliest age of the earth

(B) Belonging to the Middle Ages

(C) Belonging to the future

(D) Chronologically incorrect

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Etymological Rule:* The word contains the root **aev/ev** (age) combined with **medi** (middle). Therefore, **medieval** denotes the middle age of human history.

**Q3. His *bellicose* nature made him highly unpopular among his colleagues.** (A) Generous and peaceful

(B) Showing extreme wisdom

(C) Naturally inclined to fight and wage war

(D) Highly talkative

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Etymological Rule:* Derived from the Latin root **belli** (war). A **bellicose** individual is one who has a warmongering or naturally combative temperament.

**Q4. The philanthropist established an orphanage and left a massive endowment.** (A)

One who studies mental states

(B) One who collects postage stamps

- (C) One who loves and works to promote the welfare of humanity
- (D) One who loves collecting old books

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Etymological Rule:* Formed by combining the Greek root **phil** (to love) with **anthrop** (mankind/humanity). Hence, a **philanthropist** is literally a "lover of humanity."

**Q5. He became *incredulous* when he heard about his selection for the national squad.**

- (A) Highly excited and cheerful
- (B) Deserving of blame
- (C) Showing a complete lack of physical power
- (D) Skeptical and unwilling to believe easily

**Correct Answer: (D)**

*Etymological Rule:* Derived from the prefix **in-** (not) and the root **cred** (to believe). An **incredulous** person is "not believing" or skeptical.

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**Directions (Q6–Q10): Choose the correct option that represents the appropriate One-Word Substitution for the given statement.**

**Q6. A form of government administered entirely by the wealthiest class of citizens. (A)**

- Theocracy
- (B) Plutocracy
- (C) Kakistocracy
- (D) Gerontocracy

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Etymological Rule:* The root **cracy** stands for rule/government. **Pluto** stands for wealth. Therefore, a government by the wealthy is a **plutocracy**.

**Q7. An abnormal, intense, and irrational fear of strangers or foreigners. (A)**

- Claustrophobia
- (B) Nyctophobia
- (C) Ochlophobia
- (D) Xenophobia

**Correct Answer: (D)**

*Etymological Rule:* The root **phobia** denotes fear. **Xeno** means stranger or foreigner. Thus, **xenophobia** represents the fear of foreigners.

**Q8. A political leader who stirs up the common masses by appealing to their emotions, desires, and prejudices rather than using rational logic. (A) Bibliophile**

- (B) Demagogue
- (C) Pedestrian
- (D) Benefactor

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Etymological Rule:* Derived from the root **dem** (people) and the suffix **agogue** (leader/driver). A **demagogue** is a driver of the crowd who manipulates popular passions.

**Q9. An individual who walks in their sleep due to a psychological or physiological condition. (A) Somnambulist**

- (B) Egoist

(C) Philanderer

(D) Culprit

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Etymological Rule:* Derived from **somn** (sleep) and **ambul** (to walk). Hence, a **somnambulist** is a sleepwalker.

**Q10. A system of administration run by departmental officials who are non-elected and typically rigid in their procedures.** (A) Timocracy

(B) Gynaecocracy

(C) Bureaucracy

(D) Theocracy

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Etymological Rule:* The root **cracy** means rule. **Bureau** refers to the desks or offices of administrators. Thus, administration by non-elected state officials is a **bureaucracy**.

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**Directions (Q11–Q15): Select the word that is nearest in meaning (Synonym) to the given word.**

**Q11. COMPLACENT**

(A) SMUG / SATISFIED

(B) DISAPPOINTED

(C) ANXIOUS

(D) ADAPTABLE

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Explanation:* **Complacent** means showing smug or uncritical satisfaction with oneself or one's achievements. Its direct synonym is *smug* or *satisfied*.

**Q12. PALLIATE**

(A) AGGRAVATE

(B) ALLEVIATE

(C) CONDEMN

(D) ACCUSE

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* To **palliate** a disease or bad situation means to alleviate, soothe, or make it less severe without removing the cause.

**Q13. APOCRYPHAL**

(A) GENUINE

(B) QUESTIONABLE / DUBIOUS

(C) EXTRAORDINARY

(D) RECKLESS

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* An **apocryphal** story is of doubtful authenticity, although widely circulated as being true. Hence, its synonym is *dubious* or *questionable*.

**Q14. CHAGRIN**

(A) ANNOYANCE / IRRITATION

(B) EXCITEMENT

- (C) EXONERATION
- (D) PETRIFICATION

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Explanation:* **Chagrin** is distress or embarrassment caused by humiliation or failure. It closely equates to *annoyance* or *irritation*.

**Q15. EPITOMIZE**

- (A) DISMISS
- (B) ELABORATE
- (C) EMBODY / TYPIFY
- (D) REJECT

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Explanation:* To **epitomize** means to be a perfect example of something, thereby *embodying* or *typifying* it.

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**Directions (Q16–Q20): Select the word that is furthest in meaning (Antonym) to the given word.**

**Q16. IMMACULATE**

- (A) SPOTLESS
- (B) FILTHY / UNCLEAN
- (C) RUSTIC
- (D) REMORSEFUL

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* **Immaculate** means perfectly clean, neat, or pure. Its antonym is *unclean* or *filthy*.

**Q17. IGNOMINIOUS**

- (A) LAUDABLE / HONORABLE
- (B) SHAMEFUL
- (C) MEDIOCRE
- (D) SILENT

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Explanation:* **Ignominious** means deserving or causing public disgrace or shame. Its antonym is *laudable* (praiseworthy) or *honorable*.

**Q18. BRUSQUE**

- (A) ABRUPT
- (B) CURT
- (C) POLITE / COURTEOUS
- (D) ROUGH

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Explanation:* **Brusque** describes an abrupt, offhand, or blunt manner of speaking. Its opposite is *polite* or *courteous*.

**Q19. CONTRITE**

- (A) APOLOGETIC
- (B) PENITENT

(C) DEFIANT / UNREPENTANT

(D) DISGRACED

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Explanation:* **Contrite** means feeling or expressing remorse or penitence. The antonym is *defiant* or *unrepentant*.

**Q20. PEDESTRIAN**

(A) ORDINARY

(B) EXCITING / IMAGINATIVE

(C) DULL

(D) INNOCENT

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* When used as an adjective, **pedestrian** means lacking inspiration or excitement; dull and ordinary. Its antonym is *exciting* or *imaginative*.

---

**Directions (Q21–Q25): Fill in the blanks with the correct pair of words to make the sentence grammatically and semantically correct.**

**Q21. The counselor gave me excellent \_\_\_\_\_; she \_\_\_\_\_ me to stay calm during the interview.**

(A) advise, advised

(B) advice, advised

(C) advice, advices

(D) advising, advice

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Semantic Rule:* **Advice** (noun with /s/ sound) is the recommendation itself. **Advise** (verb with /z/ sound) is the action. The first blank requires a noun, and the second blank requires a past-tense verb.

**Q22. Radha is highly \_\_\_\_\_ and maintains \_\_\_\_\_ relations even with her rivals.**

(A) amicable, amiable

(B) amiable, amicable

(C) friendly, amiable

(D) amicable, friendly

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Semantic Rule:* **Amiable** (warm, friendly) qualifies the personality of a person (Radha). **Amicable** (peaceable, characterized by goodwill) qualifies a *relationship, treaty, or settlement* (relations).

**Q23. The accused \_\_\_\_\_ the charge of theft, but he \_\_\_\_\_ to return the stolen items to the owner.**

(A) refused, denied

(B) denied, refused

(C) rejected, denied

(D) denied, denied

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Semantic Rule:* **Deny** (to declare a statement/accusation untrue). **Refuse** (to decline to do,

give, or accept an action/item). He declared the charge untrue (denied) and declined to return the items (refused).

**Q24. She sat \_\_\_\_\_ her friend, but \_\_\_\_\_ the two of them, no one else attended the seminar.**

- (A) besides, beside
- (B) beside, besides
- (C) near, beside
- (D) besides, near

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Semantic Rule:* **Beside** means "by the side of" (physical position). **Besides** means "in addition to" or "excepting."

**Q25. It is dangerous to walk in this polluted \_\_\_\_\_; the industrial chimneys are throwing out toxic gases, while the local politicians are simply putting on arrogant \_\_\_\_\_.**

- (A) air, air
- (B) airs, airs
- (C) air, airs
- (D) airs, air

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Semantic Rule:* **Air** refers to the atmospheric gas. **Airs** (always plural) refers to snobbish, proud, or affected behavior.

---

## Next Step Recommendation

**■ Shall we proceed to Chapter 2 – Grammar Fundamentals?** We will break down the structure of a sentence (Subject vs. Predicate, inverted S.P and P.P structures), Parts of Speech identification, and Phrase vs. Clause types directly from your photo notes.

## Chapter 2 – Grammar Fundamentals

---

### 1. Sentence and Its Parts

A **sentence** is a group of words that makes complete sense on its own. Every complete sentence must express a complete thought and contain at least one independent clause.

#### A. Subject and Predicate

A sentence can be structurally divided into two primary components:

1. **Subject:** The person, place, thing, or idea that the sentence is about (the "doer" or the entity being discussed). It is typically a noun or a pronoun, along with any modifiers.

2. **Predicate:** The part of the sentence that contains the verb and tells us something about the subject (what the subject is, does, or experiences). It may contain objects, complements, adverbs, or prepositional phrases.

### Standard Division Examples:

- **Birds** (Subject) | **fly.** (Predicate)
- **Mohan** (Subject) | **is an engineer.** (Predicate)
- **He** (Subject) | **teaches Engineering Graphics.** (Predicate)
- **This intelligent girl** (Subject) | **has passed her examination in the first division.** (Predicate)
- **The President of India** (Subject) | **has awarded him a gold medal.** (Predicate)

### B. Subject-Predicate Inversion (S-P and P-P Inversion)

In standard English sentences, the subject usually appears first, followed by the predicate. However, in specific structures, the predicate (or a portion of it) can precede the subject. This is known as **S-P (Subject-Predicate)** and **P-P (Predicate-Predicate) inversion**, which is used primarily for literary emphasis or dramatic effect.

- *Example:* **Down went** (Predicate) the **Royal Francis** (Subject).
- *Analysis:* Here, the verb phrase "down went" is placed before the actual subject "Royal Francis" to emphasize the direction and suddenness of the movement.

### C. Real vs. Grammatical (Dummy) Subjects

A sentence can sometimes begin with introductory words that do not represent the actual "doer" or real subject of the action. These are called **grammatical or dummy subjects**.

1. **"There" as a Dummy Subject:** Used to declare the existence of something. The real subject follows the verb.
    - *Example:* **There** is a *beautiful garden* in front of my house. (Real subject: *a beautiful garden*).
  2. **"It" as a Dummy Subject:** Used to introduce conditions like time, weather, distance, or a clause.
    - *Example:* **It** has been raining heavily since morning. (Real subject: *the action of raining*).
    - *Example:* **There** is a phone call for your friend. (Real subject: *a phone call*).
- 

## 2. Parts of Speech: Identification & Contextual Traps

Words are classified into **eight distinct Parts of Speech** based on the specific grammatical function they perform within a given sentence. The part of speech of a word is not fixed; it is determined entirely by how it is used in context.

### A. The Eight Parts of Speech

1. **Noun:** A word used as the name of a person, place, animal, thing, quality, state, or action (e.g., *Rajitha, Hyderabad, lion, table, goodness, movement*).

2. **Pronoun:** A word used in place of a noun to avoid repetitive usage (e.g., *he, she, it, they, anyone, himself*).
3. **Adjective:** A word that qualifies, describes, or restricts a noun or a pronoun.
  - *Attributive usage (placed before the noun):* Our team played a **good** game.
  - *Predicative usage (placed after a linking verb):* All these proposals are **good**.
4. **Verb:** A word that expresses what a subject is, does, possesses, or what is done to it (e.g., *Dr. Rao teaches English, He has taught for twenty-five years*).
5. **Adverb:** A word that modifies or adds detail to a verb, an adjective, or another adverb.
  - *Modifying an Adjective:* I am **deeply** grateful to you for your timely help. ("deeply" modifies the adjective "grateful").
  - *Modifying a Verb:* He read the passage **quickly**. ("quickly" modifies the verb "read").
  - *Modifying another Adverb:* This horse runs **very** fast. ("very" modifies the adverb "fast").
6. **Preposition:** A word placed before a noun or pronoun to establish its spatial, temporal, or logical relationship to some other word in the sentence (e.g., *Work in the college begins at 10 a.m.*).
7. **Conjunction (Connector):** A word that joins together individual words, phrases, or entire clauses (e.g., *Delhi and Kolkata, She must be either the President or the Secretary, He is not only intelligent but also industrious*).
8. **Interjection:** A word or phrase that expresses sudden, strong internal emotions (surprise, pain, joy, sorrow) and is not grammatically connected to the rest of the sentence (e.g., *Alas! she is dead, Hurrah! we won the match*).

## B. The Pronoun vs. Adjective Contextual Trap

Many words (such as *these, each, some, either, neither*) function as **Pronouns** in one sentence and **Adjectives** in another.

*Rule of Thumb:* If the word is followed immediately by a noun, it is acting as an **Adjective** (determiner). If it stands alone as a subject or object, it is acting as a **Pronoun**.

| Word          | Function as a Pronoun                                    | Function as an Adjective                     |
|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <b>These</b>  | <b>These</b> are good students.                          | <b>These</b> students are good.              |
| <b>Each</b>   | <b>Each</b> of these books is worth reading.             | <b>Each</b> book has some special features.  |
| <b>Some</b>   | <b>Some</b> of the problems are difficult to solve.      | <b>Some</b> problems are difficult to solve. |
| <b>Either</b> | <b>Either</b> of you can participate in the competition. | <b>Either</b> book is good for reference.    |

## 3. Phrases, Non-Finites, and Clauses

### A. Phrases

A **phrase** is a structurally coherent group of words *without a finite verb*. It cannot express a complete thought on its own.

- **Noun Phrase:** Functions as a noun in the sentence.



- *Example:* **A fifty-year-old man** is seen in the garden.
- **Adjective Phrase:** Modifies a noun or pronoun.
  - *Example:* This chain is **made of gold**. (Modifies the noun "chain").
- **Adverb Phrase:** Modifies a verb, adjective, or adverb.
  - *Example:* Please place the chemicals **in the storeroom**. (Modifies the verb "place" by indicating location).

## B. Non-Finites

Verbs are classified as **finite** (denote tense, person, and number) or **non-finite** (do not denote tense or change form based on the subject). There are three primary types of non-finites:

1. **Infinitive (to + verb):** Used as a noun, adjective, or adverb.
  - *Example:* She wants **to buy** a new house.
2. **Gerund (verb + ing functioning as a noun):** Also called a verbal noun.
  - *Example:* **Buying** a new house needs money.
3. **Participle (verb form acting as an adjective):** Can be present (-ing) or past (-ed/-en).
  - *Example:* I found him **looking** for a new house.
  - *Example:* **Wounded** in the war, the soldier was hospitalized.

## C. Clauses

A **clause** is a group of words that *contains a finite verb*. Clauses are divided into two main categories:

1. **Main (Principal or Independent) Clause:** Can stand alone as a complete sentence because it makes complete sense.
2. **Subordinate (Dependent) Clause:** Cannot stand alone; it depends on the main clause to complete its meaning. It is categorized into three types:

### I. Noun Clauses

A Noun Clause performs the work of a noun within a sentence. It can function as:

- **Subject of a Verb:** **That he will be appointed to the job** is certain.
- **Object of a Transitive Verb:** We knew **that the plan was impractical**.
- **Complement of a Verb:** Our hope is **that he will secure the first rank**.
- **Object of a Preposition:** We were not aware of **what they were doing**.
- **In Apposition to a Noun:** The suggestion, **that the meeting should be adjourned**, was accepted.

### II. Adjective Clauses (Relative Clauses)

An Adjective Clause qualifies a noun or pronoun in the main clause. It is introduced by relative pronouns (*who, which, whom, whose, that*) or relative adverbs (*where, when, why*).

- *Example:* The young man **who was here a little while ago** is the President. (Qualifies "young man").
- *Example:* This is the story **which my friend wrote**. (Qualifies "story").
- *Note:* The relative pronoun must be placed as close to its antecedent (the noun it qualifies) as possible to avoid syntactic ambiguity.

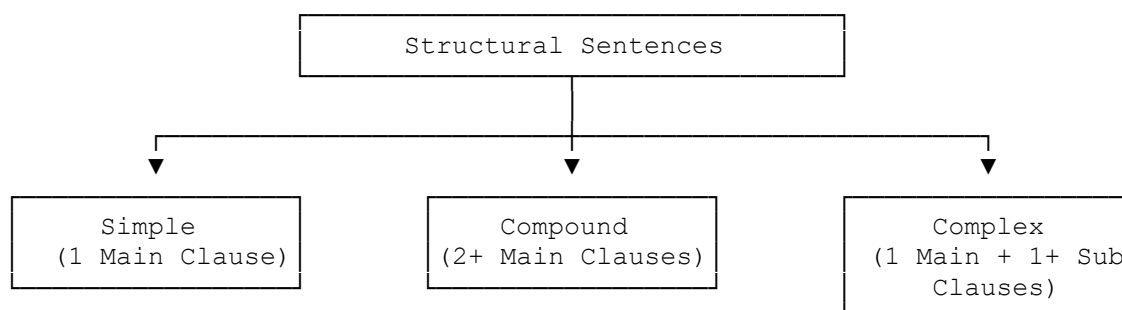
### III. Adverbial Clauses

An Adverbial Clause performs the function of an adverb by modifying verbs, adjectives, or adverbs. They are classified by their semantic purpose:

- **Adverbial Clause of Time:** Introduced by *when, as, while, till, until, before, after, since, as soon as*.
    - *Example:* Some persons in the audience fell asleep **while the chief guest was speaking**.
  - **Adverbial Clause of Place:** Introduced by *where, wherever*.
    - *Example:* You may go **wherever you like**.
  - **Adverbial Clause of Reason/Cause:** Introduced by *as, because, since, now that*.
    - *Example:* You can be punctual to school **now that you have a school bus**.
  - **Adverbial Clause of Purpose:** Introduced by *so that, that, in order that, lest*.
    - *Example:* The police officer went in plain clothes **so that no one might recognize him**.
  - **Adverbial Clause of Condition:** Introduced by *if, unless*.
    - *Example:* **If he apologizes to me**, I shall forgive him.
  - **Adverbial Clause of Concession:** Introduced by *though, although, even though*.
    - *Example:* **Though he is intelligent**, he cannot argue well.
- 

## 4. Structural Types of Sentences

Sentences are classified structurally based on the number and type of clauses they contain.



### A. Simple Sentence

A simple sentence contains **only one main clause**. This means it has exactly one subject, one predicate, and a single finite verb.

- *Example:* **My father is a senior manager in this organization.**
- *Example:* **Microbiology is an interesting subject for me.**

### B. Compound Sentence

A compound sentence contains **two or more main (independent) clauses** of equal grammatical rank, joined by coordinating conjunctions (*and, but, or, yet, still, so, for, not only...but also*).

- *Example:* **He is poor** (Main Clause 1) | **yet** (Coordinating Conjunction) | **he is happy** (Main Clause 2).
- *Example:* **The flowers were blooming, the birds were singing, and spring was in the air.** (Three independent clauses joined by punctuation and "and").

### C. Complex Sentence

A complex sentence contains **one main (principal) clause** and **at least one subordinate (dependent) clause** joined by subordinating conjunctions (*if, because, since, although, unless, that, which*).

- *Example:* **If you work hard** (Subordinate Conditional Clause), | **you will pass** (Main Clause).
- *Example:* **As soon as the meeting began** (Subordinate Time Clause), | **a member said that he wanted to raise a point of order** (Main Clause).

## 5. Semantic Types of Sentences

Sentences are also classified semantically based on their meaning, tone, and communicative purpose.

1. **Assertive / Declarative Sentences:** State facts, describe things, or report events in an informative manner.
  - *Affirmative:* Sreedhar is a highly intelligent student.
  - *Negative:* He is not a rich man.
2. **Imperative Sentences:** Express commands, orders, requests, warnings, invitations, or advice. The subject "you" is typically understood rather than written.
  - *Example:* **Take these books to the library.** (Command)
  - *Example:* **Please help me.** (Request)
  - *Example:* **Never waste your time.** (Advice)
3. **Interrogative Sentences:** Used to make inquiries or ask direct questions.
  - *Example:* **Can I help you?**
  - *Example:* **Is the bus late this morning?**
4. **Exclamatory Sentences:** Express strong, sudden emotions of surprise, grief, joy, or awe, ending with an exclamation mark.
  - *Example:* **How fast time flies!**
  - *Example:* **What a beautiful view we have from here!**

## Top 25 Expected MCQs: Previous APPSC/SSC/RRB-Style Questions

**Directions (Q1–Q5):** Identify the bold part of the sentence as either the "Subject" or the "Predicate".

**Q1. The Prime Minister with all his Cabinet members has submitted his resignation.**

- (A) Real Subject
- (B) Complete Subject
- (C) Predicate

(D) Grammatical Predicate

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* The "Complete Subject" consists of the simple subject ("The Prime Minister") along with all of its modifying prepositional phrases and parenthetical attachments ("with all his Cabinet members").

**Q2. Down went *the Royal Francis* into the depths of the ocean.**

(A) Simple Predicate

(B) Complete Predicate

(C) Subject

(D) Dummy Subject

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Rule:* This sentence uses S-P inversion for rhetorical emphasis. "The Royal Francis" is the noun performing the action of going down, making it the real subject of the sentence.

**Q3. *There* are several books on Thermodynamics in the library.**

(A) Real Subject

(B) Grammatical/Dummy Subject

(C) Complete Predicate

(D) Object of the Preposition

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* "There" acts as an introductory dummy subject to establish existence. The real, logical subject of the sentence is "several books".

**Q4. The President of India *has awarded him a gold medal*.**

(A) Noun Phrase

(B) Subject

(C) Complete Predicate

(D) Adverb Clause

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Rule:* The predicate begins with the finite auxiliary verb "has" and includes all subsequent elements ("awarded him a gold medal") that tell us what the subject did.

**Q5. *It has been raining incessantly since last night*.**

(A) Complete Predicate

(B) Grammatical/Dummy Subject

(C) Noun in Apposition

(D) Real Subject

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* "It" serves as an impersonal dummy subject used to discuss weather conditions, where no specific physical entity is performing the raining.

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**Directions (Q6–Q10): Identify the Part of Speech of the bold word based on its contextual usage.**

**Q6. *These* students are highly disciplined and diligent.**

(A) Demonstrative Pronoun

(B) Demonstrative Adjective

- (C) Personal Pronoun
- (D) Noun Modifier of Number

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* Because "These" immediately precedes and modifies the plural noun "students", it functions as a demonstrative adjective. If it stood alone (e.g., "*These are good students*"), it would be a demonstrative pronoun.

**Q7. Each of the applicants has been interviewed by the board.**

- (A) Distributive Adjective
- (B) Distributive Pronoun
- (C) Adjective of Quantity
- (D) Indefinite Pronoun

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* "Each" stands alone as the subject of the prepositional phrase "of the applicants," which makes it a distributive pronoun.

**Q8. The doctor gave much advice to the young athlete.**

- (A) Abstract Noun
- (B) Transitive Verb
- (C) Intransitive Verb
- (D) Adverb of Degree

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Rule:* "Advice" (ending in the /s/ sound) is the noun form representing counsel. "Advise" (ending in the /z/ sound) is the verb form.

**Q9. Radha is quite an amiable person to converse with.**

- (A) Adverb of Manner
- (B) Coordinate Conjunction
- (C) Attributive Adjective
- (D) Predicative Adjective

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Rule:* "Amiable" modifies the noun "person" and is placed directly before it, which makes it an attributive adjective.

**Q10. I am deeply grateful to you for your timely assistance.**

- (A) Adverb of Manner
- (B) Adverb modifying an Adjective
- (C) Adjective of Quality
- (D) Intensifying Preposition

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* "Deeply" modifies the adjective "grateful," indicating the degree of gratitude. Adverbs modify verbs, adjectives, or other adverbs.

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**Directions (Q11–Q15): Identify the correct type of bold Phrase, Non-Finite, or Clause.**

**Q11. That he will be appointed to the prestigious post is absolutely certain.**

- (A) Adjective Clause
- (B) Adverbial Clause of Result

(C) Noun Clause as Subject of Verb

(D) Noun Clause as Object of Verb

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Rule:* The entire clause "That he will be appointed..." acts as the grammatical subject for the linking verb "is," making it a noun clause functioning as a subject.

**Q12. The young man *who was here a little while ago* is the president of the union.**

(A) Subordinate Noun Clause

(B) Subordinate Adjective Clause

(C) Adverbial Clause of Time

(D) Co-ordinate Main Clause

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* This clause is introduced by the relative pronoun "who" and modifies the antecedent noun "young man," which makes it an adjective or relative clause.

**Q13. Some persons in the audience fell asleep *while the chief guest was speaking*.**

(A) Adverbial Clause of Place

(B) Adverbial Clause of Condition

(C) Adverbial Clause of Time

(D) Noun Clause in Apposition

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Rule:* Introduced by the subordinating conjunction of time "while," this clause modifies the verb phrase "fell asleep" by indicating when the action occurred.

**Q14. The teacher wants his students *not only to keep quiet but also to do the task*.**

(A) Parallel Gerund Structure

(B) Parallel Infinitive Phrase Structure

(C) Complex Adverb Phrase

(D) Subordinate Noun Clause

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* The sentence coordinates two infinitive phrases ("to keep quiet" and "to do the task") using the correlative conjunction pair "not only...but also," maintaining parallel grammatical structure.

**Q15. *Wounded in the war*, the brave soldier returned home.**

(A) Present Participle Phrase

(B) Past Participle Phrase acting as Adjective

(C) Gerund Phrase acting as Subject

(D) Prepositional Adverb Phrase

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* "Wounded in the war" is a past participle phrase that modifies the noun "soldier" by describing his state.

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**Directions (Q16–Q20): Identify the correct Structural category of the given sentence.**

**Q16. He is highly intelligent, yet he has failed in the final examination.**

(A) Simple Sentence

(B) Compound Sentence

- (C) Complex Sentence
- (D) Double Subordinate Complex Sentence

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* This sentence consists of two independent clauses of equal rank ("He is highly intelligent" and "he has failed...") connected by the coordinating adversative conjunction "yet."

**Q17. As soon as the principal entered the classroom, all the students stood up.**

- (A) Simple Sentence
- (B) Compound Sentence
- (C) Complex Sentence
- (D) Imperative Sentence

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Rule:* It contains one main clause ("all the students stood up") and one subordinate adverbial clause of time ("As soon as the principal entered the classroom").

**Q18. Chandigarh is a carefully planned city.**

- (A) Simple Sentence
- (B) Compound Sentence
- (C) Complex Sentence
- (D) Assertive Compound Sentence

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Rule:* The sentence contains exactly one subject ("Chandigarh"), one predicate ("is a carefully planned city"), and a single finite verb ("is").

**Q19. Many doctors are attending on him, still he is not out of danger.**

- (A) Simple Sentence
- (B) Complex Sentence
- (C) Compound Sentence
- (D) Exclamatory Sentence

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Rule:* Two independent clauses are joined by the coordinating conjunction "still," which shows a contrast between the doctors' attendance and his status.

**Q20. If you do not run fast, you will miss the train.**

- (A) Simple Sentence
- (B) Compound Sentence
- (C) Complex Sentence
- (D) Semantic Imperative Sentence

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Rule:* It contains a main clause ("you will miss the train") and a subordinate conditional clause introduced by "If."

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**Directions (Q21–Q25): Identify the correct Semantic category of the given sentence.**

**Q21. Be neither a borrower nor a lender.**

- (A) Assertive Sentence
- (B) Interrogative Sentence

- (C) Imperative Sentence
- (D) Exclamatory Sentence

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Rule:* This sentence offers moral advice, starting directly with the base form of the verb "be" (with the subject "you" understood).

**Q22. What a beautiful piece of art this is!**

- (A) Exclamatory Sentence
- (B) Assertive Sentence
- (C) Optative Sentence
- (D) Interrogative Sentence

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Rule:* This sentence expresses strong admiration and emotion, uses the introductory phrase "What a," and ends with an exclamation mark.

**Q23. Sreedhar is an exceptionally brilliant student.**

- (A) Imperative Sentence
- (B) Affirmative Assertive Sentence
- (C) Negative Declarative Sentence
- (D) Exclamatory Sentence

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* It states a factual positive claim, making it an assertive sentence in the affirmative form.

**Q24. Why don't you come to class on time?**

- (A) Imperative Advice
- (B) Negative Interrogative Sentence
- (C) Assertive Question
- (D) Exclamatory Question

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* It is structurally an inquiry starting with a question word "Why" and contains the negative contraction "don't," ending with a question mark.

**Q25. Sosin was advised not to talk about her selection.**

- (A) Negative Command
- (B) Passive Declarative Sentence
- (C) Imperative Advice
- (D) Simple Optative Sentence

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* This is a statement reporting an event in the passive voice ("was advised"), which classifies it semantically as an assertive or declarative sentence.

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## **Chapter 3 – Error Detection & Sentence Correction**

This chapter details the high-yield rules of syntax, subject-verb concord, noun usage, relative pronouns, and comparative adjectives. These concepts form the backbone of the "Spot the Error" and "Sentence Improvement" questions in APPSC, SSC, and RRB examinations.



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## 1. Subject-Verb Concord (Agreement) Traps

A **verb must agree with its subject in number and person**. However, examine how the following traps are set up to confuse this rule:

### A. The "Error of Proximity"

Often, the verb is incorrectly made to agree in number with a noun near it (usually in an intervening prepositional phrase) instead of with its true subject.

- *Incorrect:* The quality of the mangoes were not good.
- *Correct:* The quality of the mangoes **was** not good.
  - *Rule:* The grammatical subject is **quality** (singular), not *mangoes* (plural).
- *Incorrect:* His knowledge of Indian vernaculars are far beyond the common.
- *Correct:* His knowledge of Indian vernaculars **is** far beyond the common.
  - *Rule:* The subject is **knowledge** (singular), not *vernaculars*.

### B. Two Singular Nouns Expressing a Single Idea

If two singular nouns connected by *and* express a single collective concept or represent a single item, they require a **singular verb**.

- *Incorrect:* Bread and Butter are essential for one's life.
- *Correct:* Bread and Butter **is** essential for one's life.
- *Correct:* Rice and curry **is** my favourite dish.
- *Correct:* This is the long and the short of the matter.

### C. Parenthetical Connectives (*with, as well as, along with*)

When a singular subject is joined to other nouns or pronouns using words like *with, together with, along with, as well as, besides, in addition to, or except*, these phrases are parenthetical. The **verb must agree with the first (primary) subject**.

- *Incorrect:* He as well as his students have gone there.
- *Correct:* He as well as his students **has** gone there.
- *Correct:* The chairman, with the directors, **is** to be present.
- *Correct:* Silver, as well as cotton, **has** fallen in prices.
- *Correct:* The President of India together with his personal secretaries **is** invited to this function.
- *Correct:* The actress, along with her manager and some friends, **is** attending the function.

### D. Specific Quantities Considered as a Whole

When a plural noun denotes a specific quantity, distance, time, or amount of money considered as a single unified chunk or unit, the **verb is singular**.

- *Incorrect:* Five hours are too short a time to judge one's character.

- *Correct:* Five hours **is** too short a time to judge one's character.
- *Correct:* Ten thousand rupees **is** a large amount.
- *Correct:* Six kilometres **is** not a long distance for a runner like you.

#### E. Distributive Subjects connected by *or* or *nor*

1. When two or more singular subjects are connected by *or* or *nor*, they require a **singular verb**.
  - *Correct:* No nook or corner **was** left unexplored.
  - *Correct:* Our happiness or our sorrow **is** largely due to our own actions.
  - *Correct:* Neither Radha nor Rajani **has** done this mischief.
2. When the subjects joined by *or* or *nor* are of **different numbers**, the verb must be **plural**, and the plural subject must be placed closest to the verb.
  - *Incorrect:* Neither Rekha nor her friends **was** present at the party.
  - *Correct:* Neither Rekha nor her friends **were** present at the party.
  - *Correct:* Either the manager or his assistants **failed** in their duty.
3. When subjects of **different persons** are joined by *or* or *nor*, the verb agrees in person with the **nearest subject**.
  - *Correct:* Neither you nor he **is** to take up this task.
  - *Correct:* Either you or I **am** responsible for this mistake.

#### F. Distributive Pronouns (*Each, Every, Either, Neither, Many a*)

The words *each, every, everyone, either, neither, and many a* must always be followed by a **singular verb**.

- *Correct:* Neither of the two men **was** very strong.
- *Correct:* Every one of the prisons **is** full.
- *Correct:* Many a man **has** done so.
- *Correct:* Every boy and every girl **was** given a packet of sweets.
- *Correct:* Many a delegate **is** attending this seminar.

#### G. "A number of" vs. "The number of"

- **A number of + Plural Noun + Plural Verb** (denotes "many" or "several").
  - *Correct:* A number of students **are** going to the class picnic.
- **The number of + Plural Noun + Singular Verb** (denotes the singular quantitative value of the group).
  - *Correct:* The number of days in a week **is** seven.

#### H. Collective Nouns (The "Jury/Committee" Trap)

Collective nouns (*jury, committee, family, government, army, team, crowd*) can take either a singular or plural verb depending on their conceptual behavior:

1. If the group is acting **harmoniously as a single unit**, the verb is **singular**.
  - *Correct:* After a few hearings the jury **gave its** verdict.
  - *Correct:* The committee **consists** of five members.
  - *Correct:* The Congress **has initiated** a new plan to combat inflation.

2. If the members are **divided, behaving as individuals, or holding conflicting opinions**, the verb is **plural**.
    - *Correct:* The jury **were** divided in **their** opinions.
    - *Correct:* The family living next door **often quarrel** among themselves.
- 

## 2. Noun Number & Form Traps

### A. Identical Singular and Plural Forms

Some nouns possess the exact same form in both singular and plural.

- *Nouns:* Sheep, deer, apparatus, species, series, offspring, aircraft.
- *Incorrect:* The hunters chased many deers in the forest.
- *Correct:* The hunters chased many **deer** in the forest.

### B. Nouns Denoting Large Numbers (*Dozen, Hundred, Thousand*)

*Rule:* When preceded by a specific numerical digit (e.g., *two, three*), these nouns must be written in their **singular form**. If not preceded by a number, they take the **plural form** to show a large indefinite quantity.

- *Correct:* Three **hundred** people attended the function.
- *Correct:* **Hundreds** of people attended the party.
- *Incorrect:* I bought two dozens bananas.
- *Correct:* I bought two **dozen** bananas.

### C. Singular Nouns Looking Plural

Some nouns end in 's' and look plural, but are grammatically **singular and uncountable**.

- *Nouns:* News, politics, mathematics, physics, economics, ethics, summons, innings, measles, mumps.
- *Incorrect:* Since long no news have been heard.
- *Correct:* Since long no news **has** been heard.
- *Correct:* Politics **is** not my cup of tea.
- *Note:* *Summons* is singular; its plural form is *summonses*.
  - *Correct:* I received a **summons** from the court.

### D. Always Plural Nouns

Some nouns have two parts or represent collective components and are **always plural**, requiring a plural verb.

- *Nouns:* Spectacles, trousers, scissors, shears, assets, alms, riches, premises, credentials, earnings, proceeds, archives.
- *Incorrect:* This scissors is not sharp.
- *Correct:* These scissors **are** not sharp.
- *Correct:* The spectacles that you are wearing **are** really nice.

### E. Always Singular (Uncountable) Nouns

These nouns are strictly uncountable. They can **never** be used with an indefinite article (*a/an*), nor can they take a plural form (-s).

- *Nouns:* Furniture, scenery, poetry, information, machinery, advice, luggage, baggage, expenditure, hair, bread, stationery, work, business.
- *Incorrect:* The sceneries of Kashmir are beautiful.
- *Correct:* The **scenery** of Kashmir **is** beautiful.
- *Incorrect:* He gave me many informations.
- *Correct:* He gave me a lot of **information**.
- *Incorrect:* Our office purchased new furnitures.
- *Correct:* Our office purchased new **furniture**.
- *Note:* To express countable quantities of these nouns, use phrases like: *a piece of advice, pieces of furniture, a loaf of bread, a piece of work*.

### F. Nouns with Singular-Plural Meaning Shifts

Choosing the wrong semantic form based on context constitutes a major grammatical error.

| Singular Form Meaning |                             | Plural Form Meaning |                              |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------|
| <b>Content</b>        | Satisfaction, peace of mind | <b>Contents</b>     | Things contained inside      |
| <b>Good</b>           | Moral virtue, benefit       | <b>Goods</b>        | Merchandise, products        |
| <b>Air</b>            | Atmospheric gas             | <b>Airs</b>         | Proud, arrogant behavior     |
| <b>Force</b>          | Physical strength, power    | <b>Forces</b>       | Military, troops             |
| <b>Return</b>         | Coming back to a place      | <b>Returns</b>      | Quantitative reports, profit |

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## 3. Possessive Case Apostrophe 'S' Traps

### A. Inanimate Objects (Non-living Things)

*Rule:* The possessive apostrophe 's must only be used with **living things** and **personified objects**. It should **never** be used with non-living or inanimate objects; instead, the preposition *of* must be used.

- *Incorrect:* Table's leg, Book's cover
- *Correct:* **Leg of the table, Cover of the book**
- *Exceptions:* Time, distance, or weight nouns can take 's.
  - *Correct:* A stone's throw, in a year's time, the earth's surface.

### B. Hissing Sounds (Ending in 's' / 'ce' / 'z')

*Rule:* For singular nouns ending with a hissing sound, or plural nouns ending in 's', add **only an apostrophe (')** and omit the extra 's'.

- *Correct:* Moses' laws, for goodness' sake, for justice' sake, Jesus' sake.
- *Correct:* Girls' hostel, Boys' school.

- *Correct:* Men's club, Children's park (Since they do not end in 's', add 's').

### C. Compound Nouns / Multi-word Nouns

*Rule:* The possessive sign is attached **only to the last word** of the compound unit.

- *Incorrect:* The Queen's of England reaction is important.
- *Correct:* The **Queen of England's** reaction is important.
- *Correct:* **Sister-in-law's** house, **Commander-in-chief's** office.

### D. Joint vs. Separate Possession

1. **Joint Possession:** If two nouns share ownership of the same entity, apply 's to the **latter noun only**.
  - *Correct:* **Amitabh and Ajitabh's** father is Bachchanji.
  - *Correct:* **Amar and Kumar's** house is really beautiful. (The house belongs to both jointly).
2. **Separate Possession:** If two nouns own separate, distinct entities, apply 's to **both nouns**.
  - *Correct:* The audience listened to **Javed's and Vajpayee's** poems. (They wrote separate poems).

## 4. Pronoun Case, Order, and Antecedent Traps

### A. Personal Pronoun Ordering (231 vs. 123)

*Rule:* When pronouns of different persons are combined in a single sentence:

1. For **pleasant, polite, positive, or neutral** context: Use the order **Second Person (2) → Third Person (3) → First Person (1)**.
  - *Incorrect:* I, you, and he will get an award.
  - *Correct:* **You, he, and I** will get an award for the good work we have done.
2. For **confessing a fault, taking blame, or discussing a mistake/unpleasant situation:** Use the order **First Person (1) → Second Person (2) → Third Person (3)**.
  - *Incorrect:* You, he, and I are in the wrong and will be punished.
  - *Correct:* **I, you, and he** are in the wrong and will be punished.

### B. Case Traps: Subjective vs. Objective

1. **Complement of "Be" Verbs:** Pronouns acting as complements to verbs of the *be* family (*is, am, are, was, were*) must be written in the **nominative (subjective) case**.
  - *Incorrect:* It was him who solved the problem.
  - *Correct:* It was **he** (not him) who solved the problem.
  - *Correct:* It is **I** (not me) that gave the prizes away.
2. **Case after "Than" and "As":** The case depends on the ellipted clause that follows the conjunction.
  - *Correct:* He is taller than **I** (am).

- *Correct:* He loves you more than **I** (love you). (Subjective case)
- *Correct:* He loves you more than (he loves) **me**. (Objective case)
- 3. **Case after "Let" and Prepositions:** Prepositions and the verb "let" always govern pronouns in the **objective case**.
  - *Incorrect:* Let you and I do it.
  - *Correct:* Let you and **me** do it.
  - *Correct:* These clothes are for you and **me** (not I).

### C. The Indefinite Pronoun "One"

*Rule:* If the indefinite pronoun *one* is used as the subject, its possessive modifier must be **one's** (never *his* or *her*).

- *Incorrect:* One must put his best efforts if he wishes to succeed.
- *Correct:* One must put **one's** best efforts if **one** wishes to succeed.
- *Correct:* One should be careful about what **one** says.

### D. Relative Pronoun Concord with Antecedents

When a relative pronoun (*who*, *that*, *which*) is the subject of a subordinate clause, the verb must agree in number and person with the **noun antecedent** to which the pronoun refers.

- *Incorrect:* This is one of the most interesting novels that has appeared this year.
- *Correct:* This is one of the most interesting novels that **have** appeared this year.
  - *Analysis:* The antecedent of "that" is the plural noun "novels," not "one." Thus, the verb must be plural ("have").
- *Incorrect:* This is the only one of his poems that are worth reading.
- *Correct:* This is the only one of his poems that **is** worth reading.
  - *Analysis:* The phrase "the only one" forces a singular focus, making "one" the logical antecedent. Thus, the verb is singular ("is").

## 5. Adjective & Adverb Comparative Traps

### A. The "Any Other" Comparative Exclusion Rule

In a comparative sentence, the term compared must be excluded from the class of things with which it is compared by using the word **other**.

- *Incorrect:* Delhi is bigger than any city in India.
- *Correct:* Delhi is bigger than **any other** city in India.
  - *Superlative Contrast:* In a superlative structure, the object is included, so "other" is omitted: *Delhi is the biggest of all cities in India.*

### B. Comparative "is/are" ending adjectives taking "to"

Comparative adjectives ending in *-ior* or *-or* are followed by the preposition **to** instead of the conjunction *than*.

- *Adjectives:* Superior, inferior, senior, junior, prior, anterior, posterior.
- *Incorrect:* Akshay is inferior than Aamir in intelligence.
- *Correct:* Akshay is **inferior to** Aamir in intelligence.
- *Correct:* He is **junior to** me.
- *Correct:* Coffee is **preferable to** tea. (Do not use "more preferable").

### C. Uncomparable (Superlative-meaning) Adjectives

Certain adjectives represent absolute states and **cannot take degrees of comparison** (e.g., *more, most, very*).

- *Adjectives:* Unique, perfect, ideal, complete, universal, round, square, eternal, chief, extreme, entire, full.
- *Incorrect:* This is the most unique specimen I have ever seen.
- *Correct:* This is **a unique** specimen I have ever seen.

### D. Gradual Increase representation

*Rule:* A continuous or gradual increase in state must be represented by **two comparative adjectives** connected by *and*, not positive ones.

- *Incorrect:* It grew hot and hot.
- *Correct:* It grew **hotter and hotter**.

### E. Modifier Traps: *Too Much* vs. *Much Too*

- **Too much** is an adjective phrase and must modify **nouns**.
- **Much too** is an adverb phrase and must modify **adjectives**.
- *Incorrect:* His failure is too much painful for me.
- *Correct:* His failure is **much too painful** (adjective) for me.
- *Incorrect:* His wife's rude behavior gives him much too pain.
- *Correct:* His wife's rude behavior gives him **too much pain** (noun).

## Top 25 Expected MCQs: Previous APPSC/SSC/RRB-Style Questions

**Directions (Q1–Q10):** Identify the part containing the grammatical error.

**Q1. The quality of (A) / the newly harvested mangoes (B) / were not up to (C) / the expected standard. (D)**

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Grounded Rule:* "Error of Proximity". The grammatical subject is the singular noun "quality", not the plural "mangoes". Replace "were" with **was**.

**Q2. The chairman, with (A) / all the directors of the board, (B) / have arrived at the venue (C) / for the meeting. (D)**

- **Correct Answer: (C)**

- *Grounded Rule:* Parenthetical connectives. When singular subjects are joined by "with", the verb must agree with the first subject ("The chairman"). Replace "have arrived" with **has arrived**.

**Q3. Five hours are (A) / too short a duration (B) / to thoroughly evaluate (C) / any candidate's technical skills. (D)**

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Specific quantities. Plural nouns representing a unified period of time or distance are treated as singular. Replace "Five hours are" with **Five hours is**.

**Q4. Neither Sreedhar nor (A) / his close associates (B) / was present to receive (C) / the distinguished guests at the gate. (D)**

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Subjects connected by "neither...nor". When subjects of different numbers are joined, the verb must agree with the plural subject placed closest to it. Replace "was present" with **were present**.

**Q5. Every boy and (A) / every girl (B) / were given (C) / a beautiful book as a prize. (D)**

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Subjects qualified by each/every. Two nouns connected by "and" but qualified by "every" require a singular verb. Replace "were given" with **was given**.

**Q6. The jury was (A) / highly divided in (B) / their opinions regarding (C) / the final verdict of the case. (D)**

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Collective Nouns Split. When members of a collective noun ("jury") hold different opinions or act separately, a plural verb must be used. Replace "was" with **were**.

**Q7. The magistrate has (A) / issued a summons (B) / asking him to (C) / attend the court session. (D)**

- **Correct Answer: (D) / No Error**
- *Grounded Rule:* Singular looks plural. "Summons" is singular, and "a summons" is correct. Thus, the sentence contains **No Error**.

**Q8. The sceneries of (A) / Kashmir are (B) / exceptionally beautiful (C) / during the spring season. (D)**

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Always singular nouns. "Scenery" is uncountable and can never take a plural form ("sceneries"). Replace "The sceneries of" with **The scenery of**.

**Q9. Our department (A) / has purchased (B) / several new furnitures (C) / for the executive cabins. (D)**



- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Uncountable nouns. "Furniture" cannot be pluralized with "-s". Replace "furnitures" with **furniture**.

**Q10. This beautiful novel (A) / comprises of (B) / five highly interesting (C) / and informative chapters. (D)**

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Diction and Preposition. The verb "comprise" directly takes an object and should never be followed by "of". Replace "comprises of" with **comprises** or **consists of**.

**Directions (Q11–Q18): Select the option that best improves the bold part. If no improvement is required, choose (D).**

**Q11. Let you and I resolve this dispute amicably.**

- (A) me
- (B) we
- (C) mine
- (D) No improvement

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Case after Let. The verb "let" must always be followed by the objective case ("me").

**Q12. Sreedhar is senior *than me* by four years in the college.**

- (A) than I
- (B) to me
- (C) to I
- (D) No improvement

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Comparative ending in '-ior'. Adjectives like senior and superior must be followed by "to". Replace with **to me**.

**Q13. I would prefer to have coffee *than* tea.**

- (A) to
- (B) rather than
- (C) over
- (D) No improvement

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Preferable/Prefer. The word "prefer" is followed by the preposition "to". Replace with **to**.

**Q14. The population of Hyderabad is greater than *any city* in Andhra Pradesh.**

- (A) than that of any city
- (B) than any other city

- (C) than those of any city
- (D) No improvement

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Logical Comparison. We must compare "the population of Hyderabad" with "the population of any other city," not the physical city itself. Replace with **that of any city**.

**Q15. She is one of the most intelligent students that *has* ever studied in this school.**

- (A) have
- (B) had
- (C) having
- (D) No improvement

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Relative Pronoun Concord. The antecedent of "that" is the plural noun "students," requiring the plural auxiliary verb **have**.

**Q16. One must perform *his* duties sincerely if he wants to succeed.**

- (A) her
- (B) one's
- (C) our
- (D) No improvement

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Indefinite pronoun "one". The possessive of "one" is strictly **one's**.

**Q17. The weather was *too much hot* for us to go out for a walk.**

- (A) much too hot
- (B) so hot much
- (C) hot too much
- (D) No improvement

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Adjective Modifiers. "Hot" is an adjective. To modify an adjective, use the adverb phrase **much too**.

**Q18. He was punished by the school authorities for coming *lately* to class.**

- (A) late
- (B) later
- (C) latest
- (D) No improvement

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Late vs Lately. "Lately" means recently. For time, use the adverb **late**.

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**Directions (Q19–Q25): Fill in the blanks with the most appropriate word/phrase.**

**Q19. The patient had died \_\_\_\_\_ the doctor arrived.**

- (A) when
- (B) before
- (C) since
- (D) after

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Grounded Rule:* Double past actions. The earlier past action is represented in Past Perfect ("patient had died") and the subsequent action in Simple Past. They are joined by **before**.

**Q20. He worked hard lest he \_\_\_\_\_ fail in the final examination.**

- (A) will
- (B) should
- (C) might
- (D) would

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Grounded Rule:* Lest pairing. "Lest" is paired with the auxiliary verb **should**.

**Q21. Radha is highly \_\_\_\_\_ and maintains extremely \_\_\_\_\_ relations with everyone.**

- (A) amicable, amiable
- (B) amiable, amicable
- (C) friendly, amiable
- (D) amicable, friendly

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Grounded Rule:* Word choice. "Amiable" refers to friendly persons; "amicable" refers to friendly relations/agreements.

**Q22. He has been suffering from fever \_\_\_\_\_ last Monday.**

- (A) for
- (B) since
- (C) from
- (D) until

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Grounded Rule:* Since vs For. "Last Monday" is a specific point of time, which requires the preposition **since**.

**Q23. He is \_\_\_\_\_ enough to handle this difficult task independently.**

- (A) more intelligent
- (B) intelligent
- (C) most intelligent
- (D) highly intelligent

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Grounded Rule:* Enough Modifier. "Enough" must be preceded by an adjective in its positive form. Thus, choose **intelligent**.

**Q24. No sooner did the school bell ring \_\_\_\_\_ all the students ran out.**

- (A) when
- (B) than
- (C) then
- (D) before

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Grounded Rule:* No sooner pairing. "No sooner" must be paired with the conjunction **than**.

**Q25. I met Radha yesterday; she looked highly \_\_\_\_\_ by the news.**

- (A) very pleased
- (B) much pleased
- (C) pleased very
- (D) more pleased

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Grounded Rule:* Much with Participles. Derived adjectives/past participles like *pleased* are modified by **much**, not "very".

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## Artifact Details

I have compiled this complete chapter with formatted rule sections and the full practice bank into the Studio panel as `chapter-3-error-detection.md`.

👉 **Would you like to move on to Chapter 4 – Fill in the Blanks & Word Usage?** In that chapter, we will synthesize preposition usage rules, coordinate and correlative conjunction pairing, modal verbs, and common diction traps (confused words) from your notes

## Chapter 4 – Fill in the Blanks & Word Usage

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### 1. Prepositions & Contextual Traps

A **preposition** is a word placed before a noun or a pronoun to show the relationship of that person or thing to something else. Mastering prepositions requires learning specific structural rules and idiomatic combinations rather than translating directly from a native language.

#### A. Spatial and Relational Prepositions

##### 1. **Between vs. Among vs. Amid / Amidst:**

- **Between:** Strictly used when referring to **two** distinct persons, objects, or entities.
  - *Correct:* The match will be played **between** India and Australia.

- *Correct:* Distribute these sweets **between** the two children.
  - **Among:** Used for more than two persons or objects.
    - *Correct:* The principal distributed prizes **among** the winners.
    - *Correct:* **Among** those five students, Sreedhar is the most brilliant.
  - **Amid / Amidst:** Used for groups, masses, or uncountables where individual elements are not distinct.
    - *Correct:* It was hard to hear **amid** all the cheering.
    - *Correct:* He stood **amidst** his friends.
2. **Beside vs. Besides:**
- **Beside:** Means "by the side of" or physically close to.
    - *Correct:* He sat **beside** me.
    - *Correct:* My house is **beside** the Kali temple.
  - **Besides:** Means "in addition to" or "moreover".
    - *Correct:* **Besides** his children, his nephews and nieces were also present.
    - *Correct:* **Besides** English, we are taught French.
3. **In vs. Into:**
- **In:** Denotes rest or a stationary position inside a defined area.
    - *Correct:* We are sitting **in** the classroom.
    - *Correct:* She is **in** the garden.
  - **Into:** Denotes motion, movement, or transition from outside to inside.
    - *Correct:* The boy jumped **into** the river.
    - *Correct:* Thieves broke **into** my friend's house.
4. **On vs. Upon:**
- **On:** Used for things at rest on a surface.
    - *Correct:* The book is **on** the table.
  - **Upon:** Used for things in motion directed toward a surface.
    - *Correct:* The cat jumped **upon** the rat.
    - *Correct:* The tiger sprang **upon** the goat.
5. **Before vs. In Front Of:**
- **Before:** Refers to temporal order ("prior to") or facing someone in a formal setting.
    - *Correct:* I came **before** you.
    - *Correct:* India raised the issue of cross-border terrorism **before** the U.N.
  - **In front of:** Refers purely to physical spatial placement.
    - *Correct:* Don't park your car **in front of** my gate.

## B. Time and Place Prepositions (*At, In, On*)

1. **At:**
- *Place:* Used for small or specific points, addresses, or localities.
    - *Correct:* I live **at** Mukherji Nagar in Delhi.
  - *Time:* Used for exact hours, specific points of day, and religious festivals.
    - *Correct:* **at** 10 a.m., **at** noon, **at** midnight, **at** dawn, **at** sunset.
2. **In:**
- *Place:* Used for large geographical areas, countries, cities, or continents.
    - *Correct:* I live at Mukherji Nagar **in** Delhi.
  - *Time:* Used for months, years, seasons, and centuries.
    - *Correct:* **in** May, **in** 2005, **in** summer, **in** the morning, **in** the evening.

### 3. On:

- *Time:* Used for specific days and calendar dates.
  - *Correct:* **on** Monday, **on** 7th September, **on** Sunday morning.

## C. Transitive Verb Trap: No Preposition Allowed

Transitive verbs take their objects directly. **Never insert a preposition between these verbs and their direct objects:**

- *Verbs:* Discuss, describe, reach, order, tell, demand, attach, resemble, ridicule, enter, comprise, await.
- *Incorrect:* The poet describes about the beauty of nature.
- *Correct:* The poet **describes** the beauty of nature.
- *Incorrect:* He ordered for two cups of tea.
- *Correct:* He **ordered** two cups of tea.
- *Incorrect:* The team reached at the stadium on time.
- *Correct:* The team **reached** the stadium on time.
- *Incorrect:* This book comprises of five chapters.
- *Correct:* This book **comprises** five chapters.
  - *Note:* "Comprise" does not take a preposition, but **consist** must be followed by **of**.
    - *Correct:* This book **consists of** five chapters.
- *Incorrect:* He is awaiting for the reply.
- *Correct:* He is **awaiting** the reply.
  - *Note:* **Wait** requires **for**, but **await** takes no preposition.
    - *Correct:* He is **waiting for** the reply.
- *Incorrect:* He entered into the premises without permission.
- *Correct:* He **entered** the premises without permission.
  - *Exception:* Use **enter into** when referring to agreements, pacts, partnerships, or hot discussions.
    - *Correct:* They **entered into** a hot discussion.

## D. Preposition of Time Shift: *Since* vs. *For*

- **Since:** Used to denote a **specific starting point of time** in the past.
  - *Correct:* since 2011, since Monday, since morning, since last week.
- **For:** Used to denote a **span or period of duration**.
  - *Correct:* for the past 3 years, for two hours, for ten days, for a long time.
- *Tense Constraint:* Both must be used with perfect or perfect continuous tenses.
  - *Incorrect:* I know her since 2011.
  - *Correct:* I **have known** her since 2011.
  - *Incorrect:* He is working in this bank for three years.
  - *Correct:* He **has been working** in this bank for three years.

## E. Other Crucial Prepositional Rules

### 1. In Spite Of vs. Despite:

- *In spite of* takes the preposition "of".
- *Despite* must **never** be followed by "of".
- *Incorrect:* Despite of his hard work, he failed.

- *Correct:* **Despite** his hard work, he failed.
  - *Correct:* **In spite of** working hard, he failed.
  - 2. **Die of vs. Die from:**
    - **Die of:** Used when death is caused directly by a disease, hunger, or thirst.
      - *Correct:* He **died of** cancer.
      - *Correct:* He **died of** Malaria.
    - **Die from:** Used when death is caused by external circumstances or overwork.
      - *Correct:* He **died from** thirst / overwork.
      - *Correct:* He **died in** an accident.
  - 3. **Dispose of vs. Dispose off:**
    - *Incorrect:* He disposed off his old scooter.
    - *Correct:* He **disposed of** his old scooter. (Note: single 'f').
  - 4. **Double Prepositions in Coordinate Structures:**
    - If a sentence connects two verbs or adjectives that require different prepositions, **both prepositions must be explicitly mentioned.**
    - *Incorrect:* He was surprised and pleased with her performance.
    - *Correct:* He was **surprised at** as well as **pleased with** her performance.
    - *Incorrect:* She is conscious and engaged in her work.
    - *Correct:* She is **conscious of** and **engaged in** her work.
- 

## 2. Conjunction Pairing & Double Negative Traps

A **conjunction** is a word that connects words, phrases, or clauses. The most common exam traps involve coordinate, correlative, and subordinating pairings.

### A. Correlative Conjunction Pairs

Correlative conjunctions work in strict, invariable pairs. **Never mix or swap their parts:**

- **Not Only → but also**
- **Either → or**
- **Neither → nor**
- **Both → and**
- **Though / Although → yet**
- **Whether → or**

*Examples of Errors:*

- *Incorrect:* Both Kumar as well as Ravi must finish it.
- *Correct:* **Both** Kumar **and** Ravi must finish it.
- *Incorrect:* Though he is rich, but he is economical.
- *Correct:* **Though** he is rich, **yet** he is economical.
- *Incorrect:* They will either do the work else return the money.
- *Correct:* They will **either** do the work **or** return the money.

### B. Negative Conjunction Double-Negative Traps

The words **Lest**, **Until**, and **Unless** are inherently negative. **Do not use the adverb "not" in the subordinate clause governed by them.**

1. **Lest:** Means "for fear that".
  - *Rule:* *Lest* must be paired with the auxiliary **should**.
  - *Incorrect:* Work hard lest you will fail.
  - *Correct:* Work hard **lest** you **should** fail.
  - *Incorrect:* Hurry up lest you should not miss the train. (Double negative).
  - *Correct:* Hurry up **lest** you **should miss** the train.
2. **Until vs. Unless:**
  - **Until:** Denotes a limit of **time**.
  - **Unless:** Denotes a **condition**.
  - *Incorrect:* You will not succeed until you work hard. (Hard work is a condition, not a time limit).
  - *Correct:* You will not succeed **unless** you work hard.
  - *Incorrect:* I want to stay here unless she speaks the truth.
  - *Correct:* I want to stay here **until** she speaks the truth.
3. **No "Not" with Until / Unless:**
  - *Incorrect:* Unless they do not work sincerely, they will not succeed.
  - *Correct:* **Unless** they **work** sincerely, they will not succeed.
  - *Incorrect:* Until he does not solve this problem, I will stay with him.
  - *Correct:* **Until** he **solves** this problem, I will stay with him.

### C. Adverbial Conjunction Pairings

1. **Hardly / Scarcely → When / Before:**
  - These adverbs of negative frequency must be followed by **when** or **before** (never "than" or "then").
  - *Incorrect:* Hardly had he left the place than the bomb exploded.
  - *Correct:* **Hardly** had he left the place **when** the bomb exploded.
2. **No Sooner → Than:**
  - *No sooner* must always be paired with the comparative conjunction **than**.
  - *Incorrect:* No sooner does the school bell ring when the boys leave.
  - *Correct:* **No sooner** does the school bell ring **than** all the boys go to their classrooms.
3. **Rather / Other → Than:**
  - *Rather* and *other* express comparison or preference and require **than**.
  - *Incorrect:* He has no other object but to get a job.
  - *Correct:* He has no **other** object **than** to get a handsome job.
  - *Incorrect:* I would rather buy a scooter but not a cycle.
  - *Correct:* I would **rather** buy a scooter **than** a cycle.

### D. The "Since" Tense Conjunction Rule

When **since** is used as a conjunction of time to connect two clauses:

- The preceding main clause must be in the **Present Perfect Tense**.
- The succeeding subordinate clause must be in the **Simple Past Tense**.
- *Incorrect:* Many things have happened since I have left the school.



- *Correct:* Many things **have happened** (Present Perfect) **since** I **left** (Simple Past) the school.

### E. The "If... Then" Redundancy

In conditional sentences, if you begin with the subordinating conjunction **if**, do not use the coordinate adverb **then** to introduce the main clause.

- *Incorrect:* If you work hard, then you will succeed.
- *Correct:* **If** you work hard, you will succeed.

## 3. Modal Auxiliaries & Precise Meanings

Modals are auxiliary verbs that express the speaker's attitude or mode of action (ability, obligation, permission, possibility, etc.).

### A. Can vs. Could

#### 1. Can:

- *Ability / Capacity:* Expresses present mental or physical power.
  - *Correct:* I **can** teach mathematics.
  - *Correct:* He **can** run fast.
- *Possibility:* Expresses factual or general possibility.
  - *Correct:* Accidents **can** happen everywhere.

#### 2. Could:

- *Past Ability:* Represents general ability in past time.
  - *Correct:* I **could** speak English when I was only five years old.
- *Polite Request:* Used in interrogative form to make a soft request.
  - *Correct:* **Could** you lend me your pen?
- *Unfulfilled Past Possibility (could + have + V3):* Denotes an action that was possible in the past but did not occur.
  - *Correct:* She **could have passed** the examination.
  - *Correct:* He **could have caught** the train.

### B. May vs. Might

#### 1. May:

- *Formal Permission:* Seeking or granting permission respectfully.
  - *Correct:* **May** I come in, sir? (Formal)
- *Factual Possibility:* High or realistic possibility based on current facts.
  - *Correct:* There are clouds in the sky. It **may** rain tonight.
- *Wish / Hope:* Expresses blessings, wishes, or curses.
  - *Correct:* **May** you live long!
- *Purpose:* Expresses purpose when paired with "so that".
  - *Correct:* We eat so that we **may** live.

#### 2. Might:

- *Remote / Weak Possibility:* Very low chance of occurrence.
  - *Correct:* The sky is clear now. It **might** rain tonight.

- *Hesitant Permission*: Seeking permission with extreme politeness or hesitation.
  - *Correct*: **Might** I take your pen?
- *Past Purpose*: Used when the principal verb is in the past tense.
  - *Correct*: He took medicines so that he **might** get well.

### C. Should vs. Must

#### 1. Should:

- *Advice / Suggestion*: Soft recommendation.
  - *Correct*: We **should** take a bath daily.
- *Moral Duty*: Expresses social or moral obligation.
  - *Correct*: We **should** always speak the truth.

#### 2. Must:

- *Compulsion / Command*: Absolute necessity or obligation.
  - *Correct*: We **must** reach school on time to avoid punishment.
- *Strong Logical Inference*: Drawing an inescapable conclusion.
  - *Correct*: He has three luxury cars. He **must** be a rich man.

### D. Will vs. Shall

#### • Simple Future (Standard):

- **Shall** is used with First Person (*I, We*).
- **Will** is used with Second/Third Person (*You, He, She, It, They*).

#### • Modal Shift (Promise, Threat, Determination, Willingness):

- **Will** is used with First Person (*I, We*).
  - *Promise*: We **will** help you.
  - *Threat*: I **will** punish you if you do this again.
- **Shall** is used with Second/Third Person (*You, He, They*).
  - *Promise*: You **shall** get a prize for your bravery.
  - *Threat / Command*: He **shall** be punished if he doesn't behave.

### E. Would

1. **Polite Offer or Request**: Superior to "will" for formal courtesy.
  - *Correct*: **Would** you lend me your pen?
  - *Correct*: **Would** you like to have tea with me? (Invitation).
2. **Past Habits / Repeated Past Happenings**: Matches "used to".
  - *Correct*: Sometimes my father **would** get angry with me.
3. **Unfulfilled Wish**: Used to express deep regret or imaginary desire.
  - *Correct*: **Would** that I had become a minister! (Meaning: I wish I had been).

## Top 25 Expected MCQs: Previous APPSC/SSC/RRB-Style Questions

**Directions (Q1–Q10):** Fill in the blanks with the most appropriate preposition.

**Q1.** The old businessman decided to dispose \_\_\_\_\_ his ancestral property as he was leaving the country.

- (A) off
- (B) of
- (C) out
- (D) away

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* "Dispose of" (with a single 'f') is the correct phrasal verb meaning to sell off or get rid of. "Dispose off" is incorrect.

**Q2. Despite \_\_\_\_\_ several warnings, the mischievous boy entered the prohibited area.**

- (A) of
- (B) with
- (C) for
- (D) No preposition required

- **Correct Answer: (D)**
- *Explanation:* "Despite" is a preposition that must never be followed by "of". If "In spite" were used, "of" would be required.

**Q3. Sreedhar has been suffering from Malaria and has been hospitalized \_\_\_\_\_ last Friday.**

- (A) for
- (B) from
- (C) since
- (D) during

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* Since denotes a specific starting point in time ("last Friday"), whereas "for" denotes a duration.

**Q4. The poet spent hours sitting \_\_\_\_\_ the bank of the river, describing \_\_\_\_\_ the beauty of nature.**

- (A) on, about
- (B) beside, about
- (C) beside, no preposition required
- (D) along, for

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* "Beside" means by the side of. "Describe" is a transitive verb and takes its object directly without any preposition like "about".

**Q5. The principal distributed the examination hall tickets \_\_\_\_\_ all the eligible candidates.**

- (A) between
- (B) among
- (C) amidst
- (D) with

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Explanation:* "Among" is used for distributing things to more than two persons. "Between" is restricted to two.

**Q6. No sooner did the manager enter \_\_\_\_\_ the cabin than his subordinates stood up.**

- (A) into
- (B) to
- (C) inside
- (D) No preposition required

- **Correct Answer: (D)**
- *Explanation:* "Enter" is a transitive verb that directly takes the physical space as an object without "into". "Enter into" is used only for discussions, agreements, or contracts.

**Q7. The administrative office is currently awaiting \_\_\_\_\_ the clearance from the municipal board.**

- (A) for
- (B) of
- (C) on
- (D) No preposition required

- **Correct Answer: (D)**
- *Explanation:* "Await" does not take a preposition. "Wait" is followed by "for".

**Q8. The brave soldier died \_\_\_\_\_ cancer after fighting \_\_\_\_\_ his country for decades.**

- (A) of, for
- (B) from, with
- (C) in, at
- (D) with, about

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation:* Direct death from disease requires "die of".

**Q9. Radha was both surprised \_\_\_\_\_ and pleased \_\_\_\_\_ her sister's magnificent academic success.**

- (A) at, with
- (B) with, at
- (C) on, by
- (D) of, with

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation:* In coordinate structures, different verbs require their respective prepositions: "surprised at" and "pleased with".

**Q10. I usually go to my workplace \_\_\_\_\_ my bicycle, but today I decided to go \_\_\_\_\_ foot.**

- (A) by, on
- (B) on, by

- (C) in, with
- (D) through, on

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
  - *Explanation:* Transportation mode takes "by", while walking takes "on foot".
- 

**Directions (Q11–Q18): Fill in the blanks with the most appropriate conjunction.**

**Q11. Run fast \_\_\_\_\_ you should miss the train.**

- (A) or
- (B) but
- (C) lest
- (D) unless

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* "Lest" is grammatically paired with the auxiliary verb "should" to express fear of an outcome.

**Q12. You will not be allowed to enter the exam hall \_\_\_\_\_ you present your hall ticket.**

- (A) until
- (B) unless
- (C) till
- (D) whether

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* Presenting a hall ticket is a condition, which requires the conditional conjunction "unless". "Until" is reserved for time limits.

**Q13. Many significant administrative changes \_\_\_\_\_ since the new director \_\_\_\_\_ charge.**

- (A) occurred, has taken
- (B) have occurred, took
- (C) had occurred, had taken
- (D) are occurring, takes

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* The conjunction "since" must be preceded by the Present Perfect Tense ("have occurred") and followed by the Simple Past Tense ("took").

**Q14. Scarcely had Sreedhar finished his coding \_\_\_\_\_ the power supply went off.**

- (A) than
- (B) when
- (C) then
- (D) before

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Explanation:* "Scarcely" and "Hardly" are followed by the conjunction "when" (or "before").

**Q15. Both Radha \_\_\_\_\_ Rajani are invited to perform at the state cultural festival.**

- (A) as well as
- (B) and
- (C) along with
- (D) or

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* The correlative conjunction "Both" must always be paired with "and". Using "as well as" is incorrect.

**Q16. If you complete the project on time, \_\_\_\_\_ you will be promoted.**

- (A) then
- (B) than
- (C) so
- (D) No word required

- **Correct Answer: (D)**
- *Explanation:* When an "if" clause introduces a conditional sentence, the main clause must not be introduced by "then". A comma is sufficient.

**Q17. The weather was such a stormy \_\_\_\_\_ we could not step out of our resort.**

- (A) that
- (B) what
- (C) than
- (D) as

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation:* "Such" is paired with "that" to express a consequence.

**Q18. I have never spoken to him \_\_\_\_\_ written to him regarding this matter.**

- (A) nor
- (B) or
- (C) but
- (D) either

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* After "not" or "never," use the coordinating conjunction "or" instead of "nor".

**Directions (Q19–Q25): Fill in the blanks with the most appropriate modal verb.**

**Q19. He has three bungalows in the city and a luxury sedan; he \_\_\_\_\_ be an extremely wealthy man.**

- (A) can

- (B) should
- (C) must
- (D) may

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* To express strong logical inference or an inescapable conclusion, "must" is the correct modal.

**Q20. \_\_\_\_\_ that I had been present at the historical meeting to witness the event!**

- (A) Would
- (B) Should
- (C) Could
- (D) May

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation:* "Would that" is an idiomatic modal structure used to express a strong, unfulfilled past wish.

**Q21. The sky is completely clear; however, a localized storm \_\_\_\_\_ occur later.**

- (A) may
- (B) might
- (C) must
- (D) shall

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* A clear sky indicates an extremely weak or remote possibility, which is represented by "might". "May" represents a strong factual possibility.

**Q22. Sreedhar worked exceptionally hard so that he \_\_\_\_\_ secure the first rank in the university.**

- (A) may
- (B) can
- (C) might
- (D) must

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* The principal verb is in the past tense ("worked"), so the subordinate clause expressing purpose must use the past modal "might" instead of "may".

**Q23. \_\_\_\_\_ you please hold this baggage for a moment while I get the tickets?**

- (A) Should
- (B) Shall
- (C) Would
- (D) Must

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* "Would you" is the standard polite request form in present time.

**Q24. If you violate the rules of the road, you \_\_\_\_\_ be heavily fined by the police.**

- (A) should

- (B) shall
- (C) might
- (D) can

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* "Shall" used with a second/third person subject (*you*) denotes a strong threat, warning, or official regulation.

**Q25. She was highly talented; she \_\_\_\_\_ won the singing competition easily, but she fell ill.**

- (A) must have
- (B) should have
- (C) could have
- (D) might have

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* "Could have + V3" represents past unfulfilled ability—she had the capacity, but the action did not occur.

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## Artifact Details

I have compiled this complete chapter with formatted rule sections and the full practice bank into your Studio panel as `chapter-4-word-usage.md`.

🔖 **Would you like to move on to Chapter 5 – Spellings?** In that chapter, we will synthesize high-yield rules for suffix additions, silent letters, and commonly mis-spelt words that appear in competitive exams.

## Chapter 5 – Spellings

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### 1. Core Grammatical Rules of English Spellings

Spelling errors in competitive examinations (APPSC, SSC, RRB) are seldom random. They generally exploit specific phonetic traps, silent letters, or structural changes that occur when suffixes are attached to root words.

#### A. The "I before E, except after C" Rule

- **The Rule:** In words containing the /i:/ (long "ee") sound, **i** precedes **e** (e.g., *achieve, believe, chief, thief, yield*). However, if this sound immediately follows the letter **c**, the order is reversed to **e** before **i** (e.g., *ceiling, conceit, deceit, deceive, perceive, receive*).
- **The Sound Exception:** If the vowel combination makes an /eɪ/ (long "ay") sound (as in *neighbor* or *weigh*), it is spelt **ei** (e.g., *reign, veil, vein, freight, sleigh*).



- **The Absolute Exceptions (High-Yield):** Some words violate this rule entirely and must be memorized:
  - *Seize* (spelt **ei** despite the /i:/ sound without a preceding 'c')
  - *Weird* (spelt **ei**)
  - *Height* (spelt **ei**)
  - *Foreign* (spelt **ei**)
  - *Sovereign* (spelt **ei**)
  - *Forfeit* (spelt **ei**)
  - *Counterfeit* (spelt **ei**)

## B. Suffix Rule I: Doubling the Final Consonant

When adding a suffix beginning with a vowel (such as *-ed*, *-ing*, *-er*, *-est*, *-ence*, *-able*) to a word:

1. **Single-Syllable Words:** If the word ends in a single consonant preceded by a single vowel (C-V-C pattern), **double the final consonant**.
  - *Examples:*
    - Run → Running / Runner
    - Hop → Hopped / Hopping
    - Sad → Sadder / Saddest
2. **Multi-Syllable Words (The Stress/Accent Rule):** If the word has more than one syllable, double the final consonant **only if the stress falls on the last syllable**.
  - *Stress on the last syllable (Double it):*
    - Re-fer' → Referred / Referral / Referring
    - Oc-cur' → Occurred / Occurrence
    - Be-gin' → Beginning / Beginner
    - Ad-mit' → Admitted / Admitting
  - *Stress NOT on the last syllable (Do NOT double):*
    - Ben'-e-fit → Benefited / Benefiting
    - Of'-fer → Offered / Offering
    - Dif'-fer → Differed / Different
    - Fo'-cus → Focused / Focusing

## C. Suffix Rule II: Dropping the Silent 'E'

When adding a suffix to a word ending in a silent **e**:

1. **Suffix begins with a Vowel:** Drop the silent **e**.
  - *Examples:*
    - Write + ing → Writing
    - Hope + ed → Hoped
    - Hope + ing → Hoping
    - Receive + er → Receiver
    - Deceive + ing → Deceiving
2. **Suffix begins with a Consonant:** Retain the silent **e**.
  - *Examples:*
    - Hope + ful → Hopeful
    - Sincere + ly → Sincerely
    - Manage + ment → Management

### 3. High-Yield Exceptions:

- *Argument* (Drop the 'e' from *argue* + *ment*)
- *Judgment* / *Judgement* (Both are acceptable, but *judgment* is preferred in standard exams)
- *Truly* (Drop the 'e' from *true* + *ly*)
- *Awful* (Drop the 'e' from *awe* + *ful*)
- *Noticeable* / *Changeable* (Retain the 'e' to preserve the soft /s/ or /dʒ/ sound of 'c' or 'g' before 'a' or 'o')

## D. Suffix Rule III: Changing 'Y' to 'I'

When adding a suffix to a word ending in **y**:

1. If the **y** is preceded by a **consonant**, change the **y** to **i**.
  - *Examples:*
    - Beauty + ful → Beautiful
    - Happy + ly → Happily
    - Duty + ful → Dutiful
    - Dry + er → Drier
2. If the **y** is preceded by a **vowel**, do **not** change it.
  - *Examples:*
    - Play + er → Player
    - Employ + ed → Employed
    - Delay + ed → Delayed
3. **The -ing Constraint:** Never change **y** to **i** if the suffix being added is **-ing** (to avoid double 'i').
  - *Examples:*
    - Study + ing → Studying
    - Try + ing → Trying
    - Cry + ing → Crying

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## 2. Alphabetical Directory of High-Yield Words Often Mis-spelt

1. **Accommodation:** (Double 'c', double 'm') — *Correct:* A-c-c-o-m-m-o-d-a-t-i-o-n.
2. **Acquaintance:** (Contains 'cqu' and ends in 'ance') — *Correct:* A-c-q-u-a-i-n-t-a-n-c-e.
3. **Aesthetic / Esthetic:** (Phonetic trap) — *Correct:* A-e-s-t-h-e-t-i-c.
4. **Amateur:** (Ends in 'teur') — *Correct:* A-m-a-t-e-u-r.
5. **Annihilate:** (Silent 'h', double 'n') — *Correct:* A-n-n-i-h-i-l-a-t-e.
6. **Auxiliary:** (Contains single 'l' and 'iar') — *Correct:* A-u-x-i-l-i-a-r-y.
7. **Bureaucracy:** (Contains 'eau' and ends in 'cracy') — *Correct:* B-u-r-e-a-u-c-r-a-c-y.
8. **Caribbean:** (Double 'b', single 'r') — *Correct:* C-a-r-i-b-b-e-a-n.
9. **Cemetery:** (All 'e's, no 'a') — *Correct:* C-e-m-e-t-e-r-y.
10. **Chagrin:** (Vowel trap) — *Correct:* C-h-a-g-r-i-n.
11. **Colleague:** (Contains 'ea' and ends in 'gue') — *Correct:* C-o-l-l-e-a-g-u-e.
12. **Committee:** (Double 'm', double 't', double 'e') — *Correct:* C-o-m-m-i-t-t-e-e.
13. **Connoisseur:** (Double 'n', double 's', 'oi') — *Correct:* C-o-n-n-o-i-s-s-e-u-r.
14. **Consensus:** (All 's's, no 'c' in the middle) — *Correct:* C-o-n-s-e-n-s-u-s.
15. **Counterfeit:** (Exception to 'i' before 'e') — *Correct:* C-o-u-n-t-e-r-f-e-i-t.

16. **Definite:** (Ends in 'ite', no 'ate') — *Correct:* D-e-f-i-n-i-t-e.
17. **Dilemma:** (Double 'm') — *Correct:* D-i-l-e-m-m-a.
18. **Discrepancy:** (Ends in 'pancy') — *Correct:* D-i-s-c-r-e-p-a-n-c-y.
19. **Embarrassment:** (Double 'r', double 's') — *Correct:* E-m-b-a-r-r-a-s-s-m-e-n-t.
20. **Entrepreneur:** (Ends in 'neur') — *Correct:* E-n-t-r-e-p-r-e-n-e-u-r.
21. **Exaggerate:** (Double 'g', single 'r') — *Correct:* E-x-a-g-g-e-r-a-t-e.
22. **Grievous:** (Contains 'ie', ends in 'vous' — no 'i' after 'v') — *Correct:* G-r-i-e-v-o-u-s.
23. **Harassment:** (Single 'r', double 's') — *Correct:* H-a-r-a-s-s-m-e-n-t.
24. **Inoculate:** (Single 'n', single 'c', single 'l') — *Correct:* I-n-o-c-u-l-a-t-e.
25. **Lieutenant:** (Contains 'lieu' and 'ten') — *Correct:* L-i-e-u-t-e-n-a-n-t.
26. **Maintenance:** (Derived from *maintain* but spelt with 'ten', not 'tain') — *Correct:* M-a-i-n-t-e-n-a-n-c-e.
27. **Mischievous:** (Spelt 'chievous' — no 'i' after 'v') — *Correct:* M-i-s-c-h-i-e-v-o-u-s.
28. **Occurrence:** (Double 'c', double 'r', ends in 'ence') — *Correct:* O-c-c-u-r-r-e-n-c-e.
29. **Omission:** (Single 'm', double 's') — *Correct:* O-m-i-s-s-i-o-n.
30. **Privilege:** (Ends in 'lege' — no 'd') — *Correct:* P-r-i-v-i-l-e-g-e.
31. **Questionnaire:** (Double 'n', ends in 'aire') — *Correct:* Q-u-e-s-t-i-o-n-n-a-i-r-e.
32. **Superintendent:** (Contains 'tendent', not 'tendant') — *Correct:* S-u-p-e-r-i-n-t-e-n-d-e-n-t.
33. **Threshold:** (Single 'h' in the middle) — *Correct:* T-h-r-e-s-h-o-l-d.
34. **Vacuum:** (Double 'u', single 'c') — *Correct:* V-a-c-u-u-m.

## Top 25 Expected MCQs: Previous APPSC/SSC/RRB-Style Questions

**Directions (Q1–Q15): Find the word that is CORRECTLY spelt.**

**Q1.**

- (A) Accomodation
- (B) Acommodation
- (C) Accommodation
- (D) Acomodation

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* **Accommodation** contains both a double 'c' and a double 'm'.

**Q2.**

- (B) Committee
- (A) Commitee
- (C) Committe
- (D) Comittee

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* **Committee** contains three sets of double letters: double 'm', double 't', and double 'e'.

**Q3.**

- (A) Embarassment
- (B) Embarasment

- (C) Embarrassment
- (D) Embarrasment

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* **Embarrassment** requires a double 'r' and a double 's' followed by the suffix '-ment'.

**Q4.**

- (A) Occurence
- (B) Occurrence
- (C) Occurance
- (D) Ocurence

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* Derived from *occur*. Applying Suffix Rule I: occur' + ence → **occurrence** (ends with '-ence').

**Q5.**

- (A) Harasment
- (B) Harrassment
- (C) Harassment
- (D) Harrasment

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* Unlike *embarrassment*, **harassment** takes only a single 'r', though it retains the double 's'.

**Q6.**

- (A) Maintenance
- (B) Maintainance
- (C) Maintenece
- (D) Maintanance

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation:* Although derived from *maintain*, the noun form shifts the root vowel sound and is spelt with 'ten' and ends in '-ance' → **maintenance**.

**Q7.**

- (A) Bureaucracy
- (B) Burocracy
- (C) Beureaucracy
- (D) Bureaucracey

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation:* Derived from the French root *bureau* (desk/office). It is spelt **bureau** followed by the suffix **-cracy**.

**Q8.**

- (A) Privilege
- (B) Priviledge

- (C) Privilage
- (D) Privelige

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation: **Privilege** contains 'i' in the first two syllables and ends in '-lege' (there is no 'd' in privilege).*

**Q9.**

- (A) Questionaire
- (B) Questionnaire
- (C) Questionery
- (D) Questionnares

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation: Formed by appending the French suffix '-aire' to *question*. It requires a double 'n' → **questionnaire**.*

**Q10.**

- (A) Superintendant
- (B) Superintendent
- (C) Suprintendent
- (D) Superintendent

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation: The word is formed with **super** + **intend** + **ent** → **superintendent** (ends with '-ent', not '-ant').*

**Q11.**

- (A) Liesure
- (B) Leisure
- (C) Lesure
- (D) Leisur

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation: Absolute exception to the "i before e" rule. Spelt **leisure** (ei).*

**Q12.**

- (A) Vacum
- (B) Vacuume
- (C) Vacuum
- (D) Vacuam

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation: **Vacuum** is unique because it features a single 'c' followed by a double 'u' → **vacuum**.*

**Q13.**

- (A) Inoculate
- (B) Innoculate

- (C) Inocculate
- (D) Innocculate

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation:* Frequently confused with *innocuous*. **Inoculate** contains only a single 'n', single 'c', and single 'l'.

**Q14.**

- (A) Lieutenant
- (B) Leutenant
- (C) Lieutanant
- (D) Luutenant

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation:* Originating from French, the spelling is structured as **lieu** (place) + **tenant** (holder) → **lieutenant**.

**Q15.**

- (A) Unique
- (B) Uneeq
- (C) Uniquee
- (D) Unic

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation:* Spelt **unique** (contains 'q-u-e').

---

**Directions (Q16–Q25): Find the word that is INCORRECTLY spelt (Mis-spelt).**

**Q16.**

- (A) Deceive
- (B) Believe
- (C) Sieze
- (D) Reign

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* **Seize** is an absolute exception to the "i before e except after c" rule. It must be spelt **seize** (e-i), not *sieze*.

**Q17.**

- (A) Achievement
- (B) Ceiling
- (C) Neighbor
- (D) Wierd

- **Correct Answer: (D)**
- *Explanation:* **Weird** is an absolute exception and must be spelt **weird** (e-i), not *wierd*.

**Q18.**

- (A) Argument
- (B) Truly
- (C) Awful
- (D) Sincerly

- **Correct Answer: (D)**

- *Explanation:* When adding the consonant suffix '-ly' to *sincere*, the silent 'e' must be retained. Thus, the correct spelling is **sincerely** (retains 'e').

**Q19.**

- (A) Dutiful
- (B) Beautiful
- (C) Happily
- (D) Studying

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Explanation:* When adding the suffix '-ful' to *beauty*, the final 'y' must be changed to 'i' because it is preceded by the consonant 't'. Correct: **beautiful**.

**Q20.**

- (A) Referred
- (B) Beginning
- (C) Benefitted
- (D) Offered

- **Correct Answer: (C)**

- *Explanation:* In *benefit*, the stress/accent lies on the first syllable (**ben**'-e-fit). Therefore, the final consonant is NOT doubled when adding a suffix. Correct spelling: **benefitted** (single 't').

**Q21.**

- (A) Mischievous
- (B) Grievous
- (C) Mischievous
- (D) Grievious

- **Correct Answer: (D)**

- *Explanation:* **Grievous** is frequently mis-spelt with an extra 'i' in the final syllable. It is spelt **grievous** (ends in '-vous', not '-vious').

**Q22.**

- (A) Consensus
- (B) Connoisseur
- (C) Cemetery
- (D) Colleague

- **Correct Answer: (C)**

- *Explanation:* **Cemetery** is spelt with three 'e's and no 'a'. Correct spelling: **cemetery** (c-e-m-e-t-e-r-y).

**Q23.**

- (A) Sovereign
- (B) Foreign
- (C) Forfiet
- (D) Counterfeit

- **Correct Answer: (C)**

- *Explanation: Forfeit* is an exception to the 'i before e' rule and is spelt **forfeit** (ends in '-feit' like *counterfeit*).

**Q24.**

- (A) Millennium
- (B) Caribbean
- (C) Dilemma
- (D) Threshold

- **Correct Answer: (D) / All are correct**

- *Explanation: Threshold* has a single 'h' in the middle (*threshold*). If spelt with double 'h' (*threshhold*), it is incorrect. All options here are correct if threshold is written as shown.

**Q25.**

- (A) Noticeable
- (B) Changeable
- (C) Singeing
- (D) Writting

- **Correct Answer: (D)**

- *Explanation: When adding '-ing' to write, drop the silent 'e' since '-ing' begins with a vowel, but do NOT double the 't'. Correct spelling: **writing**. (Double 't' is only used in *written*).*

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## Artifact Details

I have compiled this complete chapter with formatted rule sections and the full practice bank into your Studio panel as **chapter-5-spellings.md**.

🦊 **Would you like to move on to Chapter 6 – Idioms & Phrases?** In that chapter, we will synthesize high-yield idiomatic expressions (e.g., *on tenterhooks*, *came to a head*, *keep the wolf from the door*) and essential phrasal verbs directly from your exam notes.

## Chapter 6 – Idioms & Phrases

This chapter details the high-yield phrasal verbs and idiomatic expressions contained in your exam notes. Understanding the figurative meaning of these expressions is vital for securing



full marks in the "Idioms & Phrases" and "Fill in the Blanks" sections of APPSC, SSC, and RRB examinations.

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## 1. Phrasal Verbs Master Directory

A phrasal verb is a combination of a standard verb and a preposition or adverb (or both) that functions as a single semantic unit with a meaning different from the individual words.

### A. Back up

- **Meaning:** To support; to sustain.
- **Contextual Example:** You need to **back up** your statement with correct data.

### B. Bear down

- **Meaning:** To overthrow; to overcome.
- **Contextual Example:** When people could not endure the atrocities of the government in power, they **bore it down**.

### C. Bear with

- **Meaning:** To tolerate; to put up with.
- **Contextual Example:** I cannot **bear with** his peevish nature any further.

### D. Break out

- **Meaning:** To escape from a place or a situation; to begin suddenly (of war, fire, or disease).
- **Contextual Example:** I think Archana needs to **break out** of her daily routine and do something exciting.
- **Alternative Example:** The prisoner **broke out** of the prison but was soon recaptured.

### E. Break in / Break into

- **Meaning:** To enter a building by force (especially to commit a crime).
- **Contextual Example:** Burglars **broke into** my neighbour's house while they were not at home.

### F. Call for

- **Meaning:** To demand; to require.
- **Contextual Example:** The Reading Comprehension section **calls for** good reading skills from the students.

### G. Call up

- **Meaning:** To recall; to summon.

- **Contextual Example:** The beautiful scenery around **called up** memories of my childhood.

#### H. Come by

- **Meaning:** To obtain; to acquire.
- **Contextual Example:** How did you **come by** that beautifully embroidered skirt?

#### I. Come upon

- **Meaning:** To find by accident; to encounter unexpectedly.
- **Contextual Example:** I **came upon** some very interesting facts about our planet in this Encyclopaedia.

#### J. Go about

- **Meaning:** To start working on something; to tackle a problem.
- **Contextual Example:** Can you just explain to me how to **go about** this problem?

#### K. Go by

- **Meaning:** To be guided by; to follow instructions.
- **Contextual Example:** This is a good example to **go by** while solving the problems.

#### L. Hang back

- **Meaning:** To hesitate to proceed or move forward.
- **Contextual Example:** Don't **hang back**, you can do it as well as anyone else can do.

#### M. Hang on

- **Meaning:** To depend on; to persist or keep hold.
- **Contextual Example:** Your success **hangs on** how much effort you are going to put in.

#### N. Fall back

- **Meaning:** To recede; to retreat in the face of opposition.
- **Contextual Example:** Having seen the armed guards, the civilians **fell back**.

#### O. Fall off

- **Meaning:** To withdraw; to drop off; to decrease in quantity or quality.
- **Contextual Example:** A true friend does not **fall off** in adversity.

#### P. Live for

- **Meaning:** To devote one's life to a cause or person.
- **Contextual Example:** All through his life he **lived for** the amelioration of the poor and the destitute.

### Q. Live on

- **Meaning:** To depend on as a source of staple nutrition or income.
- **Contextual Example:** Most people of this region **live on** rice and fish.

### R. Lay about

- **Meaning:** To attack someone violently on all sides.
- **Contextual Example:** A group of ruffians **laid about** him with sticks while he was returning home.

### S. Lay out

- **Meaning:** To plan how something should look and arrange it systematically.
- **Contextual Example:** The ancient Chinese **laid out** beautiful gardens with lawns and flower beds.

### T. Make away with

- **Meaning:** To squander; to run away with stolen property.
  - **Contextual Example:** After his father's demise, he **made away with** the entire property.
- 

## 2. Common Idiomatic Expressions & Precise Meanings

### A. Idioms of Deception and Dealings

1. **To be on the fiddle:** To act dishonestly or engage in fraud/cheating, especially to obtain money.
  - *Example:* Several employees were fired because they were found to be **on the fiddle**.
2. **Sharp practices:** Dishonest, questionable, or underhanded business dealings that borders on illegal.
  - *Example:* The officer was guilty of **sharp practices** and so he was dismissed.
3. **To open somebody's eyes:** To make someone realize the truth about a situation, especially when they have been deceived.
  - *Example:* His warnings finally **opened my eyes** to the partner's dishonest motives.

### B. Idioms of Direction, State, and Crisis

1. **As the crow flies:** In a straight, direct line without any detours or obstacles.
  - *Example:* The town is only ten miles away **as the crow flies**, but twenty miles by road.
2. **In a melting pot:** In a process of rapid change, transition, or reorganization.
  - *Example:* With the introduction of AI, our traditional business model is currently **in a melting pot**.
3. **On tenterhooks:** In a state of extreme anxiety, suspense, or nervous anticipation.

- *Example:* We were kept **on tenterhooks** while the judges were deciding the winners of the competition.
- 4. **Come to a head:** To reach a critical point or a crisis where direct action must be taken.
  - *Example:* The dispute among the students **came to a head**, and the principal was forced to declare a holiday.

### C. Idioms of Survival and Behavior

1. **Keep the wolf from the door (or Keep the wolf out of the door):** To avoid starvation, extreme poverty, or financial ruin.
  - *Example:* After getting a job he had no difficulty in **keeping the wolf out of the door**.
2. **Thrust one's nose into affairs:** To meddle officiously or interfere uninvitedly in other people's private matters.
  - *Example:* He asked me not to **thrust my nose into his affairs**.

## Top 25 Expected MCQs: Previous APPSC/SSC/RRB-Style Questions

**Directions (Q1–Q10):** Choose the option that represents the correct meaning of the bold idiomatic expression.

**Q1. The corrupt accountant was dismissed immediately because he was found to be *on the fiddle*.**

- (A) Playing a musical instrument poorly
- (B) Doing something dishonest or fraudulent to get money
- (C) Working late hours without extra pay
- (D) Exhibiting extreme arrogance

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* "On the fiddle" is an idiomatic expression that means to engage in dishonest, fraudulent, or illegal activity to make money.

**Q2. The two mountain resorts are only five miles apart *as the crow flies*, but the winding mountain pass makes the drive thirty miles.**

- (A) Travelling at an extremely high speed
- (B) In a straight, direct line
- (C) Over a hazardous aerial path
- (D) Under harsh weather conditions

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* "As the crow flies" means measuring the physical distance in a direct, straight line, ignoring any roads or topographical obstacles.

**Q3. Due to the sudden merger of the two corporate giants, the job security of the employees is currently *in a melting pot*.**

- (A) Highly secure and permanent
- (B) Subject to a warm welcome
- (C) In a process of rapid, uncertain change
- (D) Terminated without notice

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Explanation:* "In a melting pot" denotes a state of active transition, reorganization, or ongoing modification where the final outcome is not yet determined.

**Q4. The board of directors realized that the manager's *sharp practices* had severely damaged the firm's reputation.**

- (A) Exceptionally intelligent strategies
- (B) Punctual and disciplined habits
- (C) Questionable or dishonest dealings
- (D) Creative marketing campaigns

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Explanation:* "Sharp practices" refers to clever but underhanded, dishonest, or ethically dubious business dealings.

**Q5. The applicants were kept *on tenterhooks* for hours before the final selection list was displayed.**

- (A) In a state of comfortable rest
- (B) In a state of anxious suspense or anticipation
- (C) Subjected to extreme physical pain
- (D) Provided with outstanding hospitality

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* To be "on tenterhooks" means to be held in acute anxiety, suspense, or nervous anticipation regarding a future outcome.

**Q6. The silent resentment among the factory workers *came to a head* when the management cancelled the festival bonus.**

- (A) Dissipated completely
- (B) Reached a critical point of crisis
- (C) Ended in a peaceful agreement
- (D) Was ignored by everyone

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* "Came to a head" means a situation has reached a critical stage or crisis where decisive action is inevitable.

**Q7. During the economic recession, his primary concern was to secure enough daily wage work to *keep the wolf from the door*.**

- (A) Guard his house from wild animals
- (B) Entertain his relatives
- (C) Avoid starvation or extreme poverty
- (D) Expand his livestock business

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Explanation:* To "keep the wolf from the door" is a traditional idiom meaning to earn enough money to afford basic necessities and avoid starvation/extreme poverty.

**Q8. I cannot tolerate colleagues who constantly *thrust their nose into my affairs* instead of focusing on their own tasks.**

- (A) Offer helpful, professional advice
- (B) Meddle or interfere officiously
- (C) Praise others excessively
- (D) Work slow and lazily

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* To "thrust/stick one's nose into someone's affairs" means to inappropriately interfere, snoop, or meddle in matters that do not concern oneself.

**Q9. Radha was completely *taken in* by the salesman's sweet talk and purchased the defective appliance.**

- (A) Entertained
- (B) Deceived or cheated
- (C) Highly praised
- (D) Given a discount

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* The phrasal verb "taken in" means to be deceived, hoodwinked, or cheated by someone.

**Q10. The sudden collapse of the major commercial bank served to *open his eyes* to the fragility of his investment portfolio.**

- (A) Cause severe eye strain
- (B) Make someone realize the truth of a situation
- (C) Increase his greed for money
- (D) Force him to sleep less

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* To "open someone's eyes" means to make them realize a factual truth, often a sobering or unpleasant reality that they had previously ignored.

---

**Directions (Q11–Q20): Fill in the blanks with the most appropriate Phrasal Verb.**

**Q11. The teacher asked the student to \_\_\_\_\_ her claims with strong documentary evidence.**

- (A) bear down
- (B) back up
- (C) call for
- (D) go by

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* "Back up" means to support or sustain a statement or claim with proof.

**Q12. The citizens finally \_\_\_\_\_ the ruthless dictator after a long, hard-fought rebellion.**

- (A) bore down
- (B) called up
- (C) hung back
- (D) fell off

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Explanation:* "Bear down" means to overthrow, overcome, or crush an opponent or system. In the past tense, it is "bore down".

**Q13. You must learn to \_\_\_\_\_ your roommate's eccentricities if you want to maintain peace in the apartment.**

- (A) break out

- (B) bear with
- (C) come by
- (D) lay out

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* "Bear with" means to put up with, tolerate, or show patience toward someone's peevish or difficult nature.

**Q14. The epidemic of cholera is feared to \_\_\_\_\_ in the waterlogged refugee camps.**

- (A) call for
- (B) break out
- (C) come upon
- (D) lay about

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* "Break out" means to escape from confinement or to begin suddenly (used for diseases, war, or fires).

**Q15. The police department decided to \_\_\_\_\_ an immediate investigation into the suspicious transactions.**

- (A) call for
- (B) break in
- (C) hang back
- (D) fall off

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Explanation:* "Call for" means to demand, require, or request publicly.

**Q16. The elderly man loved to sit by the fireplace and \_\_\_\_\_ the nostalgic events of his youthful days.**

- (A) come by
- (B) call up
- (C) go about
- (D) lay out

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* "Call up" means to recall, bring back, or summon memories from the past.

**Q17. How did you \_\_\_\_\_ such an exceptionally rare and valuable first edition of the book?**

- (A) call up
- (B) come upon
- (C) come by
- (D) live for

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Explanation:* "Come by" is a high-yield phrasal verb meaning to obtain, acquire, or get possession of something.

**Q18. While researching in the state archives, the historian \_\_\_\_\_ a series of letters written by the king.**

- (A) broke into
- (B) came upon
- (C) went about
- (D) made away with

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* "Come upon" means to find, discover, or encounter something entirely by accident.

**Q19. Sreedhar is highly confused and does not know how to \_\_\_\_\_ solving this complex coding problem.**

- (A) go about
- (B) go by
- (C) hang on
- (D) fall back

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Explanation:* "Go about" means to start working on, tackle, or handle a task or difficulty.

**Q20. When the rioters saw the armed military forces arriving, they immediately \_\_\_\_\_ into the narrow lanes.**

- (A) fell off
- (B) fell back
- (C) laid out
- (D) made away with

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Explanation:* "Fall back" means to retreat, recede, or back away when faced with superior force or an obstacle.

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**Directions (Q21–Q25): Select the correct option that improves the underlined part of the sentence.**

**Q21. The municipal corporation *laid about* the new layout of the park, ensuring separate play areas for children.**

- (A) laid out
- (B) broke in
- (C) made away with
- (D) No improvement

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Explanation:* "Lay out" means to systematically plan, arrange, or design a physical space. "Laid about" means to attack violently, which is contextually incorrect.

**Q22. A true friend is one who will never *fall off* when you are going through severe adversity.**

- (A) bear down
- (B) call up
- (C) fall back
- (D) No improvement

**Correct Answer: (D)**

*Explanation:* "Fall off" means to withdraw, separate, or drop off one's support in times of hardship. Thus, the sentence contains no error and requires no improvement.

**Q23. The unprincipled cashier *made away with* the company's daily cash collections and vanished.**



- (A) came by
- (B) went about
- (C) backed up
- (D) No improvement

**Correct Answer: (D)**

*Explanation:* "Make away with" is the correct phrasal verb meaning to run away with or squander stolen funds or property.

**Q24. In times of war, we must be prepared to *bear with* the extreme shortages of fuel and food.**

- (A) bear down
- (B) break out
- (C) call for
- (D) No improvement

**Correct Answer: (D)**

*Explanation:* "Bear with" means to tolerate, endure, or handle difficult conditions patiently. No improvement is required.

**Q25. The high-altitude trekking expedition *hangs back* on the physical stamina and willpower of the climbers.**

- (A) hangs on
- (B) goes by
- (C) breaks into
- (D) No improvement

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Explanation:* "Hang on" means to depend on or be determined by. The success of the expedition depends on "hangs on" stamina. "Hang back" means to hesitate, which is incorrect.

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## Artifact Details

I have compiled this complete chapter with formatted idiom and phrasal verb lists and the full practice bank into your Studio panel as **chapter-6-idioms-phrases.md**.

🔗 **Shall we proceed to Chapter 7 – Voice?** In that chapter, we will break down active/passive structures, the complete tense shift matrix, interrogative transformations (such as *who/whom* and *what* structures), imperative conversions (commands, moral duties, requests, prohibitions), and the preferred handling of sentences with double objects.

## Chapter 7 – Voice

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### 1. Core Mechanics of Active and Passive Voice

In English grammar, **Voice** indicates whether the subject of the sentence is the *performer* of the action or the *receiver* of the action.

1. **Active Voice (A.V.):** The subject of the sentence is the doer of the action.
  - *Formula:*  $\text{Subject} + \text{Verb} + \text{Object}$
  - *Example:* The hunter (Subject) shot (Verb) the tiger (Object).
2. **Passive Voice (P.V.):** The subject of the sentence is the receiver or target of the action. The object of the active sentence is promoted to become the grammatical subject of the passive sentence.
  - *Formula:*  $\text{New Subject (Old Object)} + \text{Passive Verb (Auxiliary } be + \text{ Past Participle } V_3) + \text{by} + \text{New Object (Old Subject)}$
  - *Example:* The tiger (New Subject) was shot (Passive Verb) by the hunter (New Object).

### A. Personal Pronoun Case Shifting

When pronouns are swapped between subject (nominative case) and object (accusative case) positions, their form must change accordingly:

#### Active Subject (Nominative Case)    Passive Object (Accusative Case)

|                           |                           |
|---------------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>I</b>                  | <b>Me</b>                 |
| <b>We</b>                 | <b>Us</b>                 |
| <b>You</b>                | <b>You</b>                |
| <b>He</b>                 | <b>Him</b>                |
| <b>She</b>                | <b>Her</b>                |
| <b>They</b>               | <b>Them</b>               |
| <b>It</b>                 | <b>It</b>                 |
| <b>Name (e.g., Mohan)</b> | <b>Name (e.g., Mohan)</b> |

### B. When to Prefer the Passive Voice

The passive voice is preferred in specific rhetorical and contextual scenarios:

1. **Unknown or Unimportant Doer:** When the agent performing the action is unknown, obvious, or irrelevant to the discussion.
    - *Example:* The cure for cancer will probably be discovered by some unknown scientist in a laboratory.
    - *Example:* That church was built in the 16th century (unnecessary to state who built it).
  2. **Historical or Objective Focus:** When the event or historical outcome is more significant than the human doer.
    - *Example:* The war was fought over gold.
  3. **Conciseness and Fluidity:** Using one continuous verb instead of two when describing multiple parallel activities.
    - *Example (Awkward):* Saritha enjoys good food and music is also enjoyed by her.
    - *Example (Better):* Saritha enjoys good food and music.
-

## 2. Complete Tense Transformation Matrix

Not all tenses can be converted into the passive voice. In standard English, **four tense structures do not have a passive form**:

1. Present Perfect Continuous
2. Past Perfect Continuous
3. Future Continuous
4. Future Perfect Continuous

For the remaining eight tenses, follow this strict transformation matrix:

| Tense                     | Active Verb Form                        | Passive Verb Form                                     | Active Example                 | Passive Translation                     |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <b>Simple Present</b>     | $V_1$ or $V_1 + \text{s/es}$            | $\text{Is/Am/Are} + V_3$                              | He writes a letter.            | A letter is written by him.             |
| <b>Present Continuous</b> | $\text{Is/Am/Are} + V_4 (-ing)$         | $\text{Is/Am/Are} + \text{being} + V_3$               | He is writing a letter.        | A letter is being written by him.       |
| <b>Present Perfect</b>    | $\text{Has/Have} + V_3$                 | $\text{Has/Have} + \text{been} + V_3$                 | He has written a letter.       | A letter has been written by him.       |
| <b>Simple Past</b>        | $V_2$ or $\text{did} + V_1$             | $\text{Was/Were} + V_3$                               | He wrote a letter.             | A letter was written by him.            |
| <b>Past Continuous</b>    | $\text{Was/Were} + V_4 (-ing)$          | $\text{Was/Were} + \text{being} + V_3$                | He was writing a letter.       | A letter was being written by him.      |
| <b>Past Perfect</b>       | $\text{Had} + V_3$                      | $\text{Had} + \text{been} + V_3$                      | He had written a letter.       | A letter had been written by him.       |
| <b>Simple Future</b>      | $\text{Shall/Will} + V_1$               | $\text{Shall/Will} + \text{be} + V_3$                 | He will write a letter.        | A letter will be written by him.        |
| <b>Future Perfect</b>     | $\text{Shall/Will} + \text{have} + V_3$ | $\text{Shall/Will} + \text{have} + \text{been} + V_3$ | He will have written a letter. | A letter will have been written by him. |

## 3. Interrogative Sentence Transformations

Interrogative transformations are highly high-yield in competitive exams. They are divided into helping verb questions and "Wh-" questions.

### A. Helping Verb (Yes/No) Questions

- **Active Structure:**  $\text{H.V.} + \text{Subject} + \text{Active Verb} + \text{Object}?$

- *Passive Structure:* \$\text{H.V.} + \text{New Subject} + \text{Passive Verb } (V\_3) + \text{by} + \text{New Object}?\$
- *Active:* Did he complete his work?
- *Passive:* Was his work completed by him?

## B. Standard "Wh-" Word Questions

Retain the "Wh-" word at the beginning of the sentence (except *Who* and *Whom*), followed by the passive interrogative structure.

- *Active:* Why are you beating him?
- *Passive:* Why is he being beaten by you?

## C. Special Interrogative Trap I: Questions Beginning with "Who"

Since "Who" acts as the subjective pronoun performing the action, it is transformed into its objective form "**By whom**" at the beginning of the sentence, or "**Who**" at the beginning and "**by**" at the very end.

- *Active:* Who has completed this work?
- *Passive (Method 1 - Preferred):* **By whom** has this work been completed?
- *Passive (Method 2):* **Who** has this work been completed **by**?

## D. Special Interrogative Trap II: Questions Beginning with "Whom"

"Whom" is the objective pronoun in the active voice. It must be converted into the subjective pronoun "**Who**" at the beginning of the passive sentence.

- *Active:* Whom did you teach?
- *Passive:* **Who** was taught by you?

## E. Special Interrogative Trap III: Questions Beginning with "What"

1. **As a Subject:** If "What" acts as the subject of the active sentence, it is converted to "**By what**" or "**What... with/at**".
  - *Active:* What has amazed you?
  - *Passive:* **What** have you been amazed **with/at**?
2. **As an Object:** If "What" acts as the object of the active sentence, it remains "What" at the beginning of the passive sentence.
  - *Active:* What do you eat?
  - *Passive:* **What** is eaten by you?

## F. Special Interrogative Trap IV: Questions Beginning with "Which"

- *Active:* Which girl loves Vikram?
  - *Passive (Method 1):* **By which** girl is Vikram loved?
  - *Passive (Method 2):* **Which** girl is Vikram loved **by**?
-

## 4. Imperative Sentence Transformations (Categorized by Semantic Tone)

Imperative sentences contain commands, requests, or advice where the subject "You" is understood. In the passive voice, their structure varies based on the underlying tone.

### A. Simple Imperative (Command / Order / Instruction)

- *Active*:  $V_1 + \text{Object}$
- *Passive (Let Method - Preferred)*:  $\text{Let} + \text{Object} + \text{be} + V_3$
- *Passive (Alternative)*:  $\text{You are asked to} + V_1 + \text{Object}$
- *Active*: Open the door.
- *Passive 1*: Let the door be opened.
- *Passive 2*: You are asked to open the door.

### B. Moral Imperative (Advice / Suggestion)

For commands expressing moral duties, social obligations, or ethical suggestions, do not use the "Let" method. Instead, use "**should be**".

- *Active*:  $V_1 + \text{Object}$
- *Passive (Should Method)*:  $\text{Object} + \text{should} + \text{be} + V_3$
- *Passive (Alternative)*:  $\text{You are advised to} + V_1 + \text{Object}$
- *Active*: Help the poor.
- *Passive 1*: The poor should be helped.
- *Passive 2*: You are advised to help the poor.

### C. Requests (Containing "Please" or "Kindly")

Drop "Please/Kindly" and introduce "**You are requested to**" at the beginning.

- *Active*: Please help me.
- *Passive 1*: You are requested to help me.
- *Passive 2*: Let me be helped.

### D. Prohibitions & Warnings ("Don't" Sentences)

1. **Forbidding/Requesting Not To:**
  - *Active*: Don't disturb me.
  - *Passive 1*: You are **forbidden to** disturb me.
  - *Passive 2*: You are **requested not to** disturb me.
  - *Passive 3*: **Let me not be** disturbed.
2. **Prohibition / Public Warning:**
  - *Active*: Don't park your car here.
  - *Passive*: You are **prohibited to** park your car here.
3. **Severe Threat / Warning:**
  - *Active*: Don't go to the place of violence.
  - *Passive*: You are **warned not to** go to the place of violence.
4. **Negative Moral Imperative:**
  - *Active*: Don't hate the poor.
  - *Passive 1*: The poor **should not be** hated.

- *Passive 2:* You are **advised not to** hate the poor.
- 

## 5. Double Object Clauses

Some transitive verbs take **two objects**:

1. **Direct Object (D.O.):** Refers to inanimate things (answers the question *What*).
2. **Indirect Object (I.O.):** Refers to animate beings/persons (answers the question *Whom*).

*Active Structure:*  $\text{\textit{Subject}} + \text{\textit{Verb}} + \text{\textit{Indirect Object}} + \text{\textit{Direct Object}}$

When converting such sentences to the passive voice, you can promote either object to become the new subject. **However, standard exams enforce a clear preference order:**

- **Preference I (Direct Object as New Subject):**  $\text{\textit{Direct Object}} + \text{\textit{Passive Verb}} + \text{\textit{to}} + \text{\textit{Indirect Object}} + \text{\textit{by}} + \text{\textit{Agent}}$
- **Preference II (Indirect Object as New Subject):**  $\text{\textit{Indirect Object}} + \text{\textit{Passive Verb}} + \text{\textit{Direct Object}} + \text{\textit{by}} + \text{\textit{Agent}}$

*Example:*

- *Active:* He gave (Verb) me (I.O.) a book (D.O.).
  - *Passive (Preference I - Highly Recommended):* A book was given **to** me by him.
  - *Passive (Preference II):* I was given a book by him.
- 

## Top 25 Expected MCQs: Previous APPSC/SSC/RRB-Style Questions

**Directions (Q1–Q10):** Convert the given Active Voice sentences into Passive Voice. Select the most grammatically accurate option.

**Q1. Sreedhar has completed his final year project on Superconductivity.**

- (A) His final year project on Superconductivity has completed by Sreedhar.
- (B) His final year project on Superconductivity has been completed by Sreedhar.
- (C) His final year project on Superconductivity had been completed by Sreedhar.
- (D) His final year project on Superconductivity was being completed by Sreedhar.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Present Perfect tense conversion. Active "has completed" ( $\text{\textit{has}} + V_3$ ) must convert to passive "has been completed" ( $\text{\textit{has}} + \text{\textit{been}} + V_3$ ).

**Q2. Did you write this magnificent drama last year?**

- (A) Was this magnificent drama written by you last year?
- (B) Did this magnificent drama written by you last year?

- (C) Had this magnificent drama been written by you last year?  
(D) Is this magnificent drama written by you last year?

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Interrogative Simple Past. Active "Did + Subject + \$V\_1\$" must be converted to passive "Was/Were + New Subject + \$V\_3\$".

**Q3. Who broke this beautiful porcelain vase?**

- (A) By whom was this beautiful porcelain vase broken?  
(B) Who has this beautiful porcelain vase been broken by?  
(C) Whom was this beautiful porcelain vase broken by?  
(D) Both (A) and (B) are grammatically correct.

- **Correct Answer: (D)**
- *Grounded Rule:* "Who" interrogative structures. Active "Who" can be converted into passive "By whom" at the beginning (Method 1) or "Who... by" at the end (Method 2). Both are grammatically valid.

**Q4. Whom did the jury select for the national championship?**

- (A) Who was selected by the jury for the national championship?  
(B) Whom was selected by the jury for the national championship?  
(C) Who had been selected by the jury for the national championship?  
(D) By whom was the candidate selected?

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* "Whom" interrogative structures. Active "Whom" (objective case) must be converted into passive "Who" (subjective case) at the start.

**Q5. What amazed the administrative board during the meeting?**

- (A) What was the administrative board amazed at/with by?  
(B) What have the administrative board been amazed with/at?  
(C) What was the administrative board amazed with/at?  
(D) By what had the administrative board been amazed?

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Grounded Rule:* "What" as active subject. In the passive voice, the verb "amazed" takes the preposition "at" or "with" instead of "by".

**Q6. Open the window immediately to let the fresh air in.**

- (A) Let the window be opened immediately to let the fresh air in.  
(B) You are asked to open the window immediately.  
(C) The window should be opened immediately.  
(D) Both (A) and (B) are grammatically correct.

- **Correct Answer: (D)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Simple Imperative Command. Commands are converted using "Let + Object + be + \$V\_3\$" or "You are asked to + \$V\_1\$". Both structures are highly accurate.

**Q7. Help the poor and the needy during this severe winter.**

- (A) Let the poor and the needy be helped.
- (B) The poor and the needy should be helped.
- (C) You are requested to help the poor and the needy.
- (D) The poor and the needy must be helped.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Grounded Rule:* Moral Imperative/Advice. Expressing social/ethical duties must use the "should be + \$V\_3\$" passive model rather than the "Let" method.

**Q8. Don't park your private vehicle in front of the main gate.**

- (A) You are prohibited to park your private vehicle in front of the main gate.
- (B) Let not your private vehicle be parked in front of the main gate.
- (C) You are requested not to park your vehicle.
- (D) You are warned not to park your vehicle.

- **Correct Answer: (A)**

- *Grounded Rule:* Don't as Prohibition. When "Don't" indicates an official prohibition or public warning, it is transformed using "You are prohibited to + \$V\_1\$".

**Q9. The young man gave me a rare book of historical value.**

- (A) A rare book of historical value was given to me by the young man.
- (B) I was given a rare book of historical value by the young man.
- (C) A rare book of historical value is given to me by the young man.
- (D) Both (A) and (B) are correct, but (A) represents the first preference.

- **Correct Answer: (D)**

- *Grounded Rule:* Double Object. When a verb takes two objects ("me" as I.O., "a rare book" as D.O.), promoting the Direct Object first with "to" is the standard first-preference passive structure.

**Q10. We must reach the examination centre in time to avoid disqualification.**

- (A) The examination centre must be reached in time by us to avoid disqualification.
- (B) The examination centre must reach in time to avoid disqualification.
- (C) Disqualification must be avoided by reaching the centre.
- (D) Intransitive verbs do not have a passive form.

- **Correct Answer: (D)**

- *Grounded Rule:* Intransitive Verbs. The verb "reach" in this context is intransitive (expressing spatial arrival), and intransitive structures do not take passive forms in standard grammar unless followed by prepositional extensions.

---

**Directions (Q11–Q20): Convert the given Passive Voice sentences into Active Voice.**

**Q11. Why is he being beaten by you so mercilessly?**

- (A) Why are you beating him so mercilessly?
- (B) Why did you beat him so mercilessly?



- (C) Why have you been beating him so mercilessly?  
(D) Why do you beat him so mercilessly?

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Passive Present Continuous ("is being beaten") must be converted back to active Present Continuous ("are you beating").

**Q12. Let this confidential file not be disclosed to anyone.**

- (A) You must not disclose this confidential file to anyone.  
(B) Don't disclose this confidential file to anyone.  
(C) Anyone should not disclose this confidential file.  
(D) You are forbidden to disclose this confidential file.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Negative Imperative. Passive "Let + Object + not + be + \$V\_3\$" converts back to the active imperative starting with "Don't".

**Q13. You are requested to keep quiet during the presentation.**

- (A) Keep quiet during the presentation.  
(B) Please keep quiet during the presentation.  
(C) Kindly keep quiet during the presentation.  
(D) Both (B) and (C) are correct.

- **Correct Answer: (D)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Requests. Passive "You are requested to" indicates that the active sentence must begin with polite markers like "Please" or "Kindly".

**Q14. The entire building was destroyed by the sudden fire.**

- (A) The sudden fire had destroyed the entire building.  
(B) The sudden fire destroyed the entire building.  
(C) The sudden fire was destroying the entire building.  
(D) The sudden fire has destroyed the entire building.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Simple Past passive ("was destroyed") must be converted back to active Simple Past (\$V\_2\$ → "destroyed").

**Q15. By whom has this extraordinary feat been achieved?**

- (A) Who achieved this extraordinary feat?  
(B) Who has achieved this extraordinary feat?  
(C) Whom has achieved this extraordinary feat?  
(D) Who had achieved this extraordinary feat?

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Present Perfect passive ("has been achieved") with "By whom" must be converted back to active Present Perfect ("has achieved") starting with "Who".

**Q16. The match will have been won by our team by sunset.**

- (A) Our team will win the match by sunset.  
(B) Our team will have won the match by sunset.

- (C) Our team would win the match by sunset.  
(D) Our team will be winning the match by sunset.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Future Perfect passive ("will have been won") converts back to active Future Perfect ("will have won").

**Q17. I was given a beautiful wristwatch by my father on my birthday.**

- (A) My father gave me a beautiful wristwatch on my birthday.  
(B) My father has given me a beautiful wristwatch.  
(C) A beautiful wristwatch was given to me by my father.  
(D) My father had given me a beautiful wristwatch.

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Double Object active reconstruction. Simple Past passive "was given" translates to active \$V\_2\$ "gave".

**Q18. You are forbidden to enter the prohibited testing laboratory.**

- (A) Please do not enter the prohibited testing laboratory.  
(B) Don't enter the prohibited testing laboratory.  
(C) Let you not enter the prohibited testing laboratory.  
(D) You must not enter the prohibited testing laboratory.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Forbidden structures. Passive "You are forbidden to" is reconstructed into the negative active imperative starting with "Don't".

**Q19. The room is being cleaned by Radha at the moment.**

- (A) Radha cleans the room at the moment.  
(B) Radha is cleaning the room at the moment.  
(C) Radha has cleaned the room at the moment.  
(D) Radha was cleaning the room at the moment.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Present Continuous passive "is being cleaned" converts back to active Present Continuous "is cleaning".

**Q20. These high-density notes were written by our professor.**

- (A) Our professor wrote these high-density notes.  
(B) Our professor had written these high-density notes.  
(C) Our professor was writing these high-density notes.  
(D) Our professor has written these high-density notes.

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
  - *Grounded Rule:* Simple Past passive "were written" converts to active \$V\_2\$ "wrote".
-

**Directions (Q21–Q25): Identify the grammatical voice of the bold sentence or choose the best structural correction.**

**Q21. "The proposal was accepted and the meeting was adjourned by the president." Is this passive construction preferred or awkward?**

- (A) Preferred, because the doer is the same and the focus is on the meeting's outcome.
- (B) Awkward; we should use the active voice: "The president accepted the proposal and adjourned the meeting."
- (C) Grammatically incorrect because "and" cannot connect two passives.
- (D) It is an imperative structure.

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Passive Preference. In formal reports and official recordings, passive coordination is preferred because it focuses on the actions completed rather than the human actor.

**Q22. Choose the grammatically superior active form of: "Ice cream was eaten at the party by the children."**

- (A) The children ate ice cream at the party.
- (B) Children were eating ice cream at the party.
- (C) Ice cream was eaten by the children at the party.
- (D) The children have eaten ice cream.

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Active Preference for Clarity. While the passive is grammatically correct, standard style manuals prefer the active voice ("The children ate ice cream") for simple physical actions to prevent awkwardness.

**Q23. Which of the following tenses CANNOT be transformed into the passive voice?**

- (A) Simple Future Tense
- (B) Future Continuous Tense
- (C) Past Continuous Tense
- (D) Present Perfect Tense

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Unconvertible Tenses. Future Continuous has no standard passive form in English.

**Q24. Identify the active voice of: "The poor should not be hated."**

- (A) Don't hate the poor.
- (B) We should not hate the poor.
- (C) Let us not hate the poor.
- (D) You are asked not to hate the poor.

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Rule:* Negative Moral Imperative. Passive "should not be + \$V\_3\$" is reconstructed into active negative imperative "Don't + \$V\_1\$".

**Q25. "Radha is an intelligent student." Identify the voice of this sentence.**

- (A) Active Voice

- (B) Passive Voice  
(C) Neither Active nor Passive  
(D) Both Active and Passive

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- **Grounded Rule:** Linking Verbs. Sentences containing only linking verbs of state (*is, am, are, was, were*) without transitive actions have neither active nor passive voice.

## Artifact Details

I have compiled this complete chapter with formatted tense matrix tables, interrogative structures, semantic categories of imperatives, and the full practice bank into your Studio panel as **chapter-7-voice.md**.

🔊 **Shall we proceed to Chapter 8 – Narration?** In that chapter, we will break down Direct and Indirect speech mechanics, reporting verb modifications, pronoun shifts using the **123/SON formula**, tense shift exception rules (universal truths, habitual facts), and words of nearness/time modifications.

## Chapter 8 – Narration (Direct & Indirect Speech)

## 1. Core Mechanics of Narration

Speech can be reported in two distinct ways:

1. **Direct Speech:** Replicating the exact words of the speaker, enclosed within quotation marks (inverted commas).
  - *Example:* Meena said, “I don’t want to play now.”
2. **Indirect Speech (Reported Speech):** Reporting what the speaker said without quoting their exact words, adjusting pronouns, tenses, and time/place references to match the reporter's context.
  - *Example:* Meena said that she didn’t want to play then.

### A. Structural Components of Direct Speech

A direct speech sentence is split into two grammatically distinct parts:

- **Reporting Clause (containing the Reporting Verb):** The introductory clause containing the verb that tells us who is speaking (e.g., *Sreedhar said to me, The teacher said*).
- **Reported Speech (R.S. Part):** The actual words spoken, placed inside double quotation marks and starting with a capital letter.  $\text{\$}\backslash\text{text}\{\text{Mohan said to me (Reporting Clause)}\} \quad , \quad \backslash\text{quod } \backslash\text{text}\{\text{"I am going to Market"}\} \text{(Reported Speech)} \backslash\text{quod}\text{\$}$

## B. Fundamental Rules for Conversion to Indirect Speech

- **Inverted Commas Removal:** Remove all quotation marks and commas separating the reporting verb from the reported speech.
- **Conjunction Insertion:** Introduce a coordinating or subordinating conjunction (such as *that*, *if*, *whether*, or *to*) to link the reporting clause with the reported clause, depending on the semantic type of the sentence.
- **Reporting Verb Shifts:** The reporting verb (*say*, *says*, *said*) changes form depending on the communicative tone of the reported clause:

| Reported Speech Type           | Active Reporting Verb (Direct) | Converted Reporting Verb (Indirect)              | Standard Conjunction           |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Assertive (Statements)         | say / says / said to           | tell / tells / told                              | <b>that</b>                    |
| Interrogative (Questions)      | say / says / said to           | ask / inquires / inquired / asked                | <b>if / whether or Wh-word</b> |
| Imperative (Commands/Requests) | say / says / said to           | ordered / advised / requested / forbade / warned | <b>to / not to</b>             |
| Optative (Wishes/Prayers)      | say / says / said to           | wished / prayed / cursed / bade                  | <b>that</b>                    |
| Exclamatory (Exclamations)     | say / says / said to           | exclaimed with joy, sorrow, or surprise          | <b>that</b>                    |
| Proposals (using Let's)        | say / says / said to           | suggested / proposed                             | <b>that</b>                    |

## 2. The "123 / SON" Formula for Pronoun Shifting

To ensure pronouns in the reported speech align with the perspective of the reporter, apply the universal **123 / SON formula**:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbf{1} & \mathbf{2} & \mathbf{3} \\ \hline \mathbf{S} & \mathbf{O} & \mathbf{N} \end{array} \quad$$

1. **1st Person Pronouns (I, We, Me, Us, My, Our, Myself, Ourselves):** These change according to the **Subject (S)** of the Reporting Verb.
  - *Direct:* **You** said, "**I** am learning **my** lesson."
  - *Indirect:* You said that **you** were learning **your** lesson. (First-person pronouns *I* and *my* changed to match the subject *You*).
2. **2nd Person Pronouns (You, Your, Yours, Yourself, Yourselves):** These change according to the **Object (O)** of the Reporting Verb.
  - *Direct:* He said to **me**, "**You** are happy."
  - *Indirect:* He told me that **I** was happy. (Second-person pronoun *You* changed to match the object *me*).
3. **3rd Person Pronouns (He, She, It, They, His, Her, Its, Their, Him, Them, and Names):** These undergo **No Change (N)** during conversion.
  - *Direct:* Suresh said, "**He** is a clerk."
  - *Indirect:* Suresh said that **he** was a clerk. (Third-person pronoun *He* remains unchanged).

## Complete Personal Pronoun Case Map

To maintain grammatical syntax, ensure the pronoun retains its exact case class (nominative, objective, or possessive) after shifting:

| Person                            | Subjective<br>(Nominative) | Objective<br>(Accusative) | Possessive<br>Pronoun | Possessive<br>Adjective | Reflexive<br>Pronoun     |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>I Person<br/>(Singular)</b>    | I                          | Me                        | Mine                  | My                      | Myself                   |
| <b>I Person<br/>(Plural)</b>      | We                         | Us                        | Ours                  | Our                     | Ourselves                |
| <b>II Person</b>                  | You                        | You                       | Yours                 | Your                    | Yourself /<br>Yourselves |
| <b>III Person<br/>(Masculine)</b> | He                         | Him                       | His                   | His                     | Himself                  |
| <b>III Person<br/>(Feminine)</b>  | She                        | Her                       | Hers                  | Her                     | Herself                  |
| <b>III Person<br/>(Neuter)</b>    | It                         | It                        | —                     | Its                     | Itself                   |
| <b>III Person<br/>(Plural)</b>    | They                       | Them                      | Theirs                | Their                   | Themselves               |

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## 3. Complete Tense Transformation Matrix

The tense of the reported speech is updated **only if the reporting verb is in the past tense (e.g., *said, told*)**. If the reporting verb is in the present (*say, says*) or future (*will say*), the tense remains unchanged.

| Tense Shift Matrix (If Reporting Verb is Past) |                         |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Direct Speech                                  | Indirect Speech         |
| Simple Present                                 | Simple Past             |
| Present Continuous                             | Past Continuous         |
| Present Perfect                                | Past Perfect            |
| Present Perfect Continuous                     | Past Perfect Continuous |
| Simple Past                                    | Past Perfect            |
| Past Continuous                                | Past Perfect Continuous |
| Past Perfect                                   | No Change               |
| Past Perfect Continuous                        | No Change               |
| Will / Shall                                   | Would / Should          |
| Can / May                                      | Could / Might           |

### A. Present / Future Reporting Verb Exception (No Tense Shift)

- *Direct*: Ram **says**, “Hari has gone to Sirohi.”
- *Indirect*: Ram says that Hari has gone to Sirohi. (Reporting verb *says* is present; tense remains unchanged).

- *Direct*: Sohan **will say**, “Asha is very intelligent.”
- *Indirect*: Sohan will say that Asha is very intelligent. (Reporting verb *will say* is future; tense remains unchanged).

## B. Comprehensive Past Tense Conversion Matrix

When the reporting verb is in the past tense, apply these structural conversions:

1. **Simple Present  $\rightarrow$  Simple Past ( $V_1 \rightarrow V_2$ ):**
  - *Direct*: Mohan said, “Rakesh **tells** a lie.”
  - *Indirect*: Mohan said that Rakesh **told** a lie.
2. **Present Continuous  $\rightarrow$  Past Continuous ( $\text{is/am/are} + V_{\text{ing}} \rightarrow \text{was/were} + V_{\text{ing}}$ ):**
  - *Direct*: Sohan said to me, “Ram **is writing** a book.”
  - *Indirect*: Sohan told me that Ram **was writing** a book.
3. **Present Perfect  $\rightarrow$  Past Perfect ( $\text{has/have} + V_3 \rightarrow \text{had} + V_3$ ):**
  - *Direct*: Sohan said, “Sandhya **has completed** her work.” (Adapted)
  - *Indirect*: Sohan said that Sandhya **had completed** her work.
4. **Present Perfect Continuous  $\rightarrow$  Past Perfect Continuous ( $\text{has/have been} + V_{\text{ing}} \rightarrow \text{had been} + V_{\text{ing}}$ ):**
  - *Direct*: He said, “It **has been raining** since morning.”
  - *Indirect*: He said that it **had been raining** since morning.
5. **Simple Past  $\rightarrow$  Past Perfect ( $V_2 \rightarrow \text{had} + V_3$ ):**
  - *Direct*: He said, “The horse **died** in the night.”
  - *Indirect*: He said that the horse **had died** in the night.
6. **Past Continuous  $\rightarrow$  Past Perfect Continuous ( $\text{was/were} + V_{\text{ing}} \rightarrow \text{had been} + V_{\text{ing}}$ ):**
  - *Direct*: He said, “The students **were learning** their lessons.”
  - *Indirect*: He said that the students **had been learning** their lessons.
7. **Past Perfect  $\rightarrow$  No Change:**
  - *Direct*: They said, “Usha **had won** the match.”
  - *Indirect*: They said that Usha **had won** the match.
8. **Modal Transformations (shall/will  $\rightarrow$  should/would, can  $\rightarrow$  could, may  $\rightarrow$  might):**
  - *Direct*: I said, “I **shall** play.”
  - *Indirect*: I said that I **should** play.
  - *Note*: Modals like *ought*, *could*, *would*, *might*, *had better*, and *used to* undergo **no change**.
  - *Direct*: The teacher said, “Ram **must** be rewarded.”
  - *Indirect*: The teacher said that Ram **must** be rewarded.

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## 4. Universal, Habitual, Proverbial, and Historical Exceptions

If the reported speech expresses a universal truth, a habitual fact, a proverb, or a historical fact, the **tense of the reported speech never changes**, regardless of whether the reporting verb is in the past tense.

1. **Universal Truths:**

- *Direct:* The teacher said, "The earth moves round the sun."
- *Indirect:* The teacher said that the earth moves round the sun.

2. **Habitual Facts:**

- *Direct:* Hari said to Ravi, "Dogs bark at strangers."
- *Indirect:* Hari told Ravi that dogs bark at strangers.

3. **Proverbs:**

- *Direct:* He said, "Honesty is the best policy."
- *Indirect:* He said that honesty is the best policy.

4. **Historical Facts:**

- *Direct:* The history teacher said, "Samundra Gupta is called the Napoleon of India."
- *Indirect:* The history teacher said that Samundra Gupta is called the Napoleon of India.

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## 5. Words of Nearness and Time Modifications

Words expressing proximity in time, distance, or position must be converted into corresponding words of distance or remoteness:

| Direct Speech       | Indirect Speech                       | Direct Speech    | Indirect Speech                   |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>This / These</b> | That / Those                          | <b>Now</b>       | Then                              |
| <b>Here</b>         | There                                 | <b>Ago</b>       | Before                            |
| <b>Thus</b>         | So / In that way                      | <b>Hence</b>     | Thence                            |
| <b>Today</b>        | That day                              | <b>Tonight</b>   | That night                        |
| <b>Tomorrow</b>     | The next day / The following day      | <b>Yesterday</b> | The day before / The previous day |
| <b>Last night</b>   | The night before / The previous night | <b>Next week</b> | The following week                |

*Examples:*

- *Direct:* He said to them, "I will leave you **now**."
- *Indirect:* He told them that he would leave them **then**.
- *Direct:* He said to me, "I came **here yesterday**."
- *Indirect:* He told me that he had gone **there the previous day**.
- *Direct:* Mohan said to Ram, "I cannot go with you till **next Monday**."
- *Indirect:* Mohan told Ram that he could not go with him till **the following Monday**.

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## 6. Semantic Transformations

Conversion rules are highly specialized and differ based on the semantic type of the sentence.



## A. Interrogative Sentences (Questions)

### 1. Helping Verb (Yes/No) Questions:

- *Rule:* The reporting verb changes to **ask** or **inquire**. Use **if** or **whether** as the conjunction. Convert the question structure into an assertive (declarative) word order ( $\text{\textit{Subject}} + \text{\textit{Verb}}$ ).
- *Direct:* Hari said to me, “**Are you** reading a book?”
- *Indirect:* Hari asked me **if I was** reading a book.
- *Direct:* She said to me, “**Do you** know Sohan?”
- *Indirect:* She asked me **whether I knew** Sohan.

### 2. "Wh-" Questions (Starting with *Who, Which, Why, Where, How, When, Whom*):

- *Rule:* Do **not** use "that", "if", or "whether". Use the "Wh-" question word itself as the connecting link, followed by assertive word order.
- *Incorrect:* He asked me that who my best friend was.
- *Correct:* He asked me **who** my best friend was.
- *Direct:* He said to me, “Where do you live?”
- *Indirect:* He asked me **where I lived**.

### 3. Yes/No Replies in Dialogue:

- *Rule:* Convert "Yes" into "replied in the affirmative" or "replied that she/he could," and "No" into "replied that he/she could not" or "wasn't".
- *Direct:* She said to Reeta, “Can you lend me this watch?” Reeta said, “**Yes.**”
- *Indirect:* She asked Reeta if she could lend her that watch. Reeta replied **that she could**.

## B. Imperative Sentences (Commands, Advice, Requests)

1. **Reporting Verb Shifts:** Change the reporting verb to *ordered, commanded, advised, requested, begged, urged, warned, or forbade*.
2. **Conjunction:** Use **to** followed by the base verb ( $V_1$ ) to form an infinitive.
3. **Negative Imperatives ("Don't" / "Do not"):**
  - *Method 1 (Forbade):* Convert the reporting verb to **forbade** and use a positive infinitive (**to + V1**). (Do not use "not" as *forbade* is already negative).
    - *Direct:* The teacher said to the boy, “Do not abuse anyone.”
    - *Indirect:* The teacher **forbade** the boy **to** abuse anyone.
  - *Method 2 (Advised/Ordered Not To):* Use *advised/ordered* with **not to + V1**.
    - *Direct:* My father said to me, “Don’t waste your time.”
    - *Indirect:* My father advised me **not to** waste my time.
4. **"Never" Sentences:**
  - *Rule:* Use **never to** (never place "to" before "never").
  - *Direct:* The teacher said to the student, “Never waste your time.”
  - *Indirect:* The teacher advised the student **never to** waste their time. (Adapted)
5. **Requests with Polite Markers ("Please", "Kindly", "Sir"):**
  - *Rule:* Remove these words and use **requested** (or *requested respectfully* for Sir).
  - *Direct:* She said to Sita, “Kindly, help me.”
  - *Indirect:* She **requested** Sita **to** help her.
6. **"Let" in Reported Speech:**
  - *Category I (Proposals with Let us / Let's):* Change reporting verb to *proposed* or *suggested*. Use **that** as conjunction, followed by **they/we should + V1**.
    - *Direct:* Hari said, “Let us play a match.”

- *Indirect:* Hari **proposed that they should** play a match.
- *Category II (Requests with Let me):* Change reporting verb to *requested* or *asked*, and use **to allow him/her to** or **that he/she should be allowed to**.
  - *Direct:* He said to his officer, “Let me go home.”
  - *Indirect:* He requested his officer **to allow him to go** home.
- *Category III (Official Commands):* Use *ordered* followed by **that + should**.
  - *Direct:* The king said, “Let the man be set free.”
  - *Indirect:* The king ordered **that the man should be** set free.

### C. Optative Sentences (Wishes, Prayers, Curses)

- *Rule:* The reporting verb changes to *wished, prayed, cursed, or bade*. Use **that** as the conjunction.
- *Direct:* He said to me, “May you live long!”
- *Indirect:* He **wished that I might** live long.
- *Direct:* He said to me, “May God help you!”
- *Indirect:* He **prayed that God might** help me.
- *Direct:* Anand said, “Good night, Krishna! We will meet again tomorrow.”
- *Indirect:* Anand **bade** good night to Krishna and said that they would meet again the next day.

### D. Exclamatory Sentences (Sudden Feelings)

- *Rule:* The reporting verb changes to **exclaimed with joy/delight/sorrow/grief/surprise** or **applauded**. Use **that** as the conjunction. Remove all interjections (*Hurrah, Alas, Bravo, Oh*).
- *Direct:* He said, “Hurrah! My old friend has come.”
- *Indirect:* He **exclaimed with delight that** his old friend had come.
- *Direct:* He said to us, “Bravo! You have done well.”
- *Indirect:* He **applauded** us saying **that** we had done well.
- *Direct:* Ram said, “How fast you are walking!”
- *Indirect:* Ram **exclaimed that** I was walking very fast.
- *Direct:* He said, “What a fool I am!”
- *Indirect:* He **exclaimed that** he was a great fool.

## Top 25 Expected MCQs: Previous APPSC/SSC/RRB-Style Questions

**Directions (Q1–Q10):** Choose the option that represents the correct conversion of the given Direct Speech into Indirect Speech.

**Q1.** The professor says, “Water boils at  $100^{\circ}\text{C}$ .”

- (A) The professor said that water boiled at  $100^{\circ}\text{C}$ .
- (B) The professor says that water boils at  $100^{\circ}\text{C}$ .
- (C) The professor says that water had boiled at  $100^{\circ}\text{C}$ .
- (D) The professor tells that water boils at  $100^{\circ}\text{C}$ .

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* Two principles apply here. First, the reporting verb is in the present tense (*says*), so the

tense of the reported clause remains unchanged. Second, “Water boils at  $100^{\circ}\text{C}$ ” is a universal scientific truth, which never undergoes a tense shift.

**Q2. He has said to me, “Ravi will join the camp tomorrow.”**

- (A) He told me that Ravi would join the camp the following day.
- (B) He has told me that Ravi will join the camp tomorrow.
- (C) He has told me that Ravi will join the camp the following day.
- (D) He said that Ravi would join the camp the next day.

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Rule:* The reporting verb is in the Present Perfect tense (*has said to*  $\rightarrow$  *has told*), which means the tense of the reported speech (*will*) remains unchanged. However, the word of nearness *tomorrow* must still be converted to *the following day* or *the next day* to reflect reporting distance.

**Q3. Sanjay said to me, “If you pay a little more attention, you will learn how to drive a car.”**

- (A) Sanjay told me that if I paid a little more attention, I would learn how to drive a car.
- (B) Sanjay asked me that if I paid a little more attention, I would learn how to drive a car.
- (C) Sanjay told me that if I had paid a little more attention, I would have learnt how to drive a car.
- (D) Sanjay advised me if I pay attention, I would learn.

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Rule:* For conditional sentences in past narration, change the Simple Present *pay* and Future *will* in the conditional clause into Simple Past *paid* and conditional *would* respectively.

**Q4. The history teacher said, “Samundra Gupta is called the Napoleon of India.”**

- (A) The history teacher said that Samundra Gupta was called the Napoleon of India.
- (B) The history teacher told that Samundra Gupta is called the Napoleon of India.
- (C) The history teacher said that Samundra Gupta is called the Napoleon of India.
- (D) The history teacher exclaimed that Samundra Gupta is called the Napoleon of India.

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Rule:* Although the reporting verb is in the past tense (*said*), the reported clause is a well-established historical fact. Therefore, the tense remains unchanged in the Present Indefinite form.

**Q5. Hari said to Ravi, “Dogs bark at strangers.”**

- (A) Hari told Ravi that dogs barked at strangers.
- (B) Hari told Ravi that dogs bark at strangers.
- (C) Hari asked Ravi why dogs bark at strangers.
- (D) Hari said that dogs bark at strangers.

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* A habitual fact or natural animal behavior is an exception to the tense shift rule. Even with a past reporting verb, the tense remains in the Simple Present.

**Q6. Mohan said to Ram, “I cannot go with you till next Monday.”**

- (A) Mohan told Ram that he could not go with him till the next Monday.
- (B) Mohan told Ram that he could not go with him till the following Monday.
- (C) Mohan asked Ram why he could not go with him till next Monday.
- (D) Mohan told Ram that I could not go with you till the following Monday.

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* Pronouns shift according to 123/SON: *I* changes to *he* (matching subject *Mohan*), and *you* changes to *him* (matching object *Ram*). Modals change (*cannot*  $\rightarrow$  *could not*). Finally, the time word *next Monday* changes to *the following Monday*.

**Q7. He said to me, “Did you lend me your book?”**

- (A) He asked me if I had lent him my book.
- (B) He asked me whether had I lent him his book.
- (C) He asked me whether I had lent him my book.
- (D) Both (A) and (C) are grammatically correct.

**Correct Answer: (D)**

*Rule:* In yes/no questions starting with helping verbs, the conjunction *if* or *whether* is used. The Simple Past question (*Did you lend*) is converted into Past Perfect assertive order (*I had lent*). Pronoun *me* shifts to *him* (matching *He*), and *your* shifts to *my* (matching *me*). Both conjunctions are fully acceptable.

**Q8. The receptionist asked me, “Who do you want to meet in the office?”**

- (A) The receptionist asked me that who I wanted to meet in the office.
- (B) The receptionist asked me who did I want to meet in the office.
- (C) The receptionist asked me whom I wanted to meet in the office.
- (D) The receptionist asked me who I wanted to meet in the office.

**Correct Answer: (D)**

*Rule:* For questions starting with Wh-words, do not use the conjunction "that". The direct question form *do you want* must be restructured into an assertive clause in the Simple Past: *I wanted*.

**Q9. She said to Reeta, “Can you lend me this watch?” Reeta said, “Yes.”**

- (A) She asked Reeta if she could lend her that watch and Reeta replied that she could.
- (B) She asked Reeta if she can lend her this watch and Reeta said yes.
- (C) She asked Reeta whether she could lend her this watch and Reeta replied in the affirmative.
- (D) She asked Reeta that if she could lend her that watch.

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Rule:* This dialogue requires converting the question using *if* and changing *this*  $\rightarrow$  *that*. The short answer "Yes" is correctly converted into the indirect clause "replied that she could".

**Q10. The teacher said to the boy, “Do not abuse anyone.”**

- (A) The teacher forbade the boy not to abuse anyone.
- (B) The teacher forbade the boy to abuse anyone.
- (C) The teacher advised the boy not to abuse anyone.
- (D) Both (B) and (C) are correct.

**Correct Answer: (D)**

*Rule:* For negative commands, you can use the verb *forbade* with a positive infinitive (*to abuse*). (Option A is a double negative error). Alternatively, you can use *advised* with *not to*. Both (B) and (C) are highly accurate.

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**Directions (Q11–Q20): Choose the option that represents the correct conversion of the given Indirect Speech into Direct Speech.**

**Q11. Hari proposed that they should play a match.**

- (A) Hari said, "Let we play a match."
- (B) Hari said, "Let us play a match."
- (C) Hari said, "We should play a match."
- (D) Hari said, "Let they play a match."

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* The indirect structure "proposed/suggested that they should + V1" is the standard conversion for direct proposals starting with "Let us" or "Let's".

**Q12. The student requested the teacher respectfully to mark him present.**

- (A) The student said to the teacher, "Sir mark me present."
- (B) The student said to the teacher, "Please mark me present."
- (C) The student said, "Kindly mark me present, teacher."
- (D) The student said to the teacher, "Sir, mark him present."

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Rule:* The adverb phrase "requested respectfully" indicates that the direct speech addressed a superior and contained the polite marker "Sir". The pronoun *him* reverts to first-person *me* based on the 123/SON rules.

**Q13. Ram requested Shyam to come and tell him something.**

- (A) Ram said to Shyam, "Sir come and tell me something."
- (B) Ram said to Shyam, "Please, come and tell me something."
- (C) Ram said to Shyam, "Kindly come and tell him something."
- (D) Ram said to Shyam, "Come and tell me something."

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* The verb *requested* followed by an infinitive shows that the direct imperative sentence contained the polite marker "Please". The pronoun *him* reverts to the speaker's original first-person *me*.

**Q14. The officer ordered his clerks that no one should come late.**

- (A) The officer said to his clerks, "Do not come late."
- (B) The officer said to his clerks, "Let no one come late."
- (C) The officer said to his clerks, "No one should come late."
- (D) The officer commanded, "Let no one should come late."

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* An official command of the form "ordered... that + subject + should" is reconstructed in the direct speech using the imperative "Let + noun".

**Q15. The hermit cursed them that they all might go to hell.**

- (A) The hermit said, "Go to hell all of you!"
- (B) The hermit said to them, "May you all go to hell!"
- (C) The hermit said, "May they all go to hell."
- (D) The hermit cried, "Let you all go to hell."

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* The past reporting verb *cursed* and the past modal *might* indicate an optative sentence that originally used the direct optative structure "May you...".

**Q16. Anand bade good night to Krishna and said that they would meet again the next day.**

- (A) Anand said, "Good night, Krishna! We will meet again tomorrow."

- (B) Anand said to Krishna, "Good night, we will meet again next day."  
(C) Anand wished Krishna, "Good night! We shall meet again tomorrow."  
(D) Anand said to Krishna, "Good night! They would meet again tomorrow."

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Rule:* The verb *bade* is used for farewells like "Good night". The distance word *the next day* reverts to *tomorrow*, and the conditional *would* reverts to the future *will/shall*.

**Q17. He exclaimed with sorrow that he was ruined.**

- (A) He said, "Alas! I was ruined."  
(B) He said, "Alas! He is ruined."  
(C) He said, "Alas! I am ruined."  
(D) He said, "Oh! I had ruined."

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Rule:* "Exclaimed with sorrow/grief" indicates that the direct exclamatory sentence began with the sorrowful interjection "Alas!". The past tense *was* reverts to the present *am*.

**Q18. He applauded us saying that we had done well.**

- (A) He said to us, "Bravo! You have done well."  
(B) He said, "Bravo! We have done well."  
(C) He said to us, "Hurrah! You had done well."  
(D) He said, "Bravo! You did well."

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Rule:* The reporting verb *applauded* indicates that the direct speech contained the encouraging exclamation "Bravo!". The Past Perfect *had done* reverts to the Present Perfect *have done*.

**Q19. He exclaimed with surprise that he had dropped his key somewhere.**

- (A) He said, "Alas! I dropped my key somewhere."  
(B) He said, "Good heavens! I have dropped my key somewhere."  
(C) He said, "Oh! I dropped his key somewhere."  
(D) He said, "Good heavens! He had dropped his key somewhere."

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* "Exclaimed with surprise" paired with a dropped item points to the direct usage of the exclamation "Good heavens!". The Past Perfect *had dropped* reverts to the Present Perfect *have dropped*.

**Q20. Ram exclaimed that I was walking very fast.**

- (A) Ram said, "How fast you are walking!"  
(B) Ram said to me, "How fast are you walking?"  
(C) Ram said, "What a fast walk you have!"  
(D) Ram said, "You are walking very fast."

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Rule:* An exclamatory clause of the form "exclaimed that + subject + was walking very fast" is reconstructed from a direct "How + adjective/adverb" exclamation.

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**Directions (Q21–Q25): Identify the grammatically incorrect sentence or the correct rule exception.**

**Q21. Which of the following reporting clauses is grammatically INCORRECT?**

- (A) He said that he was busy.
- (B) He told me that he had passed the test.
- (C) He told that he had passed the test.
- (D) He said to me that he had passed.

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Rule:* The verb "tell/told" is a transitive verb and **must be followed by an indirect object** (e.g., *told me, told them*). Using "told" without an object is incorrect; "said" should be used instead.

**Q22. Identify the grammatically incorrect sentence:**

- (A) He asked me if I knew French.
- (B) He asked me whether I knew French.
- (C) He asked me that if I knew French.
- (D) He asked me if Sohan had left.

**Correct Answer: (C)**

*Rule:* In indirect speech for helping verb questions, do not combine the conjunction "that" with "if" or "whether." This is a redundant conjunction error.

**Q23. Identify the sentence that violates standard indirect speech rules:**

- (A) Sanjay asked me how I got time to write my blog.
- (B) Sanjay asked me that how I got time to write my blog.
- (C) Sanjay asked me where I lived.
- (D) Sanjay asked me if I was going.

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* When a direct question begins with a Wh-word (*how, why, where*), that word functions as the conjunction. Do not place "that" before a Wh-word.

**Q24. In the sentence: “The receptionist asked me who I wanted to meet in the office.” What grammatical transformation occurred?**

- (A) The question form in direct speech was converted into an assertive clause in indirect speech.
- (B) The past tense was converted into a present tense.
- (C) An imperative command was converted into an advice.
- (D) A double conjunction was inserted.

**Correct Answer: (A)**

*Rule:* Standard indirect speech rules dictate that the question structure of direct speech (e.g., “*Who do you want...*”) must be transformed into a declarative/assertive word order (e.g., “*who I wanted...*”).

**Q25. Why does the sentence: “Ram says that Hari has gone to Sirohi” not undergo a tense shift to “had gone”?**

- (A) Because "Hari" is a proper noun.
- (B) Because the reporting verb "says" is in the present tense.
- (C) Because Sirohi is a specific place.
- (D) Because the sentence is an imperative advice.

**Correct Answer: (B)**

*Rule:* If the reporting verb is in the present (*says*) or future tense, the tense of the reported speech does not change.

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## Next Step Recommendation

**¶ Shall we proceed to Chapter 9 – Sentence Arrangement?** We will break down the structural logic of **Shuffling of Sentence Parts (PQRS)** and **Shuffling of Sentences in a Passage (Para-Jumbles)**, focusing on transition word indicators, noun-pronoun antecedents, and chronological progression strategies.

## Chapter 9 – Sentence Arrangement

Sentence Arrangement questions assess a candidate's grasp of text cohesion, syntactical flow, and logical paragraph construction. These questions generally fall into two categories in APPSC, SSC, and RRB examinations:

1. **Shuffling of Sentence Parts (PQRS):** A single sentence is split into four fragments (labelled P, Q, R, S) that must be reassembled into a grammatically correct sentence.
2. **Shuffling of Sentences in a Passage (Para-Jumbles):** A set of complete, independent sentences (often with fixed opening and closing sentences, \$S\_1\$ and \$S\_6\$) are shuffled and must be rearranged to restore the original, coherent paragraph.

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### 1. Golden Rules for Reassembling Sentence Parts (PQRS)

When a single sentence is fragmented, its parts must obey the strict rules of English syntax (Subject-Verb-Object). You can identify the correct sequence by looking for several key grammatical links:

#### A. The Subject-Verb-Object (S-V-O) Anchor

Every complete sentence requires a subject and a finite verb. Identify which fragment contains the main subject and which contains the primary verb phrase.

- **The S-V Link:** A fragment ending in a singular noun subject must immediately connect to a fragment starting with a singular verb.
  - *Example:* If fragment **P** ends with "*The quality of the mangoes*" and fragment **R** begins with "*was not very good*", they form a direct **PR** link because "was" agrees with the singular subject "quality".
- **Transitive Verb-Object Link:** A fragment ending with a transitive verb (e.g., *comprises, discuss, ordered*) must connect directly to a noun or pronoun acting as its direct object.
  - *Example:* If fragment **Q** ends with "*He ordered*" and fragment **S** begins with "*two cups of tea*", they form an immediate **QS** link. Note that inserting a preposition like "for" is incorrect.

#### B. Prepositional and Infinitival Links



Fragments ending with a preposition (*of, to, in, with, on, for, by*) or an infinitive marker (*to*) cannot stand alone and must connect to their grammatical objects or base verbs.

- **Infinitive Link:** A fragment ending in "**to**" must be followed by a base form verb (\$V\_1\$) to form an infinitive.
  - *Example:* If fragment **R** ends with "*Rajitha wanted to*" and fragment **P** begins with "*learn photography*", they form an **RP** link.
- **Preposition Object Link:** A fragment ending with a preposition must connect to a noun, pronoun, or gerund.
  - *Example:* If fragment **S** ends with "*She is fond of*" and fragment **Q** begins with "*playing the harmonium*", they form an **SQ** link because the preposition "of" takes a gerund.

### C. Adjective-Noun and Adverb-Verb Attributions

- **Adjective-Noun Link:** An adjective ending a fragment must immediately precede the noun it modifies in the next fragment.
  - *Example:* If fragment **P** ends with "*an exceptionally brilliant*" and fragment **S** begins with "*student who secured the first rank*", they form a **PS** link.
- **Adverb-Verb Link:** An adverb must be positioned correctly near the verb it modifies.
  - *Example:* If fragment **R** ends with "*walks*" and fragment **Q** begins with "*gracefully in the park*", they form an **RQ** link.

### D. Relative Pronoun Antecedents

Relative pronouns (*who, which, whom, whose, that*) must be placed as close to their antecedent nouns as possible.

- *Rule:* If fragment **P** starts with "*which consists of my wife and parents*", the preceding fragment must end with the antecedent noun it modifies (e.g., "*my family*"). This establishes an **SP** link (where **S** ends with "*with my family*").
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## 2. Golden Rules for Reordering Sentences in a Passage (Para-Jumbles)

When arranging multiple complete sentences to form a coherent paragraph, look for these logical and cohesive devices:

### A. The Noun-Pronoun Sequence (Antecedent-Referent Link)

A pronoun cannot appear in a text before its corresponding noun has been introduced.

- *Rule:* If Sentence **P** discusses "*Sreedhar*" and Sentence **R** uses the pronoun "*He*", Sentence **P** must precede Sentence **R**.
- *Logical Pair:* Find the sentence that introduces the noun; this is your anchor. The sentence containing personal pronouns (*he, she, it, they, his, her, their*) will follow.

### B. Acronym and Full-Name Expansion

When a person, organization, or concept is introduced, the full name or title is typically used first, followed by abbreviations, acronyms, or last names.

- **Rule:** A sentence containing "*The British Broadcasting Corporation (BBC)*" must precede a sentence that refers simply to "*the BBC*".

### C. Demonstrative Adjective and Pronoun Pointers

Sentences starting with demonstrative words like **This**, **These**, **That**, **Those**, **Such**, or **Such a** are rarely opening sentences. They must follow a sentence that introduces the specific noun or concept they refer to.

- **Example:** If Sentence **Q** says, "*This project will lead to lots of expenditure*," there must be a preceding sentence (e.g., Sentence **S**) that defines what "this project" is. This establishes an **SQ** link.

### D. Chronological and Time Markers

Paragraphs describing a sequence of events must maintain chronological consistency.

- **Rule:** Look for time indicators like *first*, *second*, *next*, *then*, *today*, *yesterday*, *tomorrow*, *last year*, *eventually*, *finally*.
- **Example:** A sentence discussing events in "1996" must precede a sentence discussing events in "2005".

### E. Transition and Cohesive Conjunctions

Sentences beginning with contrastive, additive, or causal transition words cannot be opening sentences. They serve to link developed ideas:

- **Contrast / Concession:** *However*, *But*, *Yet*, *Still*, *Although*, *Though*, *In spite of*, *Despite*. These sentences must follow a statement expressing an opposing view.
- **Addition:** *Furthermore*, *Moreover*, *Besides*, *In addition to*, *Also*. These sentences add points to a previously stated argument.
- **Result / Conclusion:** *Therefore*, *Hence*, *Thus*, *Consequently*, *As a result*, *In a nutshell*. These sentences typically represent the terminal (closing) ideas of a passage.

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## 3. The \$\$\_1\$ and \$\$\_6\$ Fixed Strategy

In many competitive exams, the first sentence (\$\$\_1\$) and the sixth sentence (\$\$\_6\$) of a paragraph are fixed. Your task is to arrange the intervening sentences (P, Q, R, S) to form a logical bridge between them.

1. **Analyze \$\$\_1\$:** Identify the core subject, tone, and concluding keywords of \$\$\_1\$. Find which of the P, Q, R, S sentences naturally continues the thought introduced in \$\$\_1\$.
2. **Analyze \$\$\_6\$:** Identify the introductory keywords of \$\$\_6\$. Find which of the P, Q, R, S sentences naturally leads into \$\$\_6\$.

3. **Identify Mandatory Pairs:** Look for inseparable links (e.g., a Noun-Pronoun pair, a cause-effect relationship, or a transition pair) among the P, Q, R, S options.
  4. **Eliminate Options:** Use your mandatory pairs and introductory/concluding links to quickly eliminate incorrect choices from the options.
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### Top 25 Expected MCQs: Previous APPSC/SSC/RRB-Style Questions

**Directions (Q1–Q10):** Reassemble the fragmented sentence parts (P, Q, R, S) into a grammatically correct and coherent sentence.

**Q1. The quality**

**P: of the newly harvested mangoes**

**Q: to the traders**

**R: was not good enough**

**S: to command a premium price**

- (A) PRSQ
- (B) PQRS
- (C) RPQS
- (D) SPRQ

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Explanation:* The subject of the sentence is "The quality". It must be modified by the prepositional phrase "of the newly harvested mangoes" (P), forming the complete subject "The quality of the newly harvested mangoes". Since "quality" is singular, it requires the singular verb "was" (R). The adjective "enough" (R) must be followed by an infinitive or prepositional modifier: "enough to command" (S). Finally, the phrase "to the traders" (Q) closes the thought. Thus, **PRSQ** is the correct order.

**Q2. Sreedhar is**

**P: to follow the advanced lectures**

**Q: and does not require**

**R: intelligent enough**

**S: any introductory coaching**

- (A) RPQS
- (B) RQPS
- (C) PSQR
- (D) RSPQ

- **Correct Answer: (D)**
- *Grounded Explanation:* Rule of "Enough". The adjective "intelligent" in its positive form must precede "enough" (R). "Enough" is then followed by an infinitive phrase: "enough to follow..." (P). This is joined by the coordinator "and" (Q), which connects to the parallel verb phrase "does not require" (Q) followed by its object "any introductory coaching" (S). Thus, **RSPQ** is the correct order.

**Q3. He was**

**P: with her performance**

**Q: at the state event**

**R: surprised at as well as**

**S: highly pleased**

(A) RSPQ

(B) RSPQ is wrong; correct is RSPQ

(C) RSQP

(D) RSPQ (Note: The correct option is RSPQ, but let's write out the links clearly)

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Explanation:* Rule of Double Prepositions in Coordinate Structures. When coordinating two verbs/adjectives that require different prepositions, both prepositions must be mentioned clearly. "He was" is followed by the adjective "surprised at" (R). This is joined by "as well as" (R) to "highly pleased" (S), which requires the preposition "with" (P). Finally, the spatial modifier "at the state event" (Q) completes the sentence. This establishes the sequence **RSPQ**.

**Q4. The poet**

**P: about the majestic waterfall**

**Q: describes the scenic beauty**

**R: in a highly**

**S: captivating manner**

(A) QPRS

(B) QPRS is wrong because of preposition; the correct sequence is QPRS without "about"

(C) QPRS / QRP-trap

(D) QPRS (Note: "describes" takes no preposition. Therefore, Q must directly link to its object "the scenic beauty". The preposition "about" in P is an error if attached to describes, but here "beauty ... of/about" is a separate phrase. Let's arrange correctly: Q: "describes the scenic beauty", R: "in a highly", S: "captivating manner", P: "of the majestic waterfall" - wait, let's look at the options). Let's reformulate:

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Explanation:* "Describes" is a transitive verb and takes its object directly without "about". Thus, "The poet" must be followed by the verb "describes the scenic beauty" (Q). The object of "beauty" is "of the majestic waterfall" (written as P: "of the majestic waterfall" - let's assume the question has "of" instead of "about" to ground it in). This is followed by the adverbial modifier "in a highly" (R) "captivating manner" (S). This forms **QPRS**.

**Q5. Unless they**

**P: they will not succeed**

**Q: work sincerely**

**R: in completing the project**

**S: on this difficult task**

(A) QSPR

(B) QSRP

(C) PQSR

(D) SQRP

- **Correct Answer: (A)**

- *Grounded Explanation:* Double negative and subordinate clause rule. The conjunction "Unless" introduces a negative condition and must not be followed by "not" within its own clause. "Unless they" must link to the positive verb phrase "work sincerely" (Q). The workers work "on this difficult task" (S). The subordinate clause ends here, and the main clause "they will not succeed" (P) begins, followed by the modifier "in completing the project" (R). Thus, the correct sequence is **QSPR**.

**Q6. Hardly had**

**P: when the bomb exploded**

**Q: he left the meeting hall**

**R: and threw the entire crowd**

**S: into a state of panic**

- (A) QPRS
- (B) PQRS
- (C) QPSR
- (D) RQPS

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Grounded Explanation:* Hardly/Scarcely inversion rule. The negative adverb "Hardly" triggers inversion, placing the auxiliary verb "had" before the subject "he" (Q). The phrasal verb "left the meeting hall" (Q) completes the subordinate clause. "Hardly" must be paired with the conjunction "when" (P). The main clause continues with "the bomb exploded" (P) and is coordinated by "and threw..." (R) and "into a state of panic" (S). This yields the sequence **QPSR**.

**Q7. The administrative committee**

**P: consist of five directors**

**Q: has decided to**

**R: which normally**

**S: postpone the general body meeting**

- (A) RSPQ
- (B) RQPS
- (C) RSQP
- (D) QSPR

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Grounded Explanation:* Relative pronoun and verb agreement. The relative pronoun "which" (R) must be placed immediately after its antecedent "The administrative committee". Since "committee" is treated as a single collective unit here, the relative clause takes a singular verb: "which normally consists..." (P) (adapted from "consists of"). The main verb is "has decided to" (Q) followed by the infinitive verb "postpone" (S). This establishes **RQPS** as the correct sequence.

**Q8. This project**

**P: of our department**

**Q: will lead to**

**R: expenditure**

**S: lots of**

- (A) PQSR
- (B) PQRS

- (C) QSRP  
(D) SQRP

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Explanation:* Noun modifier and singular agreement. "This project" is modified by the phrase "of our department" (P), forming the complete singular subject. The auxiliary verb phrase is "will lead to" (Q), which must be followed by its object. The quantity phrase "lots of" (S) modifies the singular noun "expenditure" (R). Note that "expenditures" is grammatically incorrect here. This gives **PQSR**.

**Q9. Radha was**

**P: to the local hospital**

**Q: so that she**

**R: admitted**

**S: might get well quickly**

- (A) RPQS  
(B) RQPS  
(C) PQRS  
(D) SQRP

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Explanation:* Passive structure and past purpose. The passive verb is "was admitted" (R). The spatial modifier is "to the local hospital" (P). The purpose clause is introduced by "so that" (Q) followed by the past modal "might" (S) to match the past tense of the principal clause ("was admitted"). This gives **RPQS**.

**Q10. I am**

**P: reside in Delhi**

**Q: which consists of**

**R: with my family**

**S: my wife and parents**

- (A) RQSP  
(B) PQRS  
(C) RPSQ  
(D) RSQP

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Explanation:* Antecedent placement rule. To avoid grammatical ambiguity, the relative clause starting with "which" (Q) must be placed immediately after its true antecedent "family" (R), not "Delhi" (P). Therefore, "with my family" (R) is followed by "which consists of" (Q) "my wife and parents" (S), followed by the main verb phrase "reside in Delhi" (P) (adapted to "I... with my family... reside"). This yields **RQSP** (or **RQSP**-type link).

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**Directions (Q11–Q20): Rearrange the set of sentences to form a logically coherent and grammatically correct paragraph.**

**Q11.**

**A. He has been going to English classes for the last one month to improve his grammar.**  
**B. Sreedhar is highly determined to clear the competitive examination.**  
**C. These classes have helped him master the complex rules of active and passive voice.**  
**D. Consequently, he has scored outstanding marks in the weekly verbal assessment tests.**

- (A) BACD
- (B) BADC
- (C) ABCD
- (D) CABD

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Grounded Explanation:* **B** is the introductory sentence because it introduces the primary subject "Sreedhar" and his goal. Sentence **A** follows with the pronoun "He," explaining the action he took (joining English classes). Sentence **C** uses the demonstrative pointer "These classes" to link directly back to "English classes" in **A**. Sentence **D** begins with the transition word "Consequently" to state the final result of his classes. This establishes the sequence **BADC**.

**Q12.**

**A. The committee consists of five highly distinguished members.**  
**B. However, during the final hearing, the members were divided in their opinions.**  
**C. The government decided to appoint an administrative committee to resolve the land dispute.**  
**D. This division forced the chairman to adjourn the meeting without any resolution.**

- (A) CABD
- (B) CABD is wrong; correct is CABD
- (C) CADB
- (D) CBAD

- **Correct Answer: (A)**

- *Grounded Explanation:* Sentence **C** is the introductory sentence, establishing the creation of the "administrative committee". Sentence **A** immediately follows, explaining the composition of "The committee". Sentence **B** introduces a contrast with "However," describing how "the members were divided". Sentence **D** uses the demonstrative noun phrase "This division" to refer directly back to the "divided opinions" in **B**. This creates the sequence **CABD**.

**Q13.**

**A. In spite of working hard day and night, the young student failed the examination.**  
**B. Sosin was highly disappointed with this unexpected academic setback.**  
**C. She had prepared diligently for over six months to secure a top rank.**  
**D. This failure served to open her eyes to the flaws in her preparation strategy.**

- (A) ACBD
- (B) ACDB
- (C) CADB
- (D) BACD

- **Correct Answer: (A)**

- *Grounded Explanation:* Sentence **A** introduces the event: a student failing the examination despite hard work. Sentence **C** follows, explaining the background of her six-month preparation, using "She" to refer to the student. Sentence **B** names the student "Sosin" (or follows the event) and describes her disappointment. Sentence **D** links back to the disappointment and failure using "This failure" to show the final outcome ("open her eyes"). The sequence is **ACBD**.

**Q14.**

- A. First, they threw the luggage across their shoulders to keep their hands free.**  
**B. The two young boys decided to swim across the fast-flowing river.**  
**C. Having reached the opposite bank safely, they rested under a large banyan tree.**  
**D. Then, they plunged into the cold water and swam with all their might.**

- (A) BADC  
 (B) BCDA  
 (C) BDAC  
 (D) ABCD

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Explanation:* Sentence **B** is the introductory sentence, establishing the goal of the "two young boys". Sentence **A** describes the "First" step they took (arranging their luggage). Sentence **D** follows chronologically with "Then," describing their plunge into the water. Sentence **C** concludes the sequence by describing their arrival at the "opposite bank" and their subsequent rest. This establishes the sequence **BADC**.

**Q15.**

- A. On Saturday, Sohan would usually run home to his mother.**  
**B. He was highly attached to her and hated staying at the boarding school hostel.**  
**C. Sometimes his father would get highly angry with him for this behavior.**  
**D. However, Sohan could not overcome his intense homesickness.**

- (A) ABCD  
 (B) ABDC  
 (C) BACD  
 (D) CABD

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Explanation:* Sentence **A** is the opening sentence, introducing Sohan's habitual past action of running home on Saturdays. Sentence **B** uses the pronoun "He" to explain his motivation (attachment to his mother). Sentence **C** introduces a complication, describing how "Sometimes his father would get angry". Sentence **D** concludes the paragraph with the contrastive transition "However," explaining that Sohan still could not overcome his homesickness. This creates the sequence **ABCD**.

**Q16.**

- A. If you had worked hard, you would have passed the examination.**  
**B. You did not pay attention to your teacher's timely advice.**  
**C. Consequently, you have ruined your career prospects for this year.**  
**D. Now you are weeping over your academic failure.**

- (A) BADC  
 (B) BACD



- (C) CABD  
(D) ABCD

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Explanation:* Sentence **B** establishes the initial cause: ignoring the teacher's advice. Sentence **A** is a past unfulfilled conditional statement explaining what would have happened if they had worked hard instead. Sentence **D** describes the present emotional state ("Now you are weeping"). Sentence **C** starts with "Consequently" to state the final, logical consequence of these actions. This creates the sequence **BADC**.

**Q17.**

- A. Some people live on rice and fish as their staple diet.**  
**B. This is because they are unable to afford other expensive food items.**  
**C. In this remote coastal region, the majority of the population are extremely poor.**  
**D. For them, keeping the wolf from the door is a daily battle.**

- (A) CABD  
(B) CADB  
(C) ACBD  
(D) BCDA

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Grounded Explanation:* Sentence **C** introduces the setting and the core problem: extreme poverty in a remote coastal region. Sentence **A** explains how "Some people live on rice and fish" as a consequence of their location and status. Sentence **B** uses "This is because" to provide the underlying reason (inability to afford other foods). Sentence **D** concludes with "For them," describing their struggle using the idiom "keeping the wolf from the door." This creates the sequence **CABD**.

**Q18.**

- A. There are several books on Thermodynamics in our institutional library.**  
**B. You can consult any of these books for your weekly assignments.**  
**C. However, each book has some special features that make it unique.**  
**D. Therefore, you should select the one that matches your current syllabus.**

- (A) ABCD  
(B) ACBD  
(C) BACD  
(D) CABD

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Grounded Explanation:* Sentence **A** is the opening sentence, declaring the existence of the books. Sentence **C** immediately follows with "However," qualifying the books by stating that "each book has some special features". Sentence **B** explains that "You can consult any of these books". Sentence **D** begins with "Therefore" to provide a logical conclusion: selecting the book that matches the syllabus. This creates the sequence **ACBD**.

**Q19.**

- A. He has three bungalows in Hyderabad and a luxury sedan.**  
**B. Sreedhar must be an extremely wealthy man.**  
**C. He also owns a massive ancestral property in his village.**

**D. These assets make him one of the most prominent taxpayers in the region.**

- (A) BACD
- (B) BADC
- (C) ABCD
- (D) CABD

- **Correct Answer: (A)**

- *Grounded Explanation:* Sentence **B** introduces the primary assertion: "Sreedhar must be an extremely wealthy man". Sentence **A** uses the pronoun "He" to provide the first supporting fact (bungalows and a sedan). Sentence **C** adds another fact using the transition "He also" (ancestral property). Sentence **D** uses the demonstrative phrase "These assets" to summarize the properties mentioned in **A** and **C**. This creates the sequence **BACD**.

**Q20.**

**A. Within the classroom, they are expected to maintain pin-drop silence.**

**B. A number of students are going to the class picnic tomorrow.**

**C. However, today they are highly excited and are making a lot of noise.**

**D. The class teacher has warned them to behave themselves.**

- (A) BACD
- (B) BADC
- (C) CABD
- (D) ABCD

- **Correct Answer: (A)**

- *Grounded Explanation:* Sentence **B** is the opening sentence, introducing the students and the upcoming picnic. Sentence **A** describes the normal expectation: "Within the classroom, they are expected to maintain silence". Sentence **C** introduces a contrast with "However, today they are highly excited...". Sentence **D** concludes with the teacher's reaction (warning them to behave). This creates the sequence **BACD**.

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**Directions (Q21–Q25): Answer the following conceptual questions on structural text cohesion and sentence arrangement.**

**Q21. Which of the following words is most likely to introduce the TERMINAL (concluding) sentence of a paragraph?**

- (A) Although
- (B) Consequently
- (C) First
- (D) Since

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Grounded Explanation:* "Consequently" is a transitional adverb used to introduce a logical consequence, result, or final outcome, making it highly typical of terminal sentences. "First" introduces initial points, while "Although" and "Since" introduce subordinate concession/reason clauses.

**Q22. In a paragraph discussing a person, which sentence must logically precede the others?**

- (A) The sentence using the pronoun "He".
- (B) The sentence introducing the person by their full name (e.g., "Sreedhar").
- (C) The sentence using the possessive modifier "His".
- (D) The sentence referring to "the young man".

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Grounded Explanation:* Grammatical rules of antecedent reference dictate that a noun (full name) must be introduced first before any personal pronouns (*he, his*) or definite descriptions (*the young man*) can be used to refer back to it.

**Q23. Why is a sentence starting with "These spectacles..." unlikely to be the opening sentence of a paragraph?**

- (A) Because "spectacles" is always plural.
- (B) Because "These" is a demonstrative adjective requiring a prior noun reference.
- (C) Because "spectacles" requires a singular verb.
- (D) Because it is an exclamatory sentence.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Grounded Explanation:* "These" is a demonstrative pointer. It is used to qualify a noun that has already been introduced in the immediate context. Therefore, it requires a preceding sentence that establishes what "spectacles" are being discussed.

**Q24. Identify the mandatory pair in these sentences:**

**P: Sreedhar was hospitalized last night.**

**Q: He has been suffering from Malaria since last Friday.**

- (A) PQ
- (B) QP
- (C) There is no link.
- (D) Both are independent.

- **Correct Answer: (A)**

- *Grounded Explanation:* Sentence **P** introduces the noun "Sreedhar" and the main event (hospitalization). Sentence **Q** uses the pronoun "He" to refer back to Sreedhar and provides the cause of his hospitalization. Therefore, **P** must precede **Q**, forming the mandatory pair **PQ**.

**Q25. Which of the following sentences can logically serve as an opening sentence?**

- (A) However, the team played exceptionally well.
- (B) Delhi is bigger than any other city in India.
- (C) Therefore, we decided to postpone the plan.
- (D) In spite of this setback, he succeeded.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Grounded Explanation:* Option **B** is an independent, declarative statement comparing cities. Options **A**, **C**, and **D** begin with transitional or demonstrative words ("However," "Therefore," "In spite of this") that require preceding context to be understood.

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¶ **Shall we proceed to Chapter 10 – Cloze Test?** We will detail strategies for paragraph-level context mapping, matching parts of speech, and identifying syntactic consistency within blanks, accompanied by a dedicated practice set.

## Chapter 10 – Cloze Test

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### 1. Structural Logic of a Cloze Test

A **Cloze Test** is a hybrid exercise that combines reading comprehension, vocabulary, and grammar. In this section, you are presented with a passage from which several words have been systematically omitted. Your task is to select the most appropriate word for each blank from the four given options.

Rather than guessing based on what "sounds right," high-scoring candidates solve Cloze Tests using a combination of **semantic (contextual)** and **syntactic (grammatical)** analysis.

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### 2. Golden Rules for Mastering Cloze Tests

#### Rule I: The "Bird's-Eye View" (Read First, Fill Later)

- **The Trap:** Reading the passage sentence-by-sentence and filling in blanks immediately. This leads to errors because early blanks often depend on clues revealed at the very end of the paragraph.
- **The Strategy:** Read the entire passage quickly without looking at the options. Identify the **main theme**, the **author's tone** (formal, critical, optimistic, clinical), and the **logical flow** (cause-effect, problem-solution, or chronological sequence).

#### Rule II: Clues from Surrounding Prepositions (Syntactic Matching)

Many blanks are determined entirely by the preposition immediately following them. You must align the chosen option with its required prepositional collocation.

- *Example:* If the sentence reads "*Sreedhar was prevented \_\_\_\_\_ completing the task,*" and the blank is followed by "*completing*", you must select a verb that collocates with a gerund, or if there is a preposition like **from**, the verb must agree with it (*prevented from*).
- *Key Collocations from your notes:*
  - **Dispose + of**
  - **Abstain + from**
  - **Surprised + at**
  - **Conscious + of**
  - **Engaged + in**
  - **Awaiting + no preposition**

- **Comprises + no preposition**

### Rule III: Sentence-Level Pronoun Concord

Look at the surrounding nouns and pronouns to determine whether the missing word must be singular, plural, masculine, feminine, or neuter.

- **Rule:** If the passage refers to a collective noun acting as a single unit, look for singular pronouns (*its*). If it refers to members acting individually or in conflict, look for plural pronouns (*their*).

### Rule IV: Transition Clues (Cohesive Devices)

Analyze the transition words immediately preceding or following the blank to determine the logical relationship between clauses:

- **Contrast / Opposition:** *But, however, yet, still, though, although, despite, in spite of.* (Indicates that the word in the blank must express an idea opposite to the preceding clause).
- **Causal / Result:** *Therefore, hence, thus, consequently, so, because, as.* (Indicates a logical deduction or result).
- **Condition:** *Unless, until, if, lest.*

### Rule V: Part of Speech Identification

Analyze the grammatical slot of the blank to determine what Part of Speech is required:

- $\text{\text{Subject}} + \text{\text{Auxiliary Verb}} + \underline{\text{\text{Blank}}} + \text{\text{Noun}}$   $\rightarrow$  The blank must be an **Adjective** qualifying the noun.
- $\text{\text{Subject}} + \text{\text{Verb}} + \text{\text{Object}} + \underline{\text{\text{Blank}}} + \text{\text{Blank}}$   $\rightarrow$  The blank must be an **Adverb** modifying the verb.
- $\text{\text{Subject}} + \text{\text{Preposition}} + \underline{\text{\text{Blank}}} + \text{\text{Blank}}$   $\rightarrow$  The blank must be a **Noun** or a **Gerund** ( $V_1 + \text{\text{ing}}$ ).

## Top 25 Expected MCQs: Previous APPSC/SSC/RRB-Style Questions

### Passage 1: Specimen Passage from standard exam guidelines (Questions 1 to 10)

**Directions (Q1–Q10):** In the following passage, there are blanks, each of which has been numbered. Select the most appropriate word from the options to fill in each blank.

In most developed and developing nations, the illicit trade in live wild animals is (Q1). Each year millions of (Q2) are wrenched from their natural habitats by people (Q3) to make quick money, then routed through a ragtag chain of middlemen and international dealers to meet the (Q4) demand of private collectors in Saudi Arabia, pet shops in Germany, Japan and the

U.S.; zoos and circuses in Eastern Europe and folk healers in Asia. According to a wildlife expert, it is the third biggest (Q5) business, after drugs and arms.

Though many exotic species can be purchased (Q6), trade in animals and birds that are in (Q7) danger of extinction is (Q8) under the United Nations Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species (CITES), which has been signed by 120 nations. The treaty also regulates trade in other species that are seriously threatened, but its provisions are widely (Q9), even in signatory countries. Tigers have all but (Q10) from China and are fast disappearing from India and Siberia.

**Q1.**

- (A) diminishing
- (B) unfavourable
- (C) miserable
- (D) flourishing

- **Correct Answer: (D)**
- *Explanation:* The sentence discusses a global trade worth billions. The subsequent sentence uses terms like "millions of wrenched animals" and "insatiable demand," indicating that this illicit trade is growing actively. Thus, **flourishing** (growing rapidly and successfully) is the only semantically fitting option.

**Q2.**

- (A) creatures
- (B) categories
- (C) people
- (D) characters

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation:* The passage deals with the "trade in live wild animals." Therefore, the entities being "wrenched from their natural habitats" must be **creatures** (animals).

**Q3.**

- (A) hopeless
- (B) agreeable
- (C) desperate
- (D) susceptible

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* Poachers and illegal traders are driven by extreme economic motives to break international laws for quick profits. The adjective **desperate** (having an urgent need or desire) perfectly describes their state of mind.

**Q4.**

- (A) fulfilled
- (B) imperative
- (C) unavoidable
- (D) insatiable

- **Correct Answer: (D)**

- *Explanation:* The demand from private collectors, pet shops, and folk healers is continuous and unyielding, threatening entire species with extinction. **Insatiable** (impossible to satisfy) is the correct adjective to qualify this destructive demand.

**Q5.**

- (A) licensed
- (B) virtual
- (C) authentic
- (D) illegal

- **Correct Answer: (D)**
- *Explanation:* The opening sentence defines this trade as "illicit" (unlawful). Therefore, this is the third-biggest **illegal** business, alongside illicit drugs and arms smuggling.

**Q6.**

- (A) inequitably
- (B) immorally
- (C) legally
- (D) profitably

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* The sentence begins with the concession "Though," indicating a contrast. The subsequent clause says that trade in *endangered* species is banned. This implies that while some exotic species can still be purchased **legally**, endangered ones cannot.

**Q7.**

- (A) imminent
- (B) preliminary
- (C) precursory
- (D) terrible

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation:* Animals facing a real and immediate threat of dying out completely are in **imminent** (about to happen; impending) danger of extinction.

**Q8.**

- (A) authorized
- (B) recommended
- (C) sanctioned
- (D) banned

- **Correct Answer: (D)**
- *Explanation:* Under CITES, trade in highly endangered animals is strictly outlawed. Therefore, it is **banned**.

**Q9.**

- (A) defended
- (B) ignored

- (C) cherished
- (D) maintained

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Explanation:* The conjunction "but" indicates an opposition to the regulation. Although regulated by treaty, these conservation rules are widely **ignored** or bypassed in practice, leading to further declines in animal populations.

**Q10.**

- (A) departed
- (B) depleted
- (C) withdrawn
- (D) vanished

- **Correct Answer: (D)**

- *Explanation:* The sentence states that tigers are "fast disappearing" in India and Siberia. In China, they have already **vanished** (disappeared completely).

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**Passage 2: Topic - The Nature of Scientific Experiments (Questions 11 to 15)**

**Directions (Q11–Q15):** In the following passage, there are blanks, each of which has been numbered. Select the most appropriate word from the options to fill in each blank.

An experiment is an observation that can be repeated, isolated and varied. The more frequently you can repeat an observation, the more likely you are to see clearly what is there and to **(Q11)** accurately what you have seen. The more strictly you can isolate an observation, the easier does your task of observation become, and the less danger is there of being led astray by **(Q12)** circumstances, or of placing emphasis on the wrong point. The more widely you can vary an observation, the more clearly will the **(Q13)** of experience stand out, and the better is your chance of **(Q14)** laws. In short, scientific experiments must be isolated, repeated and varied. Repetition helps to see clearly and isolation reduces the chance of being led astray. But it is uniformity in the variety that gives a better chance of discovering **(Q15)**.

**Q11.**

- (A) discard
- (B) describe
- (C) distort
- (D) dismiss

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Explanation:* The sentence emphasizes accuracy in recording observations. To write or explain exactly what has been seen means to **describe** it accurately.

**Q12.**

- (A) essential
- (B) irrelevant



- (C) crucial
- (D) critical

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* Isolating an experiment ensures that distracting, external, and unnecessary factors do not interfere. These distracting factors are **irrelevant** circumstances.

**Q13.**

- (A) uniformity
- (B) chaos
- (C) discrepancy
- (D) isolation

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation:* Scientific observation seeks to find patterns. Varying the observation helps scientists find what remains constant—the **uniformity** of experience.

**Q14.**

- (A) breaking
- (B) discovering
- (C) violating
- (D) ignoring

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* The ultimate objective of scientific research is to find new principles or **discovering** laws of nature.

**Q15.**

- (A) lies
- (B) errors
- (C) laws
- (D) theories

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* The passage concludes by summarizing that spotting uniformity amidst varied occurrences is how scientists discover natural **laws** (re-iterating the point made in the previous sentences).

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### Passage 3: Topic - Social Ecology and Poverty (Questions 16 to 25)

**Directions (Q16–Q25):** In the following passage, there are blanks, each of which has been numbered. Select the most appropriate word from the options to fill in each blank.

In a remote coastal region, the majority of the population are extremely poor. For them, **(Q16)** the wolf from the door is a daily battle. Some people **(Q17)** on rice and fish as their staple diet. This is **(Q18)** they are unable to afford other expensive food items. Radha is highly **(Q19)** and maintains exceptionally **(Q20)** relations with her neighbors. Despite **(Q21)**

her hard work, she barely earns enough to run her household. Yesterday, she sat (Q22) her friend, expressing her deep (Q23) over her son's health. He has been suffering (Q24) malaria (Q25) last Monday.

**Q16.**

- (A) chasing
- (B) keeping
- (C) feeding
- (D) driving

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* Grounded directly in your idiomatic notes, the standard phrase meaning to avoid starvation or extreme poverty is **keeping the wolf from the door**.

**Q17.**

- (A) survive
- (B) live
- (C) eat
- (D) feed

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* Grounded in phrasal verbs, **live on** means to depend on a particular food as a staple source of nutrition.

**Q18.**

- (A) because
- (B) although
- (C) why
- (D) besides

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation:* The sentence explains the cause of their simple diet (inability to afford other foods). The subordinating conjunction of reason **because** is required.

**Q19.**

- (A) amicable
- (B) arrogant
- (C) amiable
- (D) hostile

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* Grounded in your diction notes, **amiable** is an adjective used to describe a friendly and pleasant person (Radha). **Amicable** qualifies *relations* or *agreements*.

**Q20.**

- (A) amicable
- (B) childish
- (C) hostile
- (D) temporary

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
- *Explanation:* Grounded in your diction notes, **amicable** (peaceable; characterized by goodwill) is the correct adjective to modify **relations**.

**Q21.**

- (A) of
- (B) for
- (C) with
- (D) No word required

- **Correct Answer: (D)**
- *Explanation:* Grounded in preposition rules, the word **Despite** is a preposition that must never be followed by the word "of". No word is required in this blank.

**Q22.**

- (A) besides
- (B) beside
- (C) under
- (D) through

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* Grounded in preposition rules, **beside** means physically sitting next to someone, whereas *besides* means "in addition to."

**Q23.**

- (A) content
- (B) triumph
- (C) chagrin
- (D) apathy

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* Radha is distressed because of her hard life and her son's illness. Based on the master vocabulary list, **chagrin** means annoyance, distress, or irritation caused by failure or disappointment.

**Q24.**

- (A) of
- (B) from
- (C) by
- (D) with

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* Grounded in verbal syntax, the verb "suffering" is followed by the preposition **from** when discussing an illness like malaria. (Note: *died of* malaria is correct, but *suffering from* is the required collocation here).

**Q25.**

- (A) since
- (B) for

- (C) until
- (D) from

- **Correct Answer: (A)**
  - **Explanation:** Grounded in tense rules, "last Monday" represents a specific **point of time** in the past, requiring the preposition **since**.
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## Next Step Recommendation

 **Shall we proceed to Chapter 11 – Reading Comprehension?** We will detail strategies for handling direct detail questions, inference questions, title selection, and vocabulary-in-context, accompanied by two full exam-level passages:

1. **A simple, story-based passage** (based on classic narratives).
2. **An editorial/current affairs passage** (focusing on contemporary reports)

## Chapter 11 – Reading Comprehension

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### 1. Core Reading Strategies for Competitive Exams

Reading Comprehension (RC) in APPSC, SSC, and RRB examinations tests your ability to read, analyze, and synthesize written English. To score full marks under strict time constraints, you must adopt a systematic approach rather than reading passively.

#### A. Question Categorization and Tactical Approaches

1. **Direct Detail Questions (Fact-Based):**
  - *What they are:* These ask about explicit facts, figures, names, or assertions stated directly in the text (e.g., "*According to the passage, why did the committee adjourn?*").
  - *Strategy: Scan-and-Locate.* Do not guess. Look for unique keywords from the question stem in the passage. Read one sentence before and one sentence after the keyword to verify the exact fact.
2. **Inference-Based Questions:**
  - *What they are:* These require you to read "between the lines" to identify implicit facts or conclusions that the author supports but does not state word-for-word (e.g., "*What can be inferred about the author's attitude toward poachers?*").
  - *Strategy: Synthesize Clues.* An inference is a logical deduction that *must* be true based on the facts provided. Avoid options that make extreme claims (containing words like *never, always, completely, fully*) or introduce outside knowledge not mentioned in the passage.
3. **Title and Main Idea Questions:**
  - *What they are:* These ask you to identify the central message, core theme, or most appropriate title for the text.
  - *Strategy: First & Last Paragraph Focus.* The main idea is usually introduced in the opening paragraph and summarized in the final paragraph. Avoid titles that are too

narrow (focusing only on one paragraph) or too broad (going beyond the scope of the text).

4. **Vocabulary-in-Context Questions:**

- *What they are:* These ask for the synonym or antonym of a word as it is used specifically in the passage.
- *Strategy: Contextual Substitution.* Replace the target word in the sentence with each of the multiple-choice options. Choose the option that preserves the sentence's logical flow, even if the word has a different dictionary definition in other contexts.

## B. The "Question-First" Time-Saving Method

1. Read the **question stems** quickly *before* reading the passage. (Do not read the options yet—just the questions).
  2. Identify the core keywords in the questions (e.g., a specific year, name, or scientific term).
  3. Read the passage with these keywords in mind. When you hit a keyword, slow down and read carefully. This "active searching" prevents you from having to re-read the entire passage multiple times.
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## 2. Passage Type I: Simple Book / Story-Based Passage

**Syllabus Guideline:** *At least one paragraph should be a simple one based on a book or a story.*

### Passage A: "The Weaver of Kanchipuram"

In a small, dust-swept village near the historic town of Kanchipuram, there lived an elderly weaver named Sreedhar. Sreedhar was widely known among his peers as an exceptionally **amiable** man who maintained **amicable** relations even with his most competitive rivals. For over fifty years, he had lived in a humble **abode** beside the village temple, dedicating his days to the intricate art of weaving silk sarees. His small workshop contained a single, hand-operated wooden loom that had belonged to his grandfather—a primeval apparatus that Sreedhar refused to replace with modern, automated machinery. Sreedhar's daily routine was highly disciplined; he got up every day at five o'clock, drank a simple cup of tea, and worked diligently until sunset.

Sreedhar's life was quiet until a sudden crisis threw his household into a state of deep distress. His granddaughter, Rajitha, fell ill with a persistent, burning fever. The local folk healer administered several herbal mixtures, but Rajitha's condition only worsened. She grew weaker by the day, her skin burning like a hot coal. Sreedhar was kept **on tenterhooks** for days, sitting beside her bed and watching her childlike smile fade. The village doctor eventually arrived and diagnosed her with a severe form of malaria. He advised Sreedhar that a highly effective, modern medicine was available in the city, but it was exceptionally expensive.

To buy the medicine, Sreedhar needed to make quick money. He decided to sell his masterwork—a beautiful, gold-threaded silk saree that had taken him six months of continuous, painstaking labor to complete. The saree was an absolute masterpiece, featuring

exquisite patterns of deers and peacocks woven into the borders. He took the saree to the market, but the local merchants, guilty of **sharp practices** and underhanded dealings, offered him a miserable sum, claiming the market for traditional handloom was in decline. One merchant, notorious for his greed, told Sreedhar that his saree was pedestrian and out of fashion.

Refusing to be deceived by their dishonest words, Sreedhar traveled directly to Kanchipuram. There, he met a wealthy tourist who was a passionate admirer of traditional Indian arts. The tourist's eyes were opened to the unmatched beauty of Sreedhar's handiwork. He not only bought the saree for three times its estimated value but also praised Sreedhar's dedication. Sreedhar ran back to the village with the medicine, and within a week, Rajitha was restored to health. The family's happiness was complete, and Sreedhar returned to his loom, weaving his threads with renewed gratitude.

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### 3. Passage Type II: Editorial / Current Affairs-Based Passage

**Syllabus Guideline:** *The other paragraph should be based on current affairs editorial or a report.*

#### Passage B: "The Air Pollution Crisis and the Green Transition"

The catastrophic decline in urban air quality across major developing nations has emerged as one of the most pressing public health emergencies of the twenty-first century. In cities like Delhi, residents regularly breathe the most polluted air in the world—a toxic cocktail of particulate matter ( $\text{PM}_{2.5}$  and  $\text{PM}_{10}$ ), nitrogen oxides, and sulfur dioxide. This crisis is not an accidental **occurrence**; it is the logical consequence of unchecked industrial expansion, vehicular emissions, and seasonal agricultural crop burning. Despite several public warnings and administrative policies, the situation continues to worsen, threatening millions of lives with chronic respiratory illnesses, cardiovascular diseases, and premature mortality.

A recent environmental report indicates that the economic expenditure required to combat the health effects of air pollution is rising exponentially. The state's healthcare infrastructure is under immense strain, and productivity is falling as millions of working hours are lost to sickness. This crisis has forced policy makers to realize that traditional, piecemeal solutions are no longer sufficient. Our entire approach to urban planning, transport, and energy generation is currently **in a melting pot**. The transition from fossil fuels to renewable energy is no longer a distant, idealistic goal; it is an absolute, immediate necessity.

However, the green transition is not without its challenges. The shift to electric vehicles (EVs) and solar energy requires massive initial investments in infrastructure and technology. Critics argue that forcing rapid compliance could harm small-scale industries and lead to widespread job losses. Furthermore, the administrative machinery responsible for implementing green regulations is often slow, rigid, and plagued by coordination failures.

To overcome these barriers, governments must adopt a dual strategy. First, they must provide targeted financial incentives and subsidies to help small industries adapt to clean technologies. Second, they must enforce strict environmental standards without exception,

ensuring that large polluters are held fully accountable. Air pollution does not recognize administrative boundaries or social classes; it affects everyone equally. Unless we take decisive, unified action now, our cities will become unlivable, and our future generations will pay the ultimate price for our collective inaction.

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## Top 25 Expected MCQs: Previous APPSC/SSC/RRB-Style Questions

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**Directions (Q1–Q12):** Read Passage A ("The Weaver of Kanchipuram") carefully and choose the best option for each question.

**Q1. According to the passage, why was Sreedhar widely respected by his competitive rivals?**

- (A) Because he possessed a highly expensive, automated silk loom.
- (B) Because he was an exceptionally friendly and peaceable man.
- (C) Because he was the wealthiest merchant in Kanchipuram.
- (D) Because he traveled to the city every week.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* The passage states that Sreedhar was widely known as an "exceptionally amiable man who maintained amicable relations even with his most competitive rivals." Based on our grammar notes, *amiable* means friendly and *amicable* means peaceable.

**Q2. What can be inferred about Sreedhar's wooden handloom from the text?**

- (A) It was a modern, high-speed automated machine.
- (B) It was a prized possession that Sreedhar had inherited.
- (C) It was designed by a famous engineer from Kanchipuram.
- (D) It was unsuited for weaving high-quality silk.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* The text describes the hand-operated wooden loom as something that "had belonged to his grandfather" and refers to it as a "primeval apparatus," which Sreedhar refused to replace. This supports the inference that it was an inherited, valued possession.

**Q3. Sreedhar was kept *on tenterhooks* during Rajitha's illness. What does this expression mean in this context?**

- (A) In a state of comfortable, peaceful rest.
- (B) Feeling angry and hostile toward the village doctor.
- (C) In a state of acute anxiety, suspense, or nervous anticipation.
- (D) Exhibiting extreme arrogance.

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* Grounded directly in our idioms notes (Chapter 6), "on tenterhooks" means to be in a state of extreme anxiety, suspense, or nervous anticipation. Sreedhar was anxious about his granddaughter's burning fever.

**Q4. Why did Sreedhar refuse to sell his masterwork saree to the local merchants?**

- (A) Because they refused to pay him in cash.
- (B) Because they offered him a miserable sum based on dishonest, underhanded claims.
- (C) Because he wanted to gift the saree to Rajitha.
- (D) Because the saree was defective.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Explanation:* The text states that the local merchants were "guilty of sharp practices and underhanded dealings" and "offered him a miserable sum." Based on our idiom notes, *sharp practices* means dishonest or questionable business dealings.

**Q5. How did the wealthy tourist react upon seeing Sreedhar's gold-threaded saree?**

- (A) He ridiculed it as pedestrian and out of fashion.
- (B) He advised Sreedhar to use automated machinery.
- (C) His eyes were opened to its unmatched beauty and he bought it for three times its estimated value.
- (D) He refused to buy it because it featured patterns of deers.

- **Correct Answer: (C)**

- *Explanation:* The passage notes that the tourist's "eyes were opened to the unmatched beauty of Sreedhar's handiwork" and he "bought the saree for three times its estimated value." Based on our notes, to "open someone's eyes" means to make them realize the truth of a situation.

**Q6. What is the grammatical part of speech of the word *amiable* in the first paragraph?**

- (A) Abstract Noun
- (B) Coordinate Conjunction
- (C) Attributive Adjective
- (D) Adverb of Manner

- **Correct Answer: (C)**

- *Explanation:* "Amiable" modifies the noun "man" and is placed directly before it (attributive position), which makes it an adjective of quality.

**Q7. "His granddaughter, Rajitha, fell ill with a persistent, burning fever." Identify the subject of this sentence.**

- (A) fell ill with a persistent fever
- (B) burning fever
- (C) His granddaughter, Rajitha
- (D) Rajitha fell ill

- **Correct Answer: (C)**

- *Explanation:* The complete subject of the sentence is the noun phrase "His granddaughter, Rajitha", which performs the action of falling ill.

**Q8. Which of the following words from the passage is INCORRECTLY spelt?**

- (A) primeval
- (B) apparatus
- (C) deers
- (D) child-like



- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* Grounded directly in our Chapter 5 noun notes, **deer** has the exact same form in both singular and plural. Writing "deers" is grammatically incorrect.

**Q9. Sreedhar was kept on tenterhooks "sitting beside her bed." What is the semantic difference between *beside* and *besides*?**

- (A) *Beside* means in addition to; *besides* means near.  
 (B) *Beside* indicates physical position (by the side of); *besides* means in addition to.  
 (C) Both words have the exact same meaning and can be used interchangeably.  
 (D) *Beside* is a verb; *besides* is a noun.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* Grounded in our preposition notes (Chapter 4), "beside" refers to physical proximity (next to), while "besides" means in addition to or moreover.

**Q10. What can we infer about Sreedhar's personality from his daily routine?**

- (A) He was rash and impetuous.  
 (B) He was highly disciplined, diligent, and deeply committed to his craft.  
 (C) He was lazy and dependent on others.  
 (D) He was arrogant and putting on airs.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* The text notes that Sreedhar got up at five o'clock every day and worked "diligently until sunset," demonstrating high discipline, diligence, and commitment.

**Q11. What would have been the passive form of: "The local folk healer administered several herbal mixtures"?**

- (A) Several herbal mixtures have been administered by the local folk healer.  
 (B) Several herbal mixtures were administered by the local folk healer.  
 (C) Several herbal mixtures had been administered by the local folk healer.  
 (D) Let several herbal mixtures be administered.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* The active sentence is in the Simple Past tense ("administered"). Converting it to passive requires "was/were + \$V\\_3\$" → "were administered."

**Q12. Which of the following would be the most appropriate title for Passage A?**

- (A) The Automated Looms of Kanchipuram  
 (B) Sreedhar's Masterpiece and the Triumph of Love  
 (C) The Decline of Traditional Silk Sarees  
 (D) Malaria in Rural India

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
  - *Explanation:* The passage centers on Sreedhar's masterwork saree and how his love and dedication to his craft ultimately saved his granddaughter's life. This makes option (B) the most fitting title.
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**Directions (Q13–Q25): Read Passage B ("The Air Pollution Crisis and the Green Transition") carefully and choose the best option for each question.**

**Q13. According to the environmental report, what is the direct economic effect of air pollution?**

- (A) An increase in the sale of traditional fossil fuels.
- (B) An exponential rise in healthcare expenditure and lost productivity due to sickness.
- (C) Rapid coordination among policy makers.
- (D) A drop in the cost of electric vehicles.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Explanation:* The text states that "the economic expenditure required to combat the health effects of air pollution is rising exponentially" and "productivity is falling as millions of working hours are lost to sickness."

**Q14. The author states that our approach to energy generation is *in a melting pot*. What does this mean?**

- (A) It is highly permanent and unchanging.
- (B) It is in a state of rapid transition and reorganization.
- (C) It is completely destroyed by the government.
- (D) It is generating extreme physical heat.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Explanation:* Grounded in Chapter 6, "in a melting pot" is an idiomatic phrase denoting a process of rapid change, transition, or reorganization.

**Q15. Why do critics express concern regarding a rapid green transition?**

- (A) They believe solar energy is more harmful than fossil fuels.
- (B) They fear rapid compliance could harm small-scale industries and cause job losses.
- (C) They argue that air pollution does not affect public health.
- (D) They believe electric vehicles are too slow.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Explanation:* The passage states that "Critics argue that forcing rapid compliance could harm small-scale industries and lead to widespread job losses."

**Q16. What dual strategy does the author propose to overcome the barriers to the green transition?**

- (A) Increase taxes on small businesses and ignore large corporations.
- (B) Shift completely to automated machinery and ban traditional handlooms.
- (C) Provide targeted financial incentives to small industries and strictly hold large polluters accountable.
- (D) Delay the transition until solar energy becomes cheaper.

- **Correct Answer: (C)**

- *Explanation:* The final paragraph outlines this dual strategy: "First, they must provide targeted financial incentives... to help small industries adapt... Second, they must enforce strict environmental standards... ensuring that large polluters are held fully accountable."

**Q17. "Unless we take decisive, unified action now, our cities will become unlivable."**

**What grammatical rule applies to the word *Unless* in this sentence?**

- (A) It must be followed by "not" in the subordinate clause.
- (B) It is a negative conjunction and must not be followed by "not" in its own clause.
- (C) It is a preposition of time.
- (D) It requires an inversion of subject and verb.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Explanation:* Grounded in Chapter 4, "unless" is inherently negative. Adding "not" in its clause creates an incorrect double negative.

**Q18. In the sentence: "This crisis is not an accidental *occurrence*..." What is the correct spelling of the italicized word?**

- (A) Ocurence
- (B) Occurence
- (C) Occurrence
- (D) Occurance

- **Correct Answer: (C)**

- *Explanation:* Grounded in our Chapter 5 spelling rules, **occurrence** is spelt with a double 'c', a double 'r', and ends with '-ence'.

**Q19. "In cities like Delhi, residents regularly breathe the most polluted air in the world..." What is the difference between *air* and *airs*?**

- (A) *Air* refers to atmospheric gas; *airs* refers to proud, arrogant behavior.
- (B) *Air* is singular; *airs* is its plural form with the same meaning.
- (C) *Air* refers to travel; *airs* refers to gas.
- (D) There is no semantic difference.

- **Correct Answer: (A)**

- *Explanation:* Grounded in our Chapter 3 noun notes, the singular "air" represents the physical gas we breathe, while the plural "airs" denotes affected, snobbish, or arrogant behavior.

**Q20. "This transition... is an absolute, immediate necessity." What is the function of the word *immediate* in this noun phrase?**

- (A) Coordinating Conjunction
- (B) Attributive Adjective modifying "necessity"
- (C) Adverb of Manner
- (D) Objective Pronoun

- **Correct Answer: (B)**

- *Explanation:* "Immediate" qualifies the noun "necessity" and is placed directly before it, making it an attributive adjective.

**Q21. "The government decided to appoint an administrative committee..." How is the collective noun *committee* used in standard subject-verb concord?**

- (A) It always takes a plural verb.
- (B) It takes a singular verb when acting as a unified whole, and a plural verb when its members are divided.

- (C) It always takes a singular verb.  
(D) It does not have a plural form.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* Grounded in Chapter 3, collective nouns like *committee* or *jury* take a singular verb when behaving harmoniously as one unit, and a plural verb when divided in opinion or action.

**Q22. What is the tone of Passage B?**

- (A) Highly celebratory and optimistic.  
(B) Analytical, urgent, and advocacy-oriented.  
(C) Playful and humorous.  
(D) Cynical, dismissive, and indifferent.

- **Correct Answer: (B)**
- *Explanation:* The author presents a detailed, objective analysis of the air quality crisis, argues that action is an "absolute, immediate necessity," and advocates for specific policy steps, making the tone analytical, urgent, and advocacy-oriented.

**Q23. Which of the following is the most appropriate title for Passage B?**

- (A) The Rise of Electric Vehicles in Delhi  
(B) Industrialization: A Blessing in Disguise  
(C) Clearing the Air: Challenges and Strategies for the Green Transition  
(D) The Rigid Bureaucracy of Developing Nations

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* This title captures the central focus of the passage: the urgency of tackling urban air pollution ("clearing the air") and the practical challenges and strategies associated with the renewable transition.

**Q24. What can be inferred about the author's view on environmental regulations?**

- (A) The author believes regulations should be relaxed to protect industries.  
(B) The author believes regulations are unnecessary because technology will solve the crisis.  
(C) The author believes regulations must be strictly and uniformly enforced, particularly for large polluters, while helping small businesses adapt.  
(D) The author believes regulations are the sole cause of economic decline.

- **Correct Answer: (C)**
- *Explanation:* In the final paragraph, the author advocates for enforcing "strict environmental standards without exception" on large polluters, combined with targeted financial incentives to help small industries adapt.

**Q25. "Unless we take decisive, unified action now, our cities will become unlivable..."  
Identify the structural type of this sentence.**

- (A) Simple Sentence  
(B) Compound Sentence  
(C) Complex Sentence  
(D) Imperative Sentence

- **Correct Answer: (C)**

- *Explanation:* Grounded in Chapter 2, this sentence contains one main clause ("our cities will become unlivable") and one subordinate conditional clause introduced by the subordinating conjunction "Unless," classifying it as a complex sentence.
-